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LG pushes Dwarka as investment hub

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Friday chaired an industry interaction on positioning Dwarka as a major economic and commercial hub.

On the occasion, the LG told industry representatives that the sub-city's proximity to the international airport, seamless connectivity, and maturing urban ecosystem make it investment-ready across sectors while insisting that its industrial growth must remain clean, non-polluting, and focused on generating large-scale employment for the local workforce.

The session was attended by industry representatives from the real estate and infrastructure, hospitality, and healthcare sectors, along with the DDA Vice Chairman,



senior Delhi government officials, and the Managing Director of ITPO.

The LG said Dwarka, as one of Asia's largest planned sub-cities, is uniquely positioned to become a premier investment destination with opportunities in commerce, hospitality, healthcare, education, and technology. He emphasised urban redevelopment and infrastructure upgradation as essential to

Delhi's long-term economic growth.

On industrial character, he was specific: Dwarka's growth should steer clear of industries that could compromise its environmental quality. The focus should be on a labour-centric industrial base that translates economic growth into direct livelihood gains for the people of Delhi.

The LG observed that plan-

ning and development norms, including floor area ratio, need to be reviewed and rationalised in line with emerging urban requirements. He said sector-specific policy measures are needed to enhance Delhi's competitiveness as an investment destination.

Industry representatives suggested a more investor-friendly ecosystem through improved infrastructure, research and innovation facilities, a streamlined single-window clearance mechanism, and simplified approval processes.

They also called for promoting hospitality, tourism, and healthcare infrastructure, incentivising knowledge-based industries, IT, ITES, and global capability centres, strengthening research and development, and leveraging MICE infrastructure at Yashobhoomi

and Bharat Mandapam, supported by adequate hotel capacity.

The DDA vice chairman said the authority has made land available to support future investments and is working with stakeholder agencies to streamline approvals. He referred to the recently approved Transit-Oriented Development Policy, formulated under the LG's guidance, which brings all concerned agencies together for single-point, time-bound approvals for eligible projects.

The additional chief secretary for industries said major ease of doing business reforms are underway, including a new industrial policy, integration of approval processes across departments, and promotion of research and innovation through financial support mechanisms.

Gold appraiser arrested for ₹3.81 crore fake loan fraud

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A gold appraiser at a non-banking financial company has been arrested for allegedly conspiring with others to create 683 fake gold loan accounts and secure loans exceeding ₹3.81 crore using forged documents and artificial gold ornaments, according to the Economic Offences Wing (EOW) of Delhi Police. The arrest followed an investigation into the suspected fraud.

The accused, Pankaj Kumar, was employed as a gold appraiser with a private company and was arrested on July 7 following the investigation. According to the EOW, the case was uncovered after the company's internal audit identified significant irregularities in its gold loan



portfolio. Packets of pledged gold ornaments worth approximately ₹14.11 lakh were missing.

The audit also revealed that 683 fake gold loan accounts had been created between 2022 and 2025 using forged KYC documents, false customer identities, and artificial gold ornaments. Loans totalling about ₹3.81 crore were fraudulently disbursed based on these accounts, the EOW statement read.

An FIR was registered at the EOW police station in August 2025, and further investiga-

tion was taken up. Police reviewed loan files, appraisal reports, KYC documents, audit records, bank statements, and other financial records during the investigation. They also recorded statements from company officials and other witnesses.

Police stated that Kumar, along with others, certified artificial gold ornaments as genuine to approve fraudulent loans. He also forged identity documents and fabricated loan records to create fake borrower accounts.

"To avoid detection during internal audits, the accused and his associates allegedly continued depositing interest in the fake loan accounts and made false entries in the company's loan management system to project them as regular and active," Amit Verma, DCP EOW, said.

Noida: Man dies after falling into rainwater-filled drain

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Noida

A 28-year-old man died after reportedly falling into a rainwater-filled roadside drain in Sector 58, Noida, while he was on his way to work, police said on Friday.

The deceased, Aryan, was a resident of Choda village in Sector 22, Noida.

Police said the incident took place around 9 am on Thursday. Aryan was walking to a factory in Sector 58 during heavy waterlogging caused by continuous rain.

Preliminary investigation found that Aryan was walking on concrete slabs placed over a roadside drain while the road was flooded. One of the slabs was reportedly unstable, causing him to fall into the drain.

Police said Aryan's friend Shivam and others pulled him from the drain while he was

unconscious. They tried to revive him with CPR, but he did not respond. He was taken to the district hospital, where doctors declared him dead.

Police said legal proceedings are in progress and the circumstances of the incident are under investigation.

The incident is part of a series of rain-related accidents in Gautam Buddh Nagar district. Recent heavy rainfall has caused waterlogging and traffic congestion in Noida. On Friday, flooding at a private construction site in Sector 73, Noida, damaged a drain and caused a wall to collapse. No injuries were reported. Locals said the incident led to the closure of the nearby service road.g service road.

Earlier this week, a 10-year-old boy fell into an open maintenance hole in the Chi-Phi area of Greater Noida while walking with his mother.

Azadpur Mandi launches online payment for gate pass

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Agricultural Produce Marketing Committee at Azadpur Mandi, one of Asia's largest wholesale markets for fruits and vegetables and a Market of National Importance under the Government of NCT of Delhi, launched online payment for gate pass charges on Friday, July 10, replacing the predominantly cash-based system that has been in use at the market's entry gates, with plans to extend the facility to all mandis in Delhi shortly.

The launch was carried out under the guidance of Arjun Sharma, Vice Chairman of the Delhi Agricultural Marketing Board, and was executed by the Secretary of the Delhi Agricultural Marketing Board and the Agricultural Produce Marketing Committee, Azadpur.



Until now, traders, vehicle drivers, and all stakeholders entering Azadpur Mandi were required to pay gate pass charges primarily in cash. Under the new system, payment can be made through digital modes, allowing traders, vehicle owners, and all associated parties to complete the gate pass fee transaction online.

The APMC administration said the initiative is designed to make the payment process simpler,

more transparent, and more convenient for all vehicles entering Azadpur Mandi.

The benefits of moving away from cash transactions at the gate are multiple. The administration said cash handling at entry points will reduce significantly, leading to smoother vehicular movement and the likelihood of a notable reduction in congestion at entry points, which has historically been a recurring problem during peak arrival

hours at the mandi. The payment process will also become faster, more secure, and more transparent, benefiting traders, farmers, vehicle drivers, and all other related parties who work at or bring produce to the market.

The administration said Arjun Sharma has directed that the facility be made available at all mandis in Delhi soon, meaning Azadpur is the first among Delhi's mandis to implement online gate pass payment, with a city-wide rollout planned.

Azadpur Mandi in north Delhi is the largest wholesale market for fruits and vegetables in Asia by trading volume and serves as the primary distribution point for agricultural produce entering Delhi from across India. Hundreds of vehicles carrying produce from different states arrive at the market every day.

Abhay Verma named chief spokesperson of Delhi Govt

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday appointed MLA Abhay Kumar Verma as Chief Spokesperson of the Delhi Government, with MLA Anil Kumar Sharma and Harish Khurana appointed as Spokespersons, with all three appointments taking immediate effect and the three officials tasked with presenting the government's authorised position on contemporary issues and ensuring timely dissemination of official information to the media and citizens.

The Chief Minister said the appointments strengthen the government's commitment to transparent, accountable, and citizen-centric governance. She said the mechanism will ensure that official and factual information con-

cerning the government's policy decisions, development works, and public welfare schemes reaches citizens and the media in a time-bound manner.

The Chief Spokesperson and Spokespersons will present the authorised stance of the Delhi Government on various issues as they arise. They will share official information regarding major decisions, policy initiatives, and matters of public interest.

They will also liaise with media representatives and provide clarifications on behalf of the government on facts and decisions when required. Additionally, they will be responsible for conveying the government's perspective to the public based on information received through authorised channels from various departments.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at Large is hereby informed that my client **Mishresh Choudhary**, aged about 55 years, W/o Sh. Maan Singh, R/o 5-43, Hari Nagar, Jaitpur Extension, Badarpur, South Delhi, New Delhi-110094, has broken all relations with her son, namely **Mr. Rahul Choudhary, S/o Mr. Maan Singh, R/o Susada, Susadi Kalan, PO: Saraswati Nagar, Dist: Haryana, Uttarakhand-247665**, due to his misbehavior and misconduct towards my client. My Client has also debarred and disowned her son, namely **Mr. Rahul Choudhary** and his family members from all her moveable and immovable property/properties. Further, my client also declares that she has no control over her son, namely **Mr. Rahul Choudhary**, and his family members. My client shall not be responsible regarding the conduct, behavior, dealing sd, debt and credit of her son, namely **Mr. Rahul Choudhary** and his family members. Whoever deals with her or his family members, will be doing so at their own risk and responsibility.

Aman Upadhyay (Advocate) Ch. No. 153, Lawyer's Chamber Block, Saket Court Complex, ND-110017, M: 9810613990

PUBLIC NOTICE

BET IT KNOWN TO ALL THAT my clients, **Shri Greshh Babu S/o Sh. Nathu Ram and Ms. Kusum W/o Shri Greshh Babu R/o E-3/239 C, Shiv Ram Park, Nanjoli, Delhi-110041**, have severed relations/connections with their son **Nagendra Kumar** and his wife **Shweta Singh** for all purposes. They are further disintitled/disowned to claim any right/share in the movable and immovable properties owned by my clients. Any person dealing with them in any manner shall be solely doing so at his own risk and costs. My clients shall not be responsible for discharging any liability/claim in this regard.

Pravesh Saini (Advocate) Ch. No. 13, Civil Supply Building, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054, M: 7015368068

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given on behalf of **NEELU JAIN W/o Mr. RAJESH JAIN** who is owner of PROPERTY BEARING No-F-67-B, LAND AREA MEASURING 135 SQ. YDS. OUT OF RECT NO 59, & KILLANA NO.7, SITUATED IN THE AREA OF GALI NO.12, LAXMI NAGAR, IN THE AREA OF VILLAGE KHUREJI KHAS, ILLUADA SHARADA, DELHI-110092 vide Sale Deed dated 24.06.2026, Document No.2026/5/2396, Book No.1, Volume No.5537, Pages 88-108, dated 24.06.2026, SRO-VIII East Preet Vihar, now **NEELU JAIN** intend to mortgage the subject property with **AXIS FINANCE LIMITED** So, to comply the requirements of BANK/NBFC, we give this public notice that if any Person having any type of claim/right/title/interest/ creating mortgage over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within 15 days from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all types of Encumbrances, lien, charge, litigation etc. **Lucem Legal LLP N-161, Ground Floor, Salra Tower, Gautam Nagar Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre, New Delhi-110049 Contact no: 011-40945316 & 41697377**

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given on behalf of **RAJNISH GOMEY** who is purchasing Portion of Plot bearing No. 129, area measuring 50 Sq. yds., out of total land area measuring 100 sq. yds., out of Kharsa No.2524, Situated in the revenue estate of Village Niloti, known as Mera Kung Niloti Extn., New Delhi-110041, from Mrs. Priya who had owned the subject property vide Notarized General Power of Attorney Agreement to sell and Will dated 02.03.2012 executed by Mrs. Sushila Kumar, now **RAJNISH GOMEY** intend to purchase and mortgage the subject property with **VASTU HOUSING FINANCE CORPORATION LTD** So, to comply the requirements of BANK/NBFC, we give this public notice that if any Person having any type of claim/right/title/interest/creating mortgage over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within 07 days from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all types of Encumbrances, lien etc. **Lucem Legal LLP N-161, Ground Floor, Salra Tower, Gautam Nagar Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre, New Delhi-110049 Contact no: 011-40945316 & 41697377**

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, **OM PARKASH SETHI S/o LATE LAL CHAND R/o C-58, ASHOK VIHAR PHASE-I, DELHI-110052** do hereby sell my share in the share and inform That **Mr. VARINDER SETHI** is my son, he has married to **Mrs. GITA SETHI**, he has two child i.e. daughter-**Vedika Sethi**, & Son-**Shivam Sethi**, do hereby disowned my son **Mr. VARINDER SETHI** and his wife **Mrs. GITA SETHI** and their childrens daughter-**Vedika Sethi** & Son-**Shivam Sethi**, from all my moveable and immovable properties and have reserved all our relations with them as he is disobedient, disrespectful, and out of control and misbehaviour and other some unavoidable circumstances arisen by them. Anyone dealing with them will do so at his own risk and cost, we will not be responsible for their any act or deeds as we have no relation with them.

Om Parkash Sethi

J&K Bank
Serving India

The Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited
Plot no 132-134 sector 44 Gurugram 122002, Haryana, India
T 0124 4715800 | E gursec@jkbml.com | W www.jkbank.net

Possession Notice
Notice under Section 13 (4) of the SARFAESI ACT, 2002 read with Rule 8 (1) of the Security (Enforcement) Interest Rules, 2002
Whereas Mr. Reyaz Ahmad Mir, as the Authorized Officer of the Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest (SARFAESI) Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers under section 13(12) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notice dated 03-06-2025 thereby calling upon the Borrowers namely:
1. Mrs. Urmila Devi W/O Mr. Ramchandra Sharma (**Borrower/Mortgagor**) &
2. Mr. Ajay Sharma S/o Mr. Ramchandra Sharma (**Co-Borrower**)
Both Residents of A-495 Block A, Second Floor, Prem Chowk, Shastri Nagar, Northwest Delhi, Delhi-110052
to repay an amount of Rs.39,99,890.16 (Rupees Thirty-Nine Lacs ninety-nine thousand eight hundred ninety and paise sixteen only) being the balance outstanding as on 31-05-2025 in the accounts of the Borrower, within 60 days from the date of the said notice together with the future interest and other charges thereon.
The said borrower having failed to repay the said amount, notice is hereby given to the said borrower in particular and the public in general that the undersigned being authorized officer of the J & K Bank Ltd. has taken possession of the mortgage property described herein below, in exercise of the powers conferred on me under section 13 (4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules, on this **07th day of July, 2026**.
The said borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned against dealing with the said property in any manner whatsoever and any dealings with the said property will be subject to the charge of the J&K Bank Limited for the amount in aggregating to **Rs. 43,66,543.16 (Rupees Forty-three lacs sixty-six Thousand five Hundred forty three and paise sixteen Only)** as on 30-06-2026 together with future interest thereon from 01-07-2026 and other charges incurred or to be incurred.
The borrower's attention is invited to the provisions of Sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of the time available, to redeem the secured assets.
DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
(As per the schedule provided in mortgage deed/latest particulars including any accreditations)
Equitable mortgage of 3rd Floor, front side with rooftop terrace rights, lift facility with common Hatchback car parking space Ground floor of built-up property bearing No. B-48A, area measuring 90 Sq. Yards, out of total area of 150 Sq. Yards, out of Kharsa No. 875 and 877, situated in the area of Village Nawada, Delhi State, Delhi, colony known as Block-B, Sewak Park, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110078 with proportionate rights of land underneath.

Sd/-
Authorized Officer
Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited

J&K Bank
Serving India

The Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited
Plot no 132-134 sector 44 Gurugram 122002, Haryana, India
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1. Mrs. Urmila Devi W/O Mr. Ramchandra Sharma (**Borrower/Mortgagor**) &
2. Mr. Vijay Sharma S/o Mr. Ramchandra Sharma (**Co-Borrower**)
Both Residents of A-495 Block A, Second Floor, Prem Chowk, Shastri Nagar, Northwest Delhi, Delhi-110052
to repay an amount of Rs.40,33,304.94 (Rupees Forty lacs thirty-three thousand three hundred forty and paise ninety-four only) being the balance outstanding as on 31-05-2025 in the accounts of the Borrower, within 60 days from the date of the said notice together with the future interest and other charges thereon.
The said borrower having failed to repay the said amount, notice is hereby given to the said borrower in particular and the public in general that the undersigned being authorized officer of the J & K Bank Ltd. has taken possession of the mortgage property described herein below, in exercise of the powers conferred on me under section 13 (4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules, on this **07th day of July, 2026**.
The said borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned against dealing with the said property in any manner whatsoever and any dealings with the said property will be subject to the charge of the J&K Bank Limited for the amount in aggregating to **Rs. 44,12,494.94 (Rupees Forty-four lacs twelve thousand four Hundred ninety-four and paise ninety-four Only)** as on 30-06-2026 together with future interest thereon from 01-07-2026 and other charges incurred or to be incurred.
The borrower's attention is invited to the provisions of Sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of the time available, to redeem the secured assets.
DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
(As per the schedule provided in mortgage deed/latest particulars including any accreditations)
Equitable mortgage of 3rd Floor, front side with rooftop terrace rights, lift facility with common Hatchback car parking space Ground floor of built-up property bearing No. B-48A, area measuring 60 Sq. Yards, out of total area of 150 Sq. Yards, out of Kharsa No. 875 and 877, situated in the area of Village Nawada, Delhi State, Delhi, Colony known as Block-B, Sewak Park, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110078 with proportionate rights of land underneath.

Sd/-
Authorized Officer
Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that **Mr. Aditya Vikram Bansal** had acquired Land measuring 4 Bighas and 16 Siewas, Kharsa No. 550/4 (0-15), S5/1 (2-13), S5/3 (0-18) & S5/76 (0-5) situated in Village Sathari Tehsil Saket known as No-10 Green Meadows Sathari, New Delhi vide Sale Deed dt. 12.02.2024 executed by **Mr. Farhat Sheikh** through attorney **Mr. Atul Agnihotri (Vendor)** and (1) **Mr. Shally Thapar (45 % Undivided share)** (2) **Mrs. Ganpat Sales Agency through Mr. Shally Thapar (55 % Undivided share)** (Confirming Party). **Mr. Aditya Vikram Bansal** is the undivided owner of above said property and willing to mortgage the above said property with CIBIL.
OR
Any person / firm / institution / company having any claim or right in respect of the said Property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession, legal heirs, partners or encumbrance whatsoever or otherwise is hereby required to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice of his/her share or claim, if any, with all supporting documents at below mentioned address. After expiration of notice period, the claims, if any, of such person shall be treated null and void and also treated as waived and not binding on our client.
Ajay Kumar Didi (Advocate) H.No. 26/161, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar 4, New Delhi 110024

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, KARNAL	STRENGTHENING WITH WBM PLUS RELAYING OF C&B AND 80MM IPS ON BERM (RHS) ON PUNDRAK TO BUDHANPUR ROAD (ROAD ID: 7373) (ODR) KM 0.00 TO 0.380 IN KARNAL CONSTITUENCY, IN KARNAL DISTRICT (UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2025-27) + 1 WORKS	07.07.2026 13.07.2026	34.98 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9876009311 pwd-eeep-karnal@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, HISAR	CONSTRUCTION OF 50 BEDDED TO 100 BEDDED HOSPITAL AT NARNAUN IN DISTT. HISAR (PDG. E.I. INTERNAL BALANCE WORK ONLY)	08.07.2026 13.07.2026	48.46 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0166-2225651 pwd-eeed-hissar@hry.nic.in
3	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	REGARDING REQUIREMENT OF MATERIAL IN STORE UNDER JURISDICTION OF LWS (M) SUB DIVISION NO. 2, CHARKHI DADRI FOR FLOOD DETERATERING	CLOSING DATE 15.07.2026	5.03 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01250-220058 xenilwsmeech@gmail.com
4	CIVIL SURGEON, KAITHAL	DRUGS AND CONSUMABLES	13.07.2026 27.07.2026	EMD 1 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7988672699 drugstorektl@gmail.com
5	CIVIL SURGEON, NARNAUL	E-TENDER FOR HIRING E-RICKSHAW WITH MIXING FOR URBAN SLUM UNDER NUHM NARNAUL	13.07.2026 30.07.2026	EMD 24000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466991604 dpm.mhn@gmail.com
6	PANCHAYATI RAJ, BHIZWANI	CONST OF SHED IN GAUSHALA AT VILL PINOKHERA BLOCK TOSHAM (DMF)	07.07.2026 13.07.2026	8.69 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01664243927 prexeeng-bhw@hry.nic.in
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in					RO 47080-I-27-7	

Pink Saheli card must for free bus rides for women from Aug 1

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Government has announced that the paper-based Pink Ticket system for free bus travel for women in DTC and Cluster buses will be discontinued after July 31, 2026, with the Pink Saheli Smart Card based on the National Common Mobility Card becoming the sole mode for availing the free travel facility from August 1, Transport Minister Dr Pankaj Kumar Singh announced on Friday.

Approximately 15 lakh Pink

Saheli Smart Cards have already been issued. Women who have not yet obtained the card have been urged to register at the earliest, though Kumar Singh clarified there is no deadline for registration and the card issuance process will continue beyond July 31 at DTC depots and special camps.

Singh said the transition is aimed at introducing a more transparent, efficient, and accountable system for women commuters. He said the government is fully committed to ensuring that no eligible woman is deprived of

the free travel benefit through the transition.

"Pink Tickets will remain valid till July 31, and from August 1, women possessing the Pink Saheli Smart Card will continue to travel free of cost. Nearly 15 lakh cards have already been issued, and I appeal to all our mothers and sisters who have not yet obtained the card to do so at the earliest. The card offers multiple benefits besides free travel and will help bring greater transparency, efficiency and accountability to the system. Even after July 31, the process



of issuing Pink Saheli Smart Cards will continue at DTC depots and Special Camps, and the Delhi Government

will ensure that no eligible beneficiary is deprived of this facility," he said.

The Pink Saheli Smart Card

is an NCMC-compatible smart card. Women commuters who obtain the card will be able to tap in and travel free of cost on DTC buses from August 1. The paper ticket system, under which women currently receive printed pink tickets at bus entry points or depots for each journey, will be phased out as part of the transition.

The shift to a smart card system has been under discussion for some time as the government sought to move away from paper-based travel passes that are harder to track in aggregate

terms and more prone to misuse. The NCMC-based format allows for digital recording of journeys, better beneficiary management, and the potential to link the free travel benefit to other mobility services as the National Common Mobility Card ecosystem expands across Metro and bus networks in Delhi.

The free bus travel scheme for women in Delhi has been in operation for several years and is among the more widely used welfare transport measures in the capital.

The paper Pink Ticket

system served as the original mechanism for its implementation. The transition to a smart card represents the next phase of the scheme's administration rather than any change to its core entitlement. Women who have not yet registered for the Pink Saheli Smart Card can do so at DTC depots across the city.

Special camps will also be organised for registration. Singh reiterated that the July 31 date applies only to the validity of paper tickets and not to the card registration process, which will remain open after that date.

World Bank formally hands over project grant to Delhi for ₹8,300 crore clean air programme

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The World Bank on Friday formally handed over the confirmation of the Project Preparation Grant Facility to the Delhi Government at an Orientation Workshop inaugurated by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, marking the official start of preparations for the Clean Air, Healthy Delhi programme. The seven-year initiative, worth ₹8,300 crore to be implemented from September 2026 to August 2033, with 65 percent financed through a World Bank loan and the remaining 35 per cent borne by the Delhi Government.

The workshop was attended by Cabinet Ministers Parvesh Sahib Singh, Ashish Sood, and Manjinder Singh Sirsa, World Bank Country Head Paul Procee and other World Bank representatives, Department of Economic Affairs officials from the Government of India, and senior officials from all departments associated with the project.

During the workshop,



Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Minister Ashish Sood, and other dignitaries during the signing of a tripartite agreement between IGL, DoE, and EHSAS for water harvesting in CM-Shri Schools at Delhi Secretariat in New Delhi

World Bank experts made presentations on financial management, procurement procedures, environmental and social safeguard standards, and institutional preparedness under the Programme for Results framework. The objective was to familiarise all participating departments and agencies with World Bank procedures and international standards before the programme commences in September.

Technical assessments and a panel discussion also took place, covering key interven-

tions on improving the transport system, controlling road dust, and strengthening solid waste management. Senior officials from the Delhi Pollution Control Committee, Transport Department, MCD, PWD, NDMC, and Delhi Transco Limited participated.

The programme is built around two pillars. The first focuses on strengthening air quality management, including establishing a Project Management Unit, building a modern air quality monitoring network, setting up data analytics systems, and creating an

Integrated Command and Control Centre for monitoring. It also aims to improve inter-departmental coordination and promote cooperation with the Indo-Gangetic Plain states on pollution control.

The second pillar targets emission reduction from major sources: phasing out old and highly polluting vehicles, promoting electric vehicles, strengthening public transport, developing advanced pollution testing systems, controlling dust from roads and construction sites, and improving waste collection.

The Chief Minister said air quality improvement is a collective responsibility across all departments rather than the task of any single agency. She said the programme reflects the Government's commitment to giving equal importance to development and environmental protection as Delhi grows.

She said the Government's strategy is to address pollution at source, strengthen data-driven monitoring, enforce compliance through technology, and encourage public participation.

Over 1.9 lakh register for DU UG admissions

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi University has received over 1.9 lakh applications for undergraduate admissions in the 2026-27 academic session, with more than 1.64 lakh candidates completing preference filling as well, officials said on Friday.

According to the university, 1,90,645 candidates have registered themselves for the UG admission process through the Common Seat Allocation System (CSAS).

University officials added that 1,64,098 candidates have completed Phase II of the admission process, which involves filling programme and college preferences. The deadline for completing the process is 11.59 pm on Saturday, July 11.

The university has also opened a one-time correction window from 10 am on Friday, allowing applicants to rectify mistakes in the details already submitted on the CSAS portal. The correction facility will remain available till 11.59 pm on Saturday.

The university announced the correction window after receiving requests from students who reported errors while filling out their details



on the portal, officials said.

The registration process for undergraduate admissions began on June 26 and will close at 11.59 pm on Saturday.

Phase II of admissions, during which candidates are required to complete subject mapping and fill their programme and college preferences, opened on July 3.

During a webinar held earlier this week to guide applicants through the admission process, the university officials urged students to carefully complete subject mapping and preference filling before the deadline.

Admissions will be conducted for 73 undergraduate programmes offered across 69 colleges and departments, with a total of 71,624 seats available. Around 150

BA programme combinations are on offer, and the detailed seat matrix has already been uploaded on the university website, the officials said.

Candidates have been advised to carefully review their programme and college preferences before the deadline, after which the choices will be automatically locked, they added.

Admissions under supernumerary categories, including sports and extracurricular activities, will also be processed based on the candidate's preferences.

The first seat allocation list will be released on July 16.

After accepting an allotted seat and paying the admission fee, candidates can either freeze their admission or opt for an upgrade in subsequent rounds.

DU TEACHERS OPPOSE FYUP CHANGES

New Delhi: Delhi University teachers on Friday raised concerns against the university's decision to restructure the credit-point in the fourth year of the Undergraduate Curriculum Framework (UGCF), alleging that the changes were introduced without the approval of statutory bodies.

The criticism comes after the university issued a notification on Friday, revising the credit distribution for the fourth year of the Four-Year Undergraduate Programme (FYUP), increasing dissertation credits from six to 10 and reducing the number of Discipline Specific Core (DSC) papers.

"Courses listed under Discipline Specific Core (DSC) in semester VII and VIII across all UG programmes under UGCF 2022 may be removed and be listed hereafter under the Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) pool of that discipline in the respective semesters," the notification mentioned.

CM Gupta writes to Nitin Gadkari seeking national highway status for Mandi Road

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has written to Union Minister for Road Transport and Highways Nitin Gadkari, requesting that the 8.8-kilometre Mandi Road in South Delhi be declared a National Highway and placed under the National Highways Authority of India for integrated development. The Chief Minister said that the move would improve connectivity across Delhi-NCR and give momentum to regional economic growth.

In her letter, the Chief Minister said Mandi Road is a key strategic transport corridor that connects Mehrauli-Gurugram Road, National Highway 148A, near Chhatarpur Metro Station, with the Gurugram-Faridabad Road at the Delhi-Haryana border. The road serves as a direct link between the National Capital Territory and the neighbouring economic centres of Gurugram and Faridabad, and plays an important role in inter-state traffic movement between the two states.

She pointed out that the Governing Body of the Unified Traffic and Transportation Infrastructure Planning and Engineering Centre, known as UTTIPEC, had at its 68th meeting held on September 27, 2023,



recognised the importance of Mandi Road and supported a proposal for its widening and comprehensive development. This existing institutional recognition, she said, provides a basis for taking the proposal forward at the national level.

The Chief Minister said that given the road's strategic significance, its existing and growing traffic demand, and its direct connectivity with NH-148A, it should be considered for inclusion under NHAI's jurisdiction.

She requested Gadkari to declare it a National Highway and place its development with NHAI so that an integrated development plan can be prepared, uniform engineering standards applied, and timely upgradation of the corridor ensured.

She said the initiative would provide better and smoother travel for the large number of commuters who use the road daily, particular-

ly those travelling between South Delhi's Chhatarpur and Mehrauli areas and the Haryana border toward Gurugram and Faridabad. The road currently connects two significant national highway segments, but it is under local jurisdiction, with no single integrated development authority responsible for its condition and upgrade.

The letter follows a pattern of requests from the Delhi government to the Central government for inclusion of key city roads and corridors under National Highway status and NHAI development, which typically brings with it access to Central funding, nationally standardised engineering specifications, and faster execution through NHAI's project management infrastructure.

Mandi Road's location in South Delhi places it in one of the capital's most economically active and rapidly developing zones.

Nearly 5,000 street vendors get PM SVANidhi loans this fiscal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Close to 5,000 street vendors under the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) have received loans worth over ₹16 crore under Centre's PM SVANidhi scheme so far in the current financial year, officials said on Friday.

A majority of these vendors availed the third tranche of assistance, as under the scheme, vendors graduate to higher loan amounts based on timely repayment of earlier loans — taken in tranche one and two. According to the civic body, the figures show that banks disbursed loans to



4,931 beneficiaries between April and early July of the 2026-27 financial year, releasing a total of ₹16.08 crore under the scheme, which provides collateral-free working capital loans to street vendors.

Under the scheme,

launched by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA), street vendors with a valid certificate of vending (COV) are eligible for collateral-free working capital loans in three tranches of ₹10,000, ₹20,000 and ₹50,000 to help them restart,

sustain and expand their businesses.

Of the total, 1,090 vendors received the first tranche of loans ranging between ₹10,000 and ₹15,000, with disbursements amounting to ₹1.60 crore.

The second tranche, under which eligible beneficiaries can avail loans of ₹20,000 or ₹25,000, was sanctioned to 1,774 vendors, taking the total disbursement under this category to ₹4.18 crore.

The largest share of beneficiaries came under the third tranche, where vendors are eligible for loans of ₹50,000. A total of 2,067 vendors received loans under this category, accounting for Rs

10.30 crore in disbursements.

The PM SVANidhi scheme allows street vendors to secure higher loan amounts based on timely repayment of earlier loans. The maximum cumulative assistance available under the scheme is ₹90,000 across the three tranches.

According to the civic body, in the previous financial year (2025-26), banks had disbursed loans worth ₹61.89 crore to 21,955 beneficiaries in Delhi. During that period, 3,762 vendors received first-tranche loans amounting to ₹5.28 crore, while 13,226 beneficiaries availed second-tranche loans worth ₹31.82 crore.

BJP's strength in MCD rises to 139 as 16 IVP councillors join party

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Friday bolstered its position in the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) after all 16 councillors of the Indraprastha Vikas Party (IVP), a breakaway faction of the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), merged with the saffron party. The councillors joined the BJP in the presence of Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra at the party headquarters.

With the merger, the BJP's strength in the 250-member

MCD has gone up to 139, while the AAP's tally now stands at 102.

The BJP had won 104 seats in the 2022 civic polls, but it has steadily increased its numbers through defections.

Welcoming the IVP councillors, Gupta said they had taken the decision keeping Delhi's development in mind.

"It is a good signal that will speed up development in their wards," she told a press conference.

"Development of the city is the top priority of the BJP government. The joining of the IVP councillors will further strengthen the BJP in



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, BJP MP Harsh Malhotra, Indraprastha Vikas Party (IVP) founder Mukesh Goyal and others during a press conference at the Delhi BJP state office in New Delhi

the Municipal Corporation of Delhi and boost civic work in their municipal wards," she said.

Malhotra said the IVP was formed around one-and-a-half years ago by councillors led by Mukesh Goel and

Hemchand Goel after they witnessed a "lack of development" under the AAP-led civic administration.

He said all 16 IVP councillors formally joined the BJP and took its membership.

Speaking to media, IVP president Mukesh Goel said the decision to join the BJP was taken after deliberations amongst the councillors this week.

"We have watched BJP's work for one and a half years, and we collectively think that joining the ruling party will help speed up the developmental work in our respective wards," Goel said.

Roaring success: Delhi zoo welcomes 3 Asiatic lion cubs in rare repeat breeding

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Fresh roars are set to echo through the Delhi zoo as Asiatic lioness Mahagauri has given birth to three cubs, adding a fresh chapter to the zoo's conservation efforts and marking a rare repeat breeding success after her earlier litter of five cubs last year, of which two survived.

The three Asiatic lion cubs were born on Tuesday at the National Zoological Park to the breeding pair of Mahagauri and Maheshwar. The newborns are currently

kept with their mother in a secure maternity enclosure, zoo Director Sanjeet Kumar said.

The official said the cubs are being provided a calm and undisturbed environment crucial for their early development, with veterinary and animal care teams monitoring their health through CCTV surveillance and regular observation.

The successful breeding of Mahagauri and Maheshwar is considered significant as the pair had earlier produced two healthy cubs — Kartik and Karni — on

April 27, 2025.

Mahagauri became the first lioness at the Delhi zoo since 2009 to conceive again within around a year of giving birth, a rare occurrence in the facility's recent breeding history, Kumar said.

According to him, lion breeding at the zoo remained stable until 2009, with cubs born every few years. However, the programme witnessed a sharp decline thereafter, with births becoming increasingly infrequent and nearly coming to a standstill at one point.

By 2021, Sundaram, a lion



A CCTV image released by the National Zoological Park shows Asiatic lioness Mahagauri with her three newborn cubs inside the zoo's maternity enclosure in New Delhi

born at the zoo in 2009, was the only Asiatic lion left at the facility. Now 17 years old, Sundaram's ageing prompted the authorities to look for new breeding stock to revive the Asiatic lion population.

As part of the revival plan, the zoo brought one male and two female lions — Maheshwar, Mahagauri and Shailja — from Junagadh in Gujarat in 2021.

The trio, born in 2020, was expected to strengthen Delhi zoo's breeding programme, Kumar said.

However, the plan suffered a setback after Shailja

sustained a serious injury while moving around her enclosure. She later developed a paralysis-like condition in her hind limbs, affecting her ability to breed, the official said.

With Shailja unable to contribute to the breeding efforts, the responsibility of expanding the zoo's Asiatic lion population rested largely on Mahagauri and Maheshwar.

Their first successful breeding resulted in the birth of five cubs on April 27, 2025.

The first litter also highlighted the challenges asso-

ciated with lion breeding, as three cubs died shortly after birth due to developmental issues. The remaining two survived after veterinarians provided artificial cat milk when Mahagauri was unable to nurse them, Kumar said.

The National Zoological Park currently houses six Asiatic lions, including three males — Sundaram, Maheshwar and Kartik — and three females — Mahagauri, Shailja and Karni.

The latest births are expected to further strengthen the conservation efforts for the endangered species.

IN FOCUS



A view of the swollen Beas River after its water level rose following heavy rainfall in Kullu, Himachal Pradesh on Friday

Catholic body urges HM to withdraw FCRA Bill

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Catholic Bishops' Conference of India (CBCI) on Friday urged Home Minister Amit Shah to withdraw the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 and the recently notified rules, stressing that both be redrafted after wider consultation with stakeholders.

The CBCI submitted a memorandum to Shah, raising concerns over the proposed FCRA Bill, 2026, religious freedom, the rights of Scheduled Caste (SC) Christians and the humanitarian crisis in Manipur. The memorandum, signed by CBCI president Cardinal Anthony Poola and CBCI secretary general Archbishop Anil Couto, was handed to Shah when the delegation met him here.

The CBCI expressed concern over the proposed amendments to the FCRA

and said some of the proposed provisions could affect charitable institutions that have served poor and vulnerable communities for decades.

The Conference urged the Government to withdraw the proposed Amendment Bill and the recently notified Rules. It requested that both be redrafted after wider consultation with stakeholders, a CBCI statement said.

It said any changes to the law should apply only in the future. They should not affect existing rights, legally acquired assets or ongoing charitable work.

It called for independent judicial oversight in FCRA cases. It also sought safeguards before the government can take over or transfer the assets of an institution. The memorandum said there should be a clear distinction between minor procedural lapses and serious offences. It said charitable



assets should continue to be used according to the intentions of donors. The memorandum also raised concerns over various state freedom of religion Acts. It alleged that there was a continued denial of SC status to Christians and other religious minorities of SC origin under the Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950.

Noting that these matters are pending before the Supreme Court, the CBCI appealed for an early hearing and final judgment.

It said the delay continues to affect the dignity, equality and constitutional rights of millions of citizens and creates uncertainty among minority communities.

The CBCI also highlighted the continuing humanitarian crisis in Manipur and said thousands of farming families have lost their livelihoods. Many students have faced disruption to their education, while several families have left the state in search of safety, education and employment, the CBCI

said. The Conference appealed to the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) to take urgent steps to restore lasting peace, communal harmony and normalcy in Manipur. It also reaffirmed the Church's willingness to work with the government in promoting reconciliation, humanitarian assistance and social healing.

Congress general secretary KC Venugopal attacked the BJP over the issue after the CBCI submitted its memorandum. "In typical BJP fashion, HM Amit Shah has lied to the CBCI about FCRA and is wrongly deflecting blame to hide his Government's culpability in weaponising the FCRA laws. In reality, the Modi Government has been hell bent on using the FCRA to harass vocal civil society organisations and minority-run institutions and take over their properties," Venugopal said on X.

In 2020, they severely

tightened FCRA rules to increase the time period for which organisations can be suspended, gave greater powers to the Centre to scrutinise them, and even limited their administrative expenses, essentially crippling them from carrying out their routine activities, the Congress leader alleged.

"In 2026, first they sought to amend the FCRA legislation to give the Centre powers to seize properties of recipient organisations and also brought in provisions of 'deemed cessation' of licences. After widespread Opposition, they withdrew these amendments only to re-introduce them through the backdoor as delegated legislation," he said.

In these new rules, they are also preventing organisations from changing their scope of work or geography, and bringing in ideological scrutiny to disallow those who oppose them, he claimed.

Human-wildlife conflict tops conservation challenges: Bhupender Yadav

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Human-wildlife conflict has emerged as one of India's foremost conservation challenges, Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav said on Friday, stressing the need to utilise modern technology to deal with the issue. The minister made the remarks at the inauguration of the Centre of Excellence (CoE) on Human-Wildlife Conflict at Coimbatore.

The inauguration was followed by a National Workshop on Human-Wildlife Conflict, bringing together senior policymakers, forest managers, scientists, researchers, technology experts and conservation practitioners from across the country, to deliberate on effective strategies for curbing hostilities between humans and wildlife.

"Human-wildlife conflict has emerged as one of India's foremost conservation and development challenges due to increasing interactions between people and wildlife resulting from habitat fragmentation, changing land-use patterns and expanding human activities. Our approach should be solution-oriented... utilising modern technological advances," Yadav noted.

The minister expressed confidence that the newly-established CoE would formulate a strategy to curb instances of human conflict with tigers, leopards and elephants. He said awareness-creation must be carried out in mission mode, in both urban and rural areas, on dealing with human-wildlife encounters. "The approach needs to involve area-specific as well as species-specific



measures to address human-wildlife conflict. This would go a long way in addressing the panic in society."

Yadav also urged forest departments across the country to take proactive preventive measures to mitigate the impact of human actions, establishments and

crops on the environment and wildlife.

"This must be done by addressing the issues in coordinated manner with the respective communities, through multi-stakeholders consultations. Innovative best practices must be evolved and implemented widely on

ground, by using the latest technologies in wildlife conservation. Coexistence and harmony, instead of conflict, should be the mantra of ecological sustainability," the minister asserted.

During the event, Union Minister of State for Environment Kirti Vardhan Singh highlighted that effective wildlife conservation has led to increasing instances of human-wildlife interaction.

"This has resulted in a much larger socio-economic issue, besides being a conservation issue, affecting livelihoods in the long term. There is a need to find long-term solutions by balancing wildlife conservation and socio-economic progress of the country," he said.

He expressed hope that the CoE would have an important role over this issue, through capacity building of

officials as well as the community. "It would go a long way in using advanced technologies in documenting data, while preserving traditional knowledge in wildlife conservation and peaceful human-wildlife coexistence," Singh said.

On the occasion, Yadav launched the National Human-Wildlife Conflict Portal, a digital platform designed to facilitate data management, knowledge sharing and decision support for mitigation of such instances across the country.

The first edition of a series of publications titled 'Current Status of Human-Wildlife Conflict in India: An Overview' was also released, providing a comprehensive assessment of the current status, trends and emerging challenges related to human-wildlife conflict in India.

DGCA warns IndiGo over dangerous goods lapses

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Aviation watchdog DGCA has issued a warning letter to IndiGo for lapses with respect to certain provisions related to the handling of dangerous goods, according to a regulatory filing. In this regard, a warning letter has been issued to the airline by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA).

"The letter relates to the spillage of cargo detected on the ground post-arrival of the flight, reported in January 2026, and the subsequent audit findings regarding deviations from standard operating procedures (SOPs) with certain provisions under the Aircraft (Carriage of Dangerous

Goods) Rules, 2026," the filing said on Friday. However, specific details were not disclosed.

Strict norms are in place for the handling and carriage of dangerous goods in aircraft. InterGlobe Aviation, the parent of IndiGo, in the filing said that as directed by DGCA, the company is required to submit an action taken report on the corrective actions undertaken in this regard. The airline said there is a significant impact on its financials, operations, or other activities.

"The delay in disclosure was unintentional and was caused due to a delay in internal communication of details pertaining to receipt of the aforementioned letter," it added.

Mystery strikes hit Iran after US mission ends

Gulf Arab States, which repeatedly have been targeted by Iran since the war began February 28, did not immediately respond to requests for comment Friday over the strikes. The attacks come as they and the US insist the Strait of Hormuz, a vital waterway for world energy markets, must be open and free to ships.

Iran says the strait must now be under its sole control and that vessels should begin to pay fees to Tehran - even though the world for decades has considered it an international waterway. About a fifth of all oil and natural gas transited the strait before the war began.

Iran's grip on the strait during the conflict led to a global energy crisis, though oil prices have sharply dropped since wartime highs of \$ 120 a barrel. Israel, which took part in the Iran war, also has not claimed any recent attacks on Iran.

The US military's Central Command said Thursday around 6:30 am local Iran time that it had concluded a round of strikes that saw some 90 targets hit. Shortly after that, Iranian news outlets and state media reported a series of airstrikes and explosions targeting the country's Bushehr and Sistan and Baluchestan provinces, the cities of Ahvaz and Chabahar and other areas.

A US defence official, speaking on condition of anonymity to discuss operational details of the American military campaign, said there had been no new US strikes since the last round ended Thursday morning.

Iran responded to the strikes Thursday by launching a wider volley of attacks across the Mideast, targeting Bahrain, Jordan, Kuwait and Qatar. Missile alert sirens sounded in the four countries, sending people to seek shelter. One person was reportedly hurt in Kuwait as air defence systems targeted the incoming fire across the region. The leader of the UAE, Sheikh Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, travelled to Kuwait immediately after the Iranian attack for a meeting with the small, oil-rich nation's ruling emir. Gulf Arab countries also held calls with Qatar's foreign minister, who has been deeply involved along with Pakistan in mediating talks between Iran and the US over the interim deal now in place to halt the return of open warfare.

During the Iran war, there also were a series of unclaimed airstrikes. Officials later said both Saudi Arabia and the UAE launched airstrikes on Iran, after Tehran struck energy sites in their countries. Launching a Gulf country again strike Iran likely could be an effort to deter Tehran from targeting the Gulf states again.

Israel, which under Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has engaged in an intense campaign against Iran, has not attacked the Islamic Republic since June. In most cases, Israel immediately claims its attacks on Iran.

Israel's Government said Netanyahu spoke with US President Donald Trump on Thursday night, with Trump updating Netanyahu "on American moves in the Gulf."

Israel Katz, Israel's defence minister, also renewed threats that his nation stood ready to confront Iran if needed.

The Israeli military "is on alert and ready to renew the campaign, to reestablish aerial superiority, and to carry out a blue-white (Israeli) strike in Iran to remove threats, even for a third time," Katz told a military ceremony. "If we will have

to return, we will return with even greater force."

On Friday, Iranian state media quoted Esmail Kousari, a member of the Iranian parliament's national security committee and a former commander in the paramilitary Revolutionary Guard, as warning the UAE would "pay the price for its cooperation with the United States." He accused the Emirates of having a "behind-the-scenes" role in the recent US attacks.

Iran repeatedly accused Gulf Arab states of actively supporting the US war effort, something they denied during the war. The US since the 1991 Gulf War has maintained a broad footprint of military bases across the Gulf Arab states, including in Bahrain, which is home to the US Navy's 5th Fleet headquarters.

Meanwhile, Iran insists it must be the sole controller of the Strait of Hormuz. But the US is continuing to urge mariners to travel on a southern route through Oman's territorial waters to avoid Iran. The Joint Maritime Information Centre, a multinational body overseen by the US Navy, issued a new advisory Friday urging ships to travel that route. A similar message for ships to use that route sparked an Iranian attack on Tuesday that saw three vessels hit.

"Notwithstanding recent unprovoked attacks on merchant vessels, mariners are reminded that the southern route of the (strait) has been expanded and remains available for all traffic," the maritime centre said. (AP)

Mahadev Online Book trail leads ED...

After prices rose, the holdings were reportedly sold, restructured, or used to finance deals, allegedly resulting in profits at the expense of retail investors. Around 23,000 investors in Eraaya Lifespaces were directly affected.

The ED has informed the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) of these suspected manipulations and has requested a detailed investigation into share-price irregularities involving Garg's companies. SEBI is running its own investigations and has already taken regulatory action against Garg and his family, including orders for takeover code disclosure violations. The regulator is also looking into the Eraaya-Ebix deal for possible stock manipulation or other problems.

If the latest attachment, dated June 5, is confirmed by the Adjudicating Authority under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), it will become permanent and allow the ED to take further steps to take possession. The latest attachment covers movable assets, including equity shares and other securities, valued at Rs 893.03 crore, as well as immovable properties valued at ₹47.73 crore. The total value of properties attached, seized, or frozen in the Mahadev Online Book and Skyexchange money laundering case is now about ₹3,800 crore. The largest part is 12.84 lakh shares of Eraaya Lifespaces Ltd, which make up a 64.20 per cent stake in the US-based Ebix Inc. Eraaya Lifespaces bought this stake for about ₹765.77 crore. Other shareholders add to the total value of movable assets.

The immovable assets include luxury apartments in Delhi, Garg's home in Punjabi Bagh, commercial properties in the Safdarjung Development Scheme, a property on Babar Road, and an apartment on Shivaji Marg, including one held under Vikas Garg HUF. There are also

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properties in Goa, Uttarakhand (including Nainital), Rajasthan, and Dehradun. Authorities allege that these assets are proceeds of crime or were bought with laundered money from illegal betting.

The current attachment of assets linked to Garg is one of the biggest single-entity actions in this investigation so far. The Adjudicating Authority will now review the ED's complaint. If the attachment is confirmed, it would be a major step toward possible confiscation. The investigation is still ongoing as authorities continue to track the full path of betting proceeds and how they were allegedly used across companies and markets.

Govt defends E20, claims benefits outweigh...

On pricing, the ministry said E20 is not necessarily cheaper than conventional petrol because ethanol procurement prices are fixed at remunerative levels to support farmers and can exceed the cost of petrol when international crude prices are relatively low.

It said the programme's objective was to reduce India's dependence on imported crude, improve price stability and strengthen energy security rather than lower pump prices.

According to the ministry, the ethanol blending programme has saved more than Rs 1.97 lakh crore in foreign exchange, displaced nearly 316 lakh tonnes of crude oil imports, reduced around 952 lakh tonnes of carbon dioxide emissions and transferred over Rs 1.66 lakh crore to farmers since the 2014-15 ethanol supply year.

The ministry urged consumers not to be influenced by misinformation regarding E20, saying the fuel had been validated by vehicle manufacturers, testing agencies, oil marketing companies and regulators before its nationwide adoption. On the often asked query about option to choose between pure petrol and E10 and E20, the Government said maintaining separate nationwide fuel supply chains would be impractical. The Government said operating parallel distribution systems for pure petrol, E10 and E20 across more than one lakh fuel stations, depots, terminals and pipelines would create significant logistical challenges. It also points to nearly Rs 1 lakh crore invested in ethanol production infrastructure, saying the policy balances consumer convenience with energy security and national investments.

Ram Temple counting team quits

Staff also said they now have to count money on the floor rather than at tables and chairs, making the work more physically demanding.

Security at the centre has become much stricter. Staff are now frisked several times before entering, must go in barefoot, and cannot bring mobile phones or personal items inside. These changes are part of efforts to fix problems found during the investigation.

The staff submitted their resignations, along with a memorandum, to the SBI Tulsi Udayan branch, which oversees the counting process, and to the security agency. Their demands for addressing workload and compensation issues

went unanswered, sources added.

The large number of resignations has caused immediate problems for the Trust, which runs one of India's busiest religious sites. Daily donations from people across India and abroad are vital for the temple's upkeep and activities. With fewer staff, counting the large number of offerings, which now include more small-denomination notes, has become much slower.

The Trust is likely to start hiring new staff soon. However, new hires will undergo strict background checks implemented after the recent problems. The Trust will also discuss bigger changes to how donations, security, and darshan are managed at a meeting on July 22. The Supreme Court will hear related petitions on July 13 that call for further investigations into how donations are handled.

HC upholds Rajpal Yadav conviction

In the 108-page verdict, Justice Sharma observed that Yadav repeatedly failed to honour his undertakings on making payment to the complainant, M/s Murali Projects Pvt Ltd, and while the court made "earnest efforts" to facilitate an amicable resolution in the matter, the actor ultimately categorically refused to make any further payment.

"What is even more significant is that, on the date when the hearing in the present petitions concluded, petitioner No. 1 (Yadav) stated before this court that 'he was not willing to pay any amount to the complainant and would rather go to jail five times than return the money'," the court noted in the judgement.

"In case a litigant wishes to choose the path of imprisonment rather than abiding by multiple undertakings given by him in the court, it is entirely his choice. Law is not a script that can be rewritten at the will of an actor, nor can legal positions be altered with every change of strategy, whosoever the litigant may be," the court observed. The court rejected Yadav's plea seeking release on probation and held that there was no infirmity in the lower court's order of sentence.

"Petitioner No. 1 (convict No. 2), Rajpal Naurang Yadav, is sentenced to undergo simple imprisonment for a period of three months in each of the seven complaint cases and to pay a fine of ₹1.05 crore in each case. In default of payment of the fine, he shall undergo simple imprisonment for a further period of six months," the court ordered. It said that out of the fine amount, ₹ 1.04 crore shall be given to the complainant and ₹25,000 to the state in each case.

The court also ordered the actor's wife, Radha Rajpal Yadav, to pay around ₹5.5 lakh as fine to the complainant in each case.

In default of payment of fine, she shall undergo simple imprisonment for a period of three months, it added.

The complainant alleged that in 2013, Yadav tendered seven cheques of ₹1.05 crore each towards settlement of financial assistance of Rs 5 crore to him for a film in 2010, which were dishonoured. According to the complainant, as per an agreement between the parties in 2012, Yadav, his wife and their company had agreed to repay around ₹11 crore, including interest.

The court's verdict came on revision petitions filed by Yadav and his wife challenging the 2019 decision of a sessions court, which upheld their conviction by a magisterial court in the

cheque-bounce cases in April 2018. The magisterial court had sentenced the actor to six months' imprisonment, which was subsequently reduced to three months.

Yadav sought to justify the delay of more than five years in filing the revision petitions by claiming that he received incorrect legal advice by his earlier lawyer and that he "believed" the conviction had already been challenged.

Rejecting the assertion, the court said that Yadav was an accomplished actor, who possessed sufficient means and resources and had throughout been represented by experienced and eminent members of the Bar.

"In such circumstances, the plea that the petitioners remained under a misconception for more than five years, and believed that they had challenged their conviction as well, despite them actively pursuing legal proceedings before different courts and engaging several counsels during this period, cannot be accepted," the court said. "The applications seeking condonation of delay are dismissed. As a sequitur thereto, the revision petitions are also dismissed," it concluded. In June 2024, the high court temporarily suspended Yadav's conviction, subject to him adopting "sincere and genuine measures" to explore the possibility of reaching an amicable settlement with the opposite party.

At that time, Yadav's counsel had said that there was a genuine transaction to finance the production of a movie, which bombed at the Box Office, resulting in huge financial losses to the actor. However, on February 2, the court asked Yadav to surrender on February 4, observing that he repeatedly breached his undertakings to the court to repay the amount.

On February 16, the court suspended his sentence for the time being and permitted him to be released from jail after he deposited ₹1.5 crore in the bank account of the complainant.

Four gangsters killed in Gurugram encounter

The injured gang member, Shivam from Kota Bisar in Nuh district, and the three wounded police officers were taken to the hospital.

Four gang members were declared dead on arrival. Three of the dead, Aryan, Nitin, and Ankit, were from Rohtak, and the fourth, Sandeep alias Deepa, was from Fatehabad.

Police said targeting a high-profile businessman like Berry is part of a pattern. Nandal's network targets builders, property dealers, and other High Net Worth Individuals in the National Capital Region. The investigation is ongoing and focuses on the gang's local connections, any earlier threats to Berry, and whether there is a larger conspiracy. Nandal, one of Haryana's most wanted gangsters, began his career in the Haryana music scene before turning to crime. Nandal reportedly left India around 2023 after being named in criminal cases. He is believed to run his operations from abroad, using social media, encrypted calls, and local shooters.

His group is involved in extortion, contract killings, and arms smuggling in Gurugram and the NCR. The incident in Sushant Lok on July 9 and 10 followed a familiar pattern: the gang arrived armed, created fear by shooting or taking hostages, demanded large sums of money, and then either escaped or claimed responsibility online.

States Focus



VANDE MATARAM MADE LOVE FOR NATION A DUTY: VP

Vande Mataram transformed love for the motherland into a sacred national duty, inspiring generations of freedom fighters with courage, sacrifice and hope, said Vice President CP Radhakrishnan on Friday. He was virtually addressing the inauguration of Permanent Exhibition on Journey of Vande Mataram and the International Seminar on 'Sardar Patel's Vision: Integration, Unification and Federalism', organised by the Indian Institute of Advanced Study (IIAS), Shimla. The VP said that the nation was commemorating two historic milestones – the 150th anniversary of the national song Vande Mataram and the 150th birth anniversary of Sardar Patel. He remarked that such occasions provide an opportunity not merely to remember history but to reconnect with its soul. (PTI)



MANIPUR HOME MINISTER HOLDS SECURITY MEET WITH CRPF CHIEF

Manipur Home Minister Govindas Konhoujam on Friday said he held a "productive discussion" on the prevailing security situation in the State with a team of senior CRPF officers led by Director General Gyanendra Pratap Singh. The meeting was held on Thursday evening, days after two Assam Rifles personnel were killed in an attack by suspected militants in Ukhrul district. In a post on X, Konhoujam said, "It was a pleasure to meet Gyanendra Pratap Singh, DG CRPF, along with Vitul Kumar, SDG (Ops), Raja Shrivastava, SDG (NEZ), RN Das, IGP (Manipur & Nagaland Sector), and SK Singh, DIG, SSO to DG, CRPF." The minister said they "held a productive discussion on the prevailing security situation in Manipur" and reaffirmed their "shared commitment to strengthening coordination, enhancing operational preparedness, and ensuring lasting peace and security in the State." He also appreciated the dedication and invaluable service of the CRPF in safeguarding the nation and protecting the people of Manipur. "Together, we remain committed to a secure, stable, and peaceful Manipur," he added. (PTI)

Gujarat Govt launches massive relief drive in flood-hit Surat

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Surat

The Gujarat Government has launched a large-scale relief and restoration drive in Surat following widespread flooding after heavy rains, State officials said on Friday. In the 24-hour period ending Wednesday morning, Surat was battered by 358 mm of rainfall, which created a flood-like situation around the creek areas of the city. "In response to the severe rainfall and flooding that affected Surat and surrounding areas, the Gujarat Government, under the guidance of Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel, has launched a large-scale relief and restoration drive on a war footing to restore normalcy in record time," an official release stated. Keeping in view the critical situation after the floodwaters receded, Deputy CM Harsh Sanghavi chaired an emergency high-level review meeting late on Thursday



night at the Surat Collector's Office, the release said. The meeting was attended by all district coordination officers, senior officials of the Surat Municipal Corporation, and the district administration to review relief and rehabilitation work in detail, it added. "During the meeting, the Deputy Chief Minister prioritised three works, including rapid drainage of accumulated floodwater, intensive cleanliness and sanitation drives and protection of

public health. He instructed officials to ensure all flood-affected shops, businesses, and normal public life are restored within the next 48 to 72 hours without any delay," the release noted. According to the Government, a door-to-door survey of approximately 9,100 families has been completed, and over 800 affected families received assistance of ₹6,800 each as household goods assistance and cash relief directly in person. Separate teams have been

deployed to ensure all remaining eligible families receive this assistance by Friday night, the release stated. If any locality or housing society has been left out of the survey due to technical reasons, a special officer has been appointed at the Collector's Office, officials said. A dedicated helpline has been made operational. Upon receiving a call from citizens, survey teams will be dispatched immediately to conduct the assessment, they added. "Under the leadership of the Chief Minister, the entire State administration, district authorities, and Surat Municipal Corporation are working day and night to ensure the safety and well-being of the people. Surat will soon recover and once again stand strong as one of the country's leading engines of economic growth," the release quoted Sanghavi as saying.

NIA arrests two over killing of 6 Nagas in Manipur

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Imphal

A team of security officials led by the National Investigation Agency arrested two persons from Manipur's Kangpokpi district on Friday morning for their alleged involvement in the killing of six Naga civilians, police said. According to them, the operation was carried out by a joint team of Manipur Police, NIA and CRPF based on credible inputs. They launched the operation at Leilon Vaiphei in the early hours of Friday to apprehend two accused who were allegedly involved in the killing of six Naga persons on May 13 in the same village. Police said that a woman, Ayingbi, and another person, Pradip, were apprehended



from the Kuki-Zo village. The bodies of six Naga civilians were recovered from the vicinity of Leilon Vaiphei village on June 10, triggering protests by Naga and Meitei communities demanding the arrest of the perpetrators. Naga groups had also blocked all routes to Kangpokpi district, leading to a massive surge in the prices

of essential commodities in the Kuki-Zo majority district. Days after the bodies were found, Kuki Zo Council (KZC) chairman Henliethang Thanglet apologised for the incident and called for an impartial investigation into all acts of violence linked to the ongoing ethnic strife in Manipur. "I admit the Kuki-Zo people

made a grave mistake in killing the six Naga civilians. It was done out of emotion. I strongly condemn it. I am very sorry and apologise on behalf of my people," he had told a press conference. However, a day later, KZC stated that certain portions of Thanglet's remarks had been "misconstrued as an admission of responsibility by the Kuki-Zo community". It stated that the chairperson's expression of sorrow was made purely in the spirit of humanity, compassion, and moral responsibility and "was not intended to assign collective guilt". The clarification came as an influential Naga students' organisation expressed anger at the apology issued by the KZC chief over the killing of six Naga hostages in the State.

Odisha transfers over ₹20,648 cr to 1 cr women under Subhadra Yojana



Odisha Deputy Chief Minister Pravatī Parida

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bhubaneswar

The Odisha Government has transferred over ₹20,648 crore to more than one crore women beneficiaries of Subhadra Yojana in four instalments, while the fifth tranche will be released on the upcoming 'Rakhi Purnima' (Raksha Bandhan) in August, officials said on Friday.

Ahead of the disbursement of the fifth instalment of money (₹5,000 per beneficiary), Deputy Chief Minister Pravatī Parida on Friday reviewed the preparedness and directed concerned officers to complete field verification of pending applicants by July 25. She also directed that the progress of these cases be reviewed daily to ensure timely completion of the process ahead of the fifth instalment. Speaking to media persons, Parida, who is in charge of the Women and Child Development Department, said applications of about 3.53 lakh women are pending field verification. The block-level committees under the Subhadra scheme will approve the findings of field-level officials and forward them to the district and then to the State Government. Accordingly, those found eligible would receive the fifth instalment, she said, adding that the exercise will be completed by July 25.

Several applications are also pending at various stages, including e-KYC, bank account verification, and biometrics. Concerned applicants should complete these as soon as possible to reap the scheme's benefits, Parida said. According to officials, a total of 1.15 crore applications have been registered under the Subhadra Yojana so far. Of these, 3.17 lakh new applications were received during the financial year 2026-27. Following scrutiny and eligibility assessment, 1.02 crore women were initially identified as potential beneficiaries for the fifth instalment, they said. After verification by district administrations confirmed the deaths of 5,277 beneficiaries, the final list of 1.01 crore eligible beneficiaries has been prepared for the fifth instalment as of now, the officials said. During the meeting, Parida reviewed the progress of key preparatory activities, including Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) activation, biometric e-KYC, field enquiries, NPCI mapping, payment file preparation and coordination with banks. The deputy chief minister emphasised the need for expeditious disposal of pending cases and called for close coordination among all stakeholders to complete the necessary processes within the stipulated timeline.

MP to make TET sole exam for teacher recruitment



GIRISH SHARMA
■ Bhopal

The Madhya Pradesh Government is preparing to introduce a significant change in its teacher recruitment process by doing away with the teacher selection examination and making the Teacher Eligibility Test (TET) the sole qualifying examination for appointments in Government schools. The School Education Department has finalised a proposal in this regard and is expected to issue a formal notification after obtaining the State Government's approval. If implemented, the move would mark one of the most substantial reforms in teacher recruitment in the State in recent years. Under the existing system, aspiring teachers are required to first qualify the Teacher Eligibility Test and subsequently appear for a separate teacher selection examination before becoming eligible for appointment. The proposed framework seeks to eliminate this second stage, allowing recruitment to be conducted directly from among candidates who have cleared the eligibility examination. Officials believe the change will streamline the recruitment process, reduce procedural delays and enable the Government to fill thousands of vacant teaching posts more quickly. The proposal is also aimed at easing the financial and logistical burden on candi-

dates, who currently have to prepare for and appear in multiple examinations before securing employment. According to the proposal, recruitment to Government schools will continue to be carried out through a merit-based process, with candidates selected from the pool of those who have qualified the eligibility examination. The department is also considering provisions to ensure that candidates who have already cleared earlier eligibility examinations are not disadvantaged under the new system. The reform comes against the backdrop of persistent teacher shortages in Government schools and repeated demands from aspirants to simplify the recruitment mechanism. Officials expect that reducing the number of examinations will shorten the recruitment cycle and improve the availability of qualified teachers in classrooms. The proposal also seeks to bring greater clarity to the distinction between an eligibility examination, which certifies a candidate's minimum qualification to teach, and the recruitment process, which determines appointments based on merit and notified vacancies. The proposed changes are expected to apply only to recruitment in Government schools. For

private schools, qualifying the Teacher Eligibility Test will continue to remain a mandatory requirement for appointment, in accordance with existing norms. The proposal has not yet received final approval. The revised recruitment framework will come into effect only after the State Government formally clears the proposal and issues the necessary notification.

CM Vijay spreading false propaganda in Karur, alleges DMK

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chennai

Senior DMK leader TKS Elangovan on Friday launched a scathing attack on Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay, accusing him of spreading "false propaganda" in Karur and treating the public like "fools". CM Vijay visited Karur for the first time on Friday after the tragic stampede incident that claimed 41 lives while he was campaigning there on September 27, 2025. Addressing a press



conference, Elangovan blamed Vijay's delayed arrival for the tragic situation where several people fainted due to extreme heat, lack of food, and water. Elangovan stated that Vijay was scheduled to speak at noon but failed to arrive until 7.30 pm, forcing people to wait for hours under the scorching sun. He dismissed Vijay's explanation of being held up by crowds along the way as a "big lie". "Any person with basic knowledge understands that if people are left without food and water in intense heat, they will faint.



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NIA chargesheets 6 Hurriyat leaders in 1996 case

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

On Friday, the National Investigation Agency (NIA) filed a chargesheet in the NIA Special Court in Jammu against six senior leaders of the All Parties Hurriyat Conference. They are accused of being involved in mob violence and firing at police officers in Srinagar in 1996. The chargesheet lists Shabir Ahmad Shah, Syed Ali Shah Geelani, Abdul Ganie Lone, Mohd Yaqoob Wakeel (also called Mohd Yaqoob Vakil), Javid Ahmad Mir, and Shakeel Ahmad Bakshi. They are charged with criminal conspiracy, attempted murder, rioting, and assaulting public

servants under the Ranbir Penal Code, 1989, and Section 13 of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967. Syed Ali Shah Geelani, Abdul Ganie Lone, and Mohd Yaqoob Wakeel have passed away. Charges against them have been dropped, but the NIA has still recorded their alleged roles in the incident. The case is about events on July 17, 1996, when a large crowd, said to be led by Hurriyat leaders, carried the body of militant Hilal Ahmad Beigh from Parimpora to Eidgah in Srinagar for burial. At Naaz Crossing, police from Shergarhi station tried to control the procession, but violence broke out. The crowd reportedly threw



stones, damaged property, blocked traffic, and shouted slogans like "Hindustan Murdabad." Unidentified militants, said to include Hizbul Mujahideen members in the

crowd, fired at the police with the intent to kill. Several security personnel were hurt. The original FIR was filed at Shergarhi Police Station in Srinagar, and the NIA later took over the investigation. The agency claims that the separatist leaders planned and encouraged the mob, which led to the armed attack on the police. The chargesheet describes the events and details each accused person's role in provoking the crowd. The NIA has also used laws related to unlawful activities. Shabir Ahmad Shah was arrested in April 2026 in connection with this case and remains in custody. Other accused, like Javid Ahmad Mir and Shakeel Ahmad Bakshi, have also faced action as the investigation continues. The All Parties Hurriyat Conference was created in the early 1990s as a group of

separatist political and religious organisations in Jammu and Kashmir. It has always opposed the region joining India's constitutional system. Filing the chargesheet almost thirty years later shows the NIA's ongoing effort to investigate and prosecute cases of past violence and separatist actions in Jammu and Kashmir. The agency says the investigation is still underway and more legal steps may follow. This move brings new focus to the 1996 incident, as other old cases involving separatist leaders are also being looked at again. The NIA Special Court in Jammu will continue with the case based on the chargesheet filed on Friday.

Pradhan orders probe into NCERT legal lapse in HC



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan has ordered a probe into the role of NCERT officials who failed to defend in the high court a decision of "black listing action" against a firm tasked with supplying paper for textbooks, sources said. Bafna Global Venture Private Limited moved the Delhi High Court on June 24, citing the blacklisting order by NCERT issued on June 22, barring it for two years from participating in the procurement process of the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT). While nobody from the NCERT appeared for the high court hearing, the court granted immunity to the firm from coercive action till further orders. The court also restrained the NCERT from invoking over ₹6 crore bank guarantee furnished by the paper supplier. "Taking serious note of reports that NCERT failed to effectively defend its decision to blacklist a paper supplier before the Delhi High Court, Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan has directed strict action

against the officers responsible for the lapse," a source said. "The minister has ordered accountability for the officials who failed to take the necessary legal steps, reinforcing a zero-tolerance approach towards administrative and legal lapses while ensuring greater accountability in textbook production and procurement," the source added. The source further said that the minister, while cracking the whip on officials who have defied the high court directions, ordered for initiating strict legal action against them. "The ministry has asked NCERT to examine how Bafna Global Venture Private Limited was selected despite allegedly not meeting the required conditions, why it subsequently failed to adhere to the paper-supply schedule and how the council's case went unrepresented in court," the source said. The firm argued in the court that the delay in printing of books was because hydrogen peroxide, the bleaching agent for the purpose of manufacturing paper, was not available to the war in Iran. The case is now listed for July 20 in the Delhi High Court.

West Bengal CM gives cops free hand on law and order

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
■ Kolkata

Riots, vandalism and destruction of public property are things of the past as the police have been given a free hand to do what they have been trained to do. That was the stern statement Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari issued during his first visit to Murshidabad after assuming charge. Emerging from an administrative meeting, Adhikari said, "There will be no repetition of incidents that took place at places like Dhulian, Shamsherganj, Rejinagar or Shaktipur... I have told the police that they will not have to wait for permission... I told them, 'Do whatever you have been trained to do and whatever the law permits you to do under the BNS... there will be no compromise on law and order.' The police have also been asked to show no leniency towards the infiltrators. 'No mercy for infiltrators... I told them,' the Chief Minister said. Adhikari was apparently referring to last year's post-Wakf Bill riots in Murshidabad that saw two deaths and hundreds of Hindu families fleeing to neighbouring Malda district. Another ostensible point of reference was the large-scale violence and arson when a number of Railway stations and trains were torched during the anti-CAA agitation a few years ago. "The Government is committed towards strictly maintaining law and order, and there will be no compromise on that issue... so this is a warning to the mischief mongers... no amount of hooliganism will be tolerated," he said, adding the new "Anti-Social Activities Bill (Anti-Goonda Bill) and the Maintenance of Public Order (Amendment) Bill would be implemented from Monday onwards. Adhikari was visiting Murshidabad ahead of the Rejinagar Assembly by-election, where the seat fell vacant after local Aam Janata Unnayan Party MLA Humayun Kabir resigned as an MLA from this seat. He had won from two seats of Bharatpur and Rejinagar. The Chief Minister issued warnings to Kabir, a former TMC leader, against issuing communal statements. Murshidabad is a Muslim-majority district. The Chief Minister, who later addressed a public rally, said within 45 days of his Government coming to power, it had allocated 338 acres of land to the BSF for fencing the international border with Bangladesh. "Out of 368 acres that was the original ask, we have allocated 338 acres to the BSF... the rest will be done soon," the Chief Minister said, adding his Government was taking up the Ganga erosion issue in the area. About ₹2500 crore had been requisitioned from the Centre and the work would begin post-monsoon, he said.



Bengal CM Suwendu Adhikari

Amit Shah, Sonowal review Bureau of Port Security setup

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal on Friday reviewed the status of the Bureau of Port Security (BoPS) establishment. The home minister directed that only licensed private security agencies be assigned port security duties, with deployment limited to personnel trained by the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF). He instructed that training at the Port Security Training Institute (PSTI) begin as soon as possible, utilising the current infrastructure. Shah instructed officials to create a database of all security personnel to be deployed under BoPS. He said all ports under the BoPS framework must have container scanning facilities. The CISF was directed to conduct trial runs of the proposed security arrangements at major ports, including Visakhapatnam, Jawaharlal Nehru, and Mundra. The home minister stated that the Government, under Prime Minister Narendra Modi, remains committed to strengthening coastal security. The Bureau of Port Security (BoPS) is being set up as a statutory body under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways. Headed by a Director



General, BoPS will oversee regulatory and inspection functions for ship and port facility security. Its responsibilities include collecting and analysing security information, with a focus on cybersecurity and protection of IT infrastructure. Shah met with Department of Fisheries officials and directed steps to improve security at fishing harbours and fish landing centres. He instructed wider promotion of the ISRO-developed 'Nabhmitra' app to increase its use among fishermen. Also, the Department of Fisheries is to write to the District Magistrates (DMs) and Superintendents of Police (SPs) of all districts, requesting that they submit to the Central Government a list of

all fish landing centres in their respective districts. He also said that the registration process for fishermen should be simplified and made more accessible. He further directed that the District Superintendents of Police should ensure adequate security arrangements at fish landing centres and that only permanent police personnel are deployed at these facilities. Union Home Secretary, Director of the Intelligence Bureau, Secretary, Border Management, Secretary, Ports, Shipping and Waterways, Secretary, Department of Fisheries, Director General of the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF), and other senior officials attended the meeting.

Union Govt, Bihar agree to accelerate PM Surya Ghar scheme

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Patna/New Delhi

A high-level review meeting on the progress of the renewable energy sector in Bihar, future action plans, and the effective and time-bound implementation of various renewable energy initiatives was held on Thursday in the presence of Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary and Union Minister for New and Renewable Energy Pralhad Joshi. The meeting extensively reviewed the implementation of the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana, PM-KUSUM, Utility-Led Aggregation (ULA),

Floating Solar Projects, Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS), Green Energy Corridor, Small Hydro Power Projects, Solarisation of Government Buildings, and other renewable energy initiatives. During the meeting, Ajay Yadav, IAS, Energy Secretary, Government of Bihar and Chairman-cum-Managing Director, Bihar State Power Holding Company Limited (BSPHCL), made a detailed presentation highlighting the progress, achievements, ongoing initiatives, and future roadmap of renewable energy projects in the State. Appreciating Bihar's innovative Utility-Led Aggregation (ULA) model, Union Minister Pralhad Joshi advised the State Government to expedite the implementation of the approved project. Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary emphasised the need for the timely and effective implementation of the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana, PM-KUSUM, and other renewable energy schemes, directing the department to work in mission mode. Chief Minister also suggested introducing a "Solar Didi" initiative, on the lines of the successful Surya Mitra programme, to encourage



Santosh Kumar Sarangi, Secretary, Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE), Government of India, assured that the Government of India would continue to provide all possible technical, policy, and financial support for expanding renewable energy projects in the State.

greater participation of women in rural areas while promoting awareness about rooftop solar adoption. Bihar Energy Minister Shailesh Kumar alias Bulu Mandal stated that the Government of Bihar, with the support of the Government of India, is rapidly advancing renewable energy initiatives and is committed to fully utilising the State's immense renewable energy potential. Other dignitaries present included Deepak Kumar, IAS, Principal Secretary to the Chief Minister; Pratyaya Amrit, IAS, Chief Secretary, Government of Bihar;

Anupam Kumar, IAS, Joint Secretary, MNRE; Sanjay Kumar Singh, IAS, Secretary to the Chief Minister; Rahul Kumar, IAS, Managing Director, North Bihar Power Distribution Company Limited (NBPDDL); Dr Nawal Kishor Choudhary, IAS, Managing Director, Bihar State Power Transmission Company Limited (BSPTCL); Saurabh Jorwal, IAS, Managing Director, South Bihar Power Distribution Company Limited (SBPDDL); Shri Vishal Raj, IAS, Managing Director, Bihar State Power Generation Company Limited (BSPGCL), along with senior officials from MNRE and the Energy Department.

ED opens FEMA probe against film producer Dharmesh Sangani

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has launched an investigation under the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA) into Mumbai businessman and film producer Dharmesh Narendra Sangani and his company, Kalanee Impex Private Limited. The investigation is looking into claims of undisclosed foreign assets, export proceeds not brought back to India, and suspicious international transactions. Officials said the agency conducted searches on Thursday (July 9) at locations linked to the company and Sangani. The investigation found major issues, such as export proceeds from overseas buyers not being returned to India, a large shareholding in an undisclosed Canadian company, and foreign bank accounts in Canada, the United States, and the United Arab Emirates that were not reported to authorities. ED sources said that export proceeds from some overseas buyers had still not been received despite a long delay. The company reportedly did not receive time extensions from the authorised dealer bank and made no documented attempts to recover the money. Some export proceeds were received from third parties rather than the buyers listed on the export



invoices or shipping bills. During the raids, officials found evidence of undisclosed foreign assets and bank accounts, including a large shareholding in a Canadian company that had not been reported. Sangani owned a large share in a Canadian company that was not disclosed, along with related foreign bank accounts and transactions that were not reported to the authorities. Investigators also found a UAE business entity connected to the case that had not been disclosed. Bank accounts in Canada, the US, and the UAE have been flagged in the investigation. Officials noted that Customs authorities in the United States and the United Kingdom are separately probing certain transactions involving Sangani, and the ED is examining potential FEMA violations arising from those. During the searches, ED officials claimed that Sangani

tried to destroy digital evidence by throwing his mobile phone from the 13th floor of a building. Investigators later recovered the phone and took it as evidence. The ED has filed a complaint with the Mumbai Police against Sangani for destroying evidence. Dharmesh Narendra Sangani is known as an entrepreneur who became a film producer. He is an active director of Kalanee Impex Private Limited, a Mumbai-based company started on December 7, 2011. Other directors are Rajeeva Dharmesh Sangani and Narendra Prabhudas Shangani. Sangani is connected with veteran actor and TV host Shekhar Suman. He co-founded the Shekhar Suman Film Academy (SSFA) and is associated with GBM Studios Private Limited, which operates in film production and training. This is not his first encounter with regulators. In

September 2016, UK Border Force officers seized about 7.4 kg of gold jewellery from him upon his entry into the UK, stating it was under-declared. The ED's action is under FEMA, 1999, which regulates foreign exchange transactions and violations in India. Breaking these rules can lead to penalties up to three times the amount involved, as well as confiscation of assets and other strict measures. The agency has become more active in investigating cross-border financial issues. The investigation into Kalanee Impex continues to raise concerns about export-related foreign exchange violations and the presence of hidden foreign entities and accounts. Customs agencies from the US and UK are also involved, making the case more complex. The investigation is still ongoing. No arrests have been made yet, and officials are focused on collecting more evidence. The ED is still reviewing documents, digital evidence, and financial records found during the searches. This case has attracted attention in both the entertainment and business worlds because of Sangani's connections to the film industry and the Shekhar Suman Film Academy. Sangani and his company could not be reached for comment. A statement from the film academy with which he is affiliated is still pending.

No app can block 1600 series Govt, bank calls: TRAI

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

No app can block phone calls originating from 1600 number series that are meant for communications by regulated entities and the Government to citizens, telecom regulator TRAI said in a statement on Friday. The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) has also clarified that promotional calls originating from 140 number series cannot be tagged or filtered by an app and can only be blocked by the DND registry, which is managed by the regulator. TRAI has also clarified that promotional calls originating from 140 number series cannot be tagged or filtered by an app and can only be blocked by the DND registry. The regulator said that it has mandated the use of 1600 series numbers for service and transaction calls by regulated entities of banking, financial services



"Under the Telecom C o m m e r c i a l Communications Customer Preference Regulation (TCCPR), any tagging, blocking or filtering of the calls originating from 1600 series numbers is not permitted," Trai said. The regulator said that it has mandated the use of 1600 series numbers for service and transaction calls by regulated entities of banking, financial services

and insurance entities regulated by RBI, SEBI, IRDAI and PFRDA to their existing customers and by Government entities for Government-to-citizen communication. The key objective of assigning designated series for these important communications is to make such calls trustworthy for the citizens, the regulator said. On calls starting with the 140 number series, Trai said that it is meant for use by registered telemarketers. "The customers have the right to allow or block promotional calls originating from 140 series numbers from entities of any or all sectors by registering their preference on the Do Not Disturb (DND) registry," TRAI said. The regulator said that a customer who has blocked

any or all sectors from receiving promotional calls on the DND registry will not receive any calls from the 140 series originating from entities of the blocked sectors. "The customer can register his/her DND preference through multiple means, including the TRAI DND App. Any tagging or filtering of calls from 140 series numbers is not allowed except for blocking on the DND registry, as any tagging can mislead a customer who has otherwise allowed receipt of such calls from a sector on the DND registry," TRAI said. The clarification from TRAI implies that customers will not be able to tag calls from numbers starting with 1600 and the 140 number series as spam, fraud, or any other type of call.

Govt clears ₹3,000-cr scheme to save 15,000 sacred groves

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Over 15,000 'sacred groves' across the country will be conserved and restored under a new scheme — 'Aastha Van Sanrakshan Yojana' — which was approved on Friday, officials said. The decision was taken at the 7th Governing Body meeting of the National Compensatory Afforestation



Fund Management & Planning Authority (CAMPa) in Coimbatore, chaired by Union Environment Minister Bhupendra Yadav. "The Governing Body

approved the Aastha Van Sanrakshan Yojana, a new scheme with an initial corpus of ₹3,000 crore over five years (2026-27 to 2030-31) for the conservation and restoration of nearly 15,000 sacred groves across the country, along with a new scheme for landscape restoration, combating land degradation and biodiversity loss, to be supported from the national fund," a senior official said.

'Aastha Vans' refers to sacred groves — small, protected forest patches revered by local communities for their cultural and religious significance. The meeting reviewed the overall performance of CAMPa and considered several new proposals and initiatives aimed at strengthening compensatory afforestation, forest conservation and wildlife protection across the country.

Assam budget revenue neutral, focus on jobs, women empowerment: CM

TONY DAS ■ Guwahati

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Friday termed the State Budget 'revenue neutral', with revenue expenditure, CapEx and revenue receipts balanced.

Addressing a press conference after state Finance Minister Jayanta Malla Baruah presented his maiden Budget in the Assembly, Sarma said the fiscal plan reflects the BJP's 'Sankalp Patra' pledges, with focus on jobs, women empowerment, power, connectivity and agriculture sectors.

"It is a revenue-neutral budget. It means salary, interest, pension, and committed liabilities, which form revenue expenditure, and revenue earnings are balanced... Capital and revenue expenditures, and revenue receipts are at the same pace and balanced," he said. The Chief Minister highlighted that in 2015-16, capital expenditure was ₹2,951 crore, which has increased to ₹29,000 crore this time.

On the tax front, he said, "Barring the green cess, it is a



Assam Chief Minister Himanta Sarma with Finance Minister Jayanta Malla Baruah before presenting Budget in Assembly on Friday

tax-neutral budget. It is in sync with the state's financial health." Green cess has been proposed to discourage industries from continuing pollution-causing actions and encourage sustainable practices, Sarma said.

Highlighting various Budgetary proposals, the chief minister said ₹6,000 crore has been earmarked to implement flagship welfare schemes such as Orunodoi, Nijut Moina.

He further said the state Government was working with Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA) to

develop a ₹1,200-crore semiconductor ecosystem, so that local MSMEs can produce items to meet requirements of such industries.

On the technology front, Sarma said an AI module will be introduced in state Government offices in a phased manner, with four to five departments set to implement it soon.

Asserting his Government's tough stand against criminals and polygamy, the chief minister warned that "Government employees will lose their jobs for polygamy,

and those with criminal antecedents won't get benefits of any schemes."

Baruah on Friday presented a ₹2,85,084 crore Budget for the 2026-27 financial year, proposing to raise the tax exemption limit for small tea growers by four times and cut VAT on piped natural gas by almost 10 percentage points. He also announced continuance of all major schemes rolled out during the last five years, while stating that he aims to cut the Budget deficit to ₹419 crore.

The Budget proposed increasing the tax exemption limit for small tea growers fourfold to ₹10 lakh and raising the subsidy on orthodox and specialty tea by 50 per cent.

Finance Minister also announced a subsidy for export-oriented and premium-quality Assam CTC tea for the first time.

"To provide relief to small tea growers, I propose to enhance the agricultural income tax exemption threshold from ₹2.5 lakh to ₹10 lakh of annual agricultural income," he added.

Omar Abdullah says no permission yet for July 20 protest on J&K Statehood

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu

Even after extending an invitation to a cross-section of political leaders to join a sit-in-protest in the national Capital on July 20, the opening day of Parliament's Monsoon Session, to press the Centre to restore Jammu and Kashmir's statehood, Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Friday said the party is yet to get permission for the protest.

The National Conference has invited 52 leaders of political and religious outfits across the country to join its protest.

Speaking to reporters on the sidelines of an event in Srinagar, the CM said the party is seeking permission for a protest at Jantar Mantar, but alleged that some people were trying to "sabotage" their plan.

Referring to permission granted to the Cockroach Janta Party for the protest, the chief minister said that while the digital outfit received approval within 24 hours, the National Conference had been waiting for the past 4-5 days.

Abdullah also alleged that some people were trying to "sabotage" the NC plan.

"We have been trying for four-five days. Some people are engaged in sabotaging our programme. They have changed their dates and matched them with our dates," he



said, without naming anyone.

The National Conference has extended invitation to all its likeminded parties and their leaders including Congress leaders Sonia Gandhi, Mallikarjun Kharge, and Rahul Gandhi, DMK chief MK Stalin, TMC's Mamata Banerjee, SP's Akhilesh Yadav, BSP's Mayawati, RJD's Lalu Prasad Yadav, NCP's Sharad Pawar, UBT's Uddhav Thackeray, AAP's Arvind Kejriwal, YSR Congress's YS Jagan Mohan Reddy, BRS's K Chandrashekar Rao, AIMIM's Asaduddin Owaisi, and SAD's Sukhbir Singh Badal.

Tamil Nadu chief minister and Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam chief C Joseph Vijay, CPI's D Raja, and Rajya Sabha MP Kapil Sibal have also been invited.

Invitees from Jammu and Kashmir include former CMs Ghulam Nabi Azad, who is the Chairman, Democratic Progressive Azad Party and Mehbooba Mufti — the PDP chief — have been invited along with BJP Jammu and Kashmir president Sat Paul Sharma, Apni Party chief Altaf Bukhari, Peoples Conference chief Sajjad Lone, JKPC chief Tariq Hameed Karra, CPI(M) leader MY Tarigami, MP and chief of Awami Ittehad Party, Engineer Rashid, are among the invitees.

Mirwaiz-e-Kashmir and chief of Muttahida Majlis-e-Ulema (MMU), an amalgam of several religious bodies, Mirwaiz Umar Farooq, and Grand Mufti, Jammu and Kashmir, Mufti Nasir-ul-Islam, have also been invited.

Kill me to silence me, finish my party: Mamata to BJP

SAUGAR SENGUPTA ■ Kolkata

Former Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee on Friday slammed the BJP for planning to silence her and finish her party, saying the BJP will have to kill her to shut her up.

In a video message, Banerjee said, "You have to kill me to silence me ... and you have spared no effort to do so," launching a fierce attack on the Bengal ruling outfit.

Referring to recent attacks on the party leaders she said, "you have attacked Mahua (Moitra), Abhishek (Banerjee) Kalyan (Banerjee)... you have even not spared my house," reminding how "many of our (ministerial) colleagues have been put behind the bar ... they are languishing in jail and sleeping on the floor ... you have paraded some of them with ropes tied around their waist ... things (read eggs) are being thrown at them so that they cannot come out of their houses."

Banerjee's attacks against the BJP came almost in tandem with a statement released by former TMC MP and BJP Rajya Sabha nominee Sushmita Dev. On Friday, justified what she called "political somersault"



saying her reason for quitting the TMC was its getting steeped in corruption and lack of direction.

"Yes I have changed my ideology from today because I could not have continued in a party which is steeped in corruption and there is a lack of direction in its leadership ... While Mamata Banerjee is calling us back Abhishek Banerjee is calling us gaddar (traitors) ... this party has no future it is as good as finished," she said.

Banerjee's statement also came two days after her party men taking part in a rally were allegedly attacked by the BJP men, leaving several persons injured. Her statement also came within hours of the police freezing another four bank accounts of her

party.

Based on complaints lodged by Joynagar MLA of the TMC's breakaway section Biswanath Das the Bidhannagar Police on Friday froze another bank accounts of the former ruling party leading to total number of such frozen accounts to 12.

The development comes a day after the Calcutta High Court appointed a special officer to oversee TMC's bank withdrawal for day-to-day expenses, including legal charges. Das had lodged a formal complaint at the Bidhannagar Cyber Crime Police Station, alleging that party bank accounts contained proceeds from illegal activities, leading to several raids and subsequent freezing of the accounts.

Govt tightens rules on high-alcohol medicinal formulations

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The Centre has withdrawn the licensing exemption for medicinal formulations containing more than 12 per cent of ethyl alcohol and brought them under stricter regulatory oversight, including mandatory licensing and prescription-only sale, to curb misuse and prevent diversion for intoxication, officials said.

Certain medicinal products, including tinctures of cardamom, ginger and other aromatic preparations, have been exempted from licensing requirements under Schedule K of the Drugs Rules, 1945, the ministry said.

Some of these formulations contain high concentrations of ethyl alcohol, in certain cases up to 80-90 per cent volume per volume (v/v), making them susceptible to misuse for intoxication, it said. References were also received from certain state Governments in this regard, the ministry said.

To address this concern, the Government has mandated that all formulations containing more than 12 per cent v/v ethyl alcohol, in quantities exceeding 30 ml, shall no longer be covered



under the exemption provided under Schedule K.

Such products will be required to obtain the requisite licences under the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940, the ministry said.

The amendment also shifts these products to Schedule H1 of the Drugs Rules, 1945, which mandates sale against the prescription of a registered medical practitioner and stricter record-keeping.

"The amendment is expected to strengthen regulatory oversight over those medicinal products containing alcohol, ensuring their supply only through the regulated pharmaceutical supply chain.

"It will significantly reduce the possibility of diversion and misuse while ensuring their continued availability for legitimate

therapeutic use," the ministry said.

The amendments seek to change the part under Schedule K of the Drugs Rules that was misused in certain parts of the country, sources said.

"It allowed certain preparations containing ingredients such as cardamom, ginger and other spices to remain exempt from the prescribed limits on alcohol content. This exemption led to the sale of some products with ethyl alcohol content as high as 80 per cent, despite being marketed as medicinal preparations," a source said. The proposed changes seek to ensure a uniform regulatory framework across all categories of medicines containing ethyl alcohol.

The existing provisions under the Drugs Rules already prescribe alcohol

limits for several traditional systems of medicine.

Under Rule 161, Ayurvedic, Siddha and Unani syrups are permitted to contain a maximum of 16 per cent alcohol. Similarly, Rule 106B limits the alcohol content in Homoeopathic medicines to 12 per cent.

The amendment proposes that medicinal preparations containing more than 12 per cent of ethyl alcohol should no longer be able to claim exemption under Schedule K merely because they contain ingredients such as cardamom, ginger or other spices.

The move is intended to curb misuse of such products while ensuring that genuine medicinal formulations continue to be regulated under the appropriate provisions of the Drugs Rules, sources said.

The initiative is in line with the Government's continued efforts to strengthen the regulatory framework for drugs, promote the rational and responsible use of medicinal products and safeguard public health, the ministry said.

A gazette notification containing the detailed amendments is available on the ministry website.

BJP criticises Rahul Gandhi for skipping student programmes



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The BJP on Friday criticised Congress leader Rahul Gandhi for allegedly "vacationing abroad", describing him as a "non-serious politician" who exploits students only for political purposes.

The ruling party claimed that Gandhi's absence has led to the cancellation of his scheduled student outreach programmes this month. The BJP's remarks came after Gandhi's three scheduled student outreach programmes were reportedly cancelled.

BJP national spokesperson Tuhin Sinha questioned Gandhi's whereabouts, claiming that he has been absent from public events for nearly two weeks.

He further alleged that Gandhi is "completely immersed in vacationing" and has chosen holidays over political engagements.

"It is absolutely shocking that Rahul Gandhi has cancelled three of his scheduled student rallies because he seems to be completely immersed in vacationing. He appears to be focused on his holidays.

"Normally, students need a break because they are exhausted from preparing for examinations. Here, students may not be vacationing as much, but Rahul Gandhi, who has exploited students for his politics, has gone on a long break, leading to the cancellation of three student rallies," he said.

BJP hits back at Congress over Australia uranium deal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

Hitting back at the Congress over its claim that Australia's decision to supply uranium to India was taken during the UPA Government, the BJP on Friday said international agreements are signed and implemented by Governments, not political parties.

The Congress earlier said that Australia's uranium sales to India were not a breakthrough achieved by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, pointing out that then-Australian prime minister Julia Gillard had secured her party's approval in 2011 to sell uranium to India following the Indo-US nuclear pact. Countering the Congress, BJP national spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari said that Governments sign and implement international agreements, not political parties.

Questioning the Congress' claims, Bhandari asked that if the 2011 approval was such a major success, why there was "virtually no Australian uranium supply to India between 2011 and 2014".

He also claimed that Australia had said in 2012 that there would be "no uranium supply to India anytime soon".



BJP national spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari

the Modi Government in September 2014, Bhandari said, claiming that the current Government operationalised the long-term Australian uranium supply commitments in 2026.

He also said the Congress "may claim the Moon to please its supporters", but "paper announcements alone do not deliver results; what matters is implementing them on the ground".

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh earlier said, "The BJP ecosystem is on an overdrive to show that Australia's uranium sales to India are a Modi breakthrough. On December 4, 2011, Australian Prime Minister Julia Gillard got approval of her party to sell uranium to India following the India-US Nuclear Agreement of October 2008."

"The BJP trolls that include some of its MPs too need to do their homework better," Ramesh said, sharing a screenshot of media reports from December 2011 stating that Australia's Labour Party had endorsed plans to open up uranium sales to India.

NHRC chairperson calls for vigilance on bonded labour, seeks helpline

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) chairperson Justice V Ramasubramanian (ret'd) has urged officers to remain vigilant while dealing with cases of bonded labour and emphasised the need to launch a helpline so that labourers can seek help when needed.

The NHRC on July 9 heard online 86 cases of alleged bonded labour in brick kilns across various districts of Haryana, the rights panel said on Friday.

Justice Ramasubramanian



presided over the hearing that saw participation of several senior officials of the state Government and various district magistrates in Haryana.

He said in most of the cases, the records had "not been properly examined" by the Government func-

tionaries concerned.

"Therefore, they did not have credible evidence to declare the labourers as bonded labourers," the rights panel said in a statement. The NHRC chief urged the officers to remain vigilant while dealing with cases of bonded labour.

He further asked them to follow the requirements laid down in the 'Standard Operating Procedure for Identification and Rescue of Bonded Labourers and Prosecution of Offenders', issued by the Ministry of Labour and Employment, vide letter, dated May 14, while constituting a team for an inquiry into a complaint.

He also emphasised the need to launch a helpline so that labourers can seek help when needed to help track the incidents of bonded labour. Samir Kumar, joint secretary, NHRC, highlighted the need to comply with the panel's directions and take

action as per its 'Advisory 2.0 to Identify, Release and Rehabilitate Bonded Labourers'.

The Haryana chief secretary, the labour commissioner and the DMs, presented the bonded labour cases during the hearing. The Commission reviewed the action taken reports submitted by the DMs on the complaints, under its consideration, the statement said.

The state's chief secretary and the labour commissioner assured the NHRC that all the 86 cases would be "reviewed", and the requisite information and reports would be submitted thereafter.

Ayushman Bharat Digital mission now one of world's largest health ecosystems

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM) has emerged as one of the world's largest digital health ecosystems, with over 93.95 crore accounts created, 105 crore health records linked, and 5.33 lakh health facilities and 9.85 lakh healthcare professionals registered on the national digital health registries, the Union health ministry said on Friday.

The initiative has also enabled 2.72 lakh healthcare facilities to adopt ABDM-enabled software, generating around 24 crore scan and register tokens for faster OPD registration and facilitating seamless, consent-based exchange of health informa-

tion across the healthcare sector, according to an official statement.

The observations were made at the third meeting of the Mission Steering Group chaired by Union Health Minister J P Nadda, which reviewed the progress of the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and deliberated on the roadmap for further strengthening India's digital health ecosystem.

Addressing the meeting, Nadda underscored the transformative role of digital public infrastructure in improving access to quality healthcare, enhancing continuity of care and empowering citizens through secure and consent-based access to their health records, the statement said.



He emphasised that technology must continue to serve as a powerful enabler for achieving universal health coverage while ensuring inclusiveness, accessibility and ease of use for every citizen.

During the meeting, the Mission Steering Group reviewed the progress on the decisions taken during its previous meeting, including

capacity-building initiatives, strengthening of state-level implementation mechanisms, integration of digital health platforms across Government programmes, enhanced participation of private healthcare providers and international collaborations for knowledge exchange in digital health.

The Mission Steering Group

appreciated the rapid expansion of ABDM across states and Union territories through initiatives such as Model Districts, Model Facilities and Aarogya Setu 2.0, while strengthening integration with flagship Government health programmes, including Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY, CGHS, ESIC and Nikshay, the statement said.

The members observed that these initiatives are making healthcare more accessible, interoperable and citizen-centric by enabling secure digital health records, faster service delivery and seamless access to healthcare services nationwide, it said.

The meeting also deliberated on measures to accelerate adoption of ABDM across

the country, including proposals to expand digital health services, improve interoperability, promote adoption of nationally notified digital health standards, strengthen governance mechanisms and enhance citizen convenience through seamless digital access to health services.

Concluding the meeting, Nadda said, "While a robust digital health infrastructure has been created under ABDM, the next phase must focus on maximizing its adoption and utilization across the country."

"Strengthening the health sector is integral to realizing the vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047, and ABDM will serve as a critical pillar in that journey," he said.



Editor's
TAKE

India–Australia ties come of age

Modi's third visit to Australia, shows a relationship that has moved past symbolism into the business of contracts and commitments

When Prime Minister Narendra Modi touched down in Melbourne on Wednesday evening, fresh from a warm reception in Jakarta and Yogyakarta, he was on an important leg of a three-nation Indo-Pacific tour. This is his third visit to Australia as Prime Minister – a frequency no Indian premier has matched – and it says something about how central Canberra has become to New Delhi's calculus east of Singapore defined by 'Act East' policy.

At the third Australia-India Annual Summit, Modi and his host Anthony Albanese oversaw what officials describe as eighteen distinct outcomes: a Joint Declaration on Defence and Security Cooperation that upgrades the relationship with an Annual Defence Ministers' Dialogue, a new maritime security roadmap, and – most striking – a commercial uranium supply agreement building on the 2014 Civil Nuclear Agreement, under which Australia has so far shipped uranium to India just once, in 2017, to feed India's ambitious 100-gigawatt nuclear power goal.

Talks on the long-pending Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement were formally accelerated, building on the 2022 Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement that was India's first developed-country trade deal in a decade. Education, critical minerals, and cultural repatriation rounded out a genuinely wide canvas.

Trade negotiators have set a target of AUD 100 billion in two-way commerce by 2030, roughly double current levels, and Thursday's acceleration announcement gives that number a fighting chance. For decades, India and Australia were bound loosely by cricket and Commonwealth ties rather than strategic convergence; the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, now six years old, has since matured from rhetoric into structure. A 2021 logistics agreement already lets warships use each other's ports, and the new defence declaration reads less like an aspiration than a maintenance upgrade on an alliance-adjacent partnership.

But it was not smooth sailing for the Indian Prime Minister. Rights groups, including Amnesty International and Human Rights Watch, used the visit to press Canberra to raise India's democratic backsliding, a criticism that has trailed Modi's Australian visits since 2023. It was indeed a low point of the visit but was not allowed to overshadow the visit.

Where does this leave the two countries? Well, the trajectory is unmistakably upward, but increasingly instrumental rather than sentimental. Both governments now speak the language of supply-chain security, critical minerals, and an "open, rules-based" Indo-Pacific. The Quad remains the scaffolding; bilateral deals are increasingly the substance built upon it. If the Jakarta leg was about breadth – reviving an old civilisational friendship into hard defence contracts like BrahMos – the Australia leg was about depth, converting decades of trade and strategic dialogue into binding commitments. The test now is delivery: whether CECA is actually concluded, whether uranium shipments follow the ink, and whether the partnership can absorb criticism without either side flinching.

Viksit Bharat demands a techno-bureaucracy

To achieve Viksit Bharat by 2047, the existing administrative framework must be strengthened. India needs a governance model that combines the strengths of experienced administrators with the knowledge and analytical capabilities of technical experts. A practical solution would be to establish a structured techno-bureaucratic framework within the government



MONI
MADASWAMY

India's aspiration to become a developed nation by 2047 is not merely an economic objective; it is a civilizational mission. The vision of Viksit Bharat encompasses technological leadership, food, nutrition and health security, climate resilience, digital inclusion, energy security, and global competitiveness. Achieving these ambitions, however, requires more than investments and infrastructure. It demands a fundamental transformation in the way India governs itself.

While India's economy and society have undergone remarkable changes over the past three decades, many aspects of its administrative architecture continue to reflect structures designed for a different era. One of the most significant yet least discussed challenges lies in the composition of senior leadership within the Government of India. Today, strategic policymaking positions at the level of Joint Secretary and above are overwhelmingly occupied by traditional career civil service cadres.

There is no dispute regarding the historic contribution of India's civil services to nation-building. However, the governance challenges of the twenty-first century increasingly require a combination of administrative capability and deep domain expertise. The world is entering an era shaped by artificial intelligence, quantum technologies, cybersecurity, biotechnology, climate adaptation, digital public infrastructure, precision agriculture, and advanced healthcare systems. Public policy in these sectors cannot rely solely on administrative experience. It requires leaders who possess first-hand knowledge of the technologies, scientific principles, and institutional ecosystems involved.

Ironically, India already possesses a vast reservoir of such expertise within its own public S&T institutions. Scientists, Engineers, Technologists, and Research leaders from organisations such as ISRO, DRDO, DAE, CSIR, ICMR, ICAR, IMD, FSI, WII, ICFRE, NIC, C-DAC, STQC, and NCMRWF have played a pivotal role in advancing national development. They have built satellites, secured strategic technologies, strengthened food security, developed digital governance platforms, expanded scientific research, and enhanced public service delivery.

Yet, despite their immense contributions, these experts remain largely excluded from the highest levels of policy leadership. Their career progression follows separate scientific and technical cadres, placing them outside the mainstream empanelment mechanisms used for senior government appointments by the



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The writer is Professor Emeritus and Chairman, Centre for Agricultural Informatics and e-Governance Research Studies (CAIRS), Shobhit Institute of Engineering and Technology (Deemed-to-be University), Meerut; Former Director General, National Informatics Centre (NIC), Government of India

Department of Personnel and Training. As a result, many critical policy decisions affecting technology, health, agriculture, climate change, digital governance, and innovation are formulated without adequate participation from those possessing the deepest domain knowledge.

This disconnect creates a structural paradox and administrative inertia. The individuals who design and implement many of India's most important national programmes often have limited opportunities to influence the strategic decisions that shape and implement those programmes. The consequences are increasingly visible: Ministries frequently depend on external consultants, advisory bodies, and contractual experts to bridge knowledge gaps. While external expertise certainly has value, it raises a pertinent question: why should India overlook its own institutional scientific talent while seeking expertise from outside?

The challenge is not one of replacing the existing administrative framework but of strengthening it. India needs a governance model that combines the strengths of experienced administrators with the knowledge and analytical capabilities of scientific and technical experts.

A practical solution would be to create a structured techno-bureaucratic framework within government. Just as officers from the IAS, IFS, IPS, IFS, IRS, IES, ISS, and other organised services are deployed across ministries and departments, senior scientists and technologists should be eligible for empanelment and strategic leadership assignments where their expertise directly supports national priorities.

Such a reform would not diminish the role of civil servants. Instead, it would create a complementary leadership stream that enriches pol-

icymaking through evidence-based expertise and long-term institutional memory. To facilitate this transition, selected scientific and technical professionals should undergo structured administrative training under Mission Karmayogi. The curriculum should include constitutional governance, public administration, public finance, legislative drafting, inter-governmental coordination, and policy analysis. By combining technical depth with administrative competence, India can cultivate a new generation of techno-bureaucrats capable of addressing increasingly complex governance challenges.

The benefits would be significant. Policies would become more evidence-driven and future-oriented. Ministries would gain access to leaders who understand both the scientific dimensions and implementation realities of their sectors. Decision-making would become faster, more informed, and better aligned with national priorities.

Equally important is the need to strengthen accountability throughout the governance system. Senior officials—whether administrative or technical—should undertake periodic field assignments at district, block, and village levels, and should be encouraged to attend focussed workshops at national levels. Such exposure would ensure that policymaking remains grounded in local realities and citizen needs.

Performance evaluation systems must also evolve. Career progression should be linked not only to tenure but also to measurable outcomes, including service delivery, transparency, innovation, fiscal efficiency, and citizen satisfaction. Digital governance platforms now provide unprecedented opportunities to measure outcomes and strengthen accountability across all levels of administration, especially below district levels.

A prime example of where this integrated expertise is urgently needed is the rural sector. The 16th Finance Commission's allocation of ₹8 Lakh Crore to Panchayat Raj Institutions (PRIs) provides a unique opportunity to integrate digital governance, agricultural innovation, local planning, and rural entrepreneurship into a unified development model capable of delivering measurable returns on public investment.

Maximizing this massive fiscal devolution requires a techno-administrative approach that can seamlessly deploy smart irrigation projects, AI-driven climate-resilient farming, and blockchain-based supply chains directly at the village cluster level.

India's mental health challenge needs more than awareness



PRAVEEN
GUPTA

2ND OPINION

Mental health is no longer a silent issue. It is now one of the largest public health challenges facing the world, India included. According to an analysis from the "Global Burden of Disease Study" published in The Lancet, anxiety disorder patients in India increased by 123.5% from 1990 to 2023. It also pointed out that there has been a steep rise in the cases of depressive disorder and anxiety after Covid-19. However, they are more than just numbers. Behind every number is a person struggling with stress, fear, loneliness, burnout, sleep problems or emotional pain. Many are students, young professionals, working parents and elderly people trying to cope quietly every day.

The study also points out an important reality – mental disorders are now one of the leading causes of disability across the world, even more than many major physical ill-

nesses. This should make all of us pause and rethink how we look at mental health in India. To its credit, the government of India has recognised this growing crisis. The Union Budget 2026-27 has placed stronger focus on expanding mental health and trauma care infrastructure. This is an important and welcome step. However, infrastructure alone will not solve the problem. India certainly needs more hospitals, more counselling centres and more trained mental health professionals. We also need to focus on prevention, early support and community-based care.

Mental health can no longer remain limited to big cities or specialised hospitals. One of the biggest concerns is that mental health problems are increasing most rapidly among teenagers and young adults. This is a very sensitive stage of life where emotional health shapes education, relationships, confidence and future careers. Unfortunately, many young people today are growing up under constant pressure. Academic competition, social media comparison, financial insecurity, loneliness and lack of emotional communication inside families are affecting mental well-being deeply. Many children are connected online all day but emotionally disconnected in real life. Anxiety and depression have also increased among women in the post pandemic years due to emotional stress, responsibilities at home, work-related pressure, and societal demands.

Chronic anxiety and depression can disturb sleep, concentration, memory and overall quality of life. Long-term stress may also increase the risk of headaches, hypertension, stroke risk factors, and other neurological problems

indirectly through lifestyle changes. India, therefore, needs a much broader mental health movement. Mental health education should begin in schools. Every school and college should have access to trained counsellors.

Even at the workplace, conversations around burnout, anxiety and emotional fatigue need to be normalised. Primary healthcare doctors should receive basic mental health training so that early symptoms are recognised before conditions become severe. At the community level, we must reduce stigma. Even today, many families hesitate to seek psychiatric help because of fear, shame or social judgement. Mental illness should be treated like any other health condition – without embarrassment. Technology can also play a major role. Tele-consultations, digital counselling platforms, and regional-language mental health services can improve access in smaller towns and rural India where specialists remain limited. More importantly, we need to realise that mental well-being is also connected with issues such as education, job prospects, social welfare, family matters, and the economy.

A country cannot progress without ensuring the mental well-being of its people. India is on the right track by taking the first step in terms of policy and funding. The next step would be implementation on the ground. Mental well-being needs to become affordable, available, and acceptable for all Indians. This way, India will emerge a better nation.

The writer is Chairman, Marengo Asia International Institute of Neuro and Spine (MAIINS)

PIC TALK



Farmers transplant paddy saplings in a field during monsoon, in Ranchi, Jharkhand
PHOTO: PTI

DIGITAL EXPERIENCE

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POLITICS SHOULD UNITE CITIZENS, NOT DIVIDE FAMILIES

Politics is meant to be debated in Parliament, not allowed to poison friendships and family relationships. While political leaders are expected to disagree, ordinary citizens need not become foot soldiers of any party. Unfortunately, many people now treat criticism of their favourite leader or party as a personal attack, replacing reason with blind loyalty. Political discussions increasingly descend into hostility, with friends and even elderly citizens exchanging insults over issues beyond their control.

More worrying is the tendency to focus on a leader's attire, appearance or style rather than governance, policies and performance. Likewise, official foreign visits by ministers are often dismissed as leisure trips, ignoring the complexities of diplomacy. Leaders should be

judged by their competence, integrity and public service—not ideological or religious affinity.

The greatest threat to democracy is not rivalry between political parties but growing intolerance among citizens. Healthy democracies thrive on informed debate and mutual respect, not unquestioning allegiance. Governments will come and go, but damaged relationships are far harder to rebuild. No political ideology is worth sacrificing civility, respect and cherished human bonds. Democracy is strengthened by informed dialogue, mutual respect and tolerance. Political differences should never outweigh humanity, because governments change with time, but broken friendships, divided families and lost trust are far harder to restore.

AP THIRUVADI | CHENNAI

Please send your letter to the info@dailypioneer.com. In not more than 250 words. We appreciate your feedback.

Justice must be swift as well as fair

The recent Gujarat High Court judgment upholding the convictions in the 2008 Ahmedabad serial blasts case has reaffirmed the common citizen's faith in the judiciary. The horrific attacks claimed 56 innocent lives, injured nearly 200 people and terrorised the nation for over an hour.

The court's decision to uphold death sentences for 38 convicts and life imprisonment for 11 others sends a strong message that terrorism will not go unpunished. For the families who lost loved ones, the verdict offers some measure of closure, though no judgment can compensate for the loss of precious human lives or erase the emotional scars left behind. Justice, however, loses much of its meaning when it arrives after years of waiting.

Victims and their families deserve timely resolution, not prolonged uncertainty that deepens their suffering. The judiciary continues to command immense public trust because it remains the last refuge of justice. To strengthen that faith further, cases involving terrorism and other heinous crimes must be heard and decided without avoidable delays. Justice should not only be fair and impartial; it must also be delivered within a reasonable time.

SUNIL OKHADE | INDORE

West Asia cannot afford another escalation

The renewed military confrontation between the United States and Iran threatens to undo the fragile ceasefire that had briefly raised hopes of stability in West Asia. Fresh US airstrikes followed by Iranian missile attacks on Gulf countries have once again pushed the region towards a dangerous conflict with consequences extending far beyond its borders.

The Strait of Hormuz, through which nearly one-fifth of the world's oil and gas supplies pass, remains at the centre of the crisis. Any disruption to shipping through this vital waterway risks triggering higher energy prices, supply-chain disruptions and economic uncertainty worldwide. The latest violence has also cast serious doubt over planned negotiations on reopening the Strait and addressing Iran's contentious nuclear programme. Military retaliation may satisfy immediate strategic objectives, but it seldom produces lasting peace. Continued escalation only heightens the risk of miscalculation and draws more countries into an already volatile conflict. The international community must intensify diplomatic efforts to restore the ceasefire and bring both sides back to the negotiating table. Dialogue remains the only sustainable path towards regional stability and global energy security.

BHAGWAN THADANI | MUMBAI

Elder care requires collective action

This refers to "Elder care is not optional, it is a social responsibility" (July 9). The article rightly highlights how rapid urbanisation and changing family structures have weakened traditional support systems for senior citizens. While restoring old values is desirable, practical solutions are equally essential. Emotional bonds cannot be legislated, but effective community support can certainly be created. Resident Welfare Associations can maintain registries of elderly people living alone, local police can conduct regular welfare visits, and corporate social responsibility funds can strengthen neighbourhood care initiatives. Such measures are affordable, practical and capable of significantly improving the safety and dignity of senior citizens. At the same time, India must prepare for the challenges of an ageing population by strengthening healthcare, age-friendly urban infrastructure and workplace policies that support caregivers. Old-age homes alone cannot address the growing need, nor can nuclear families shoulder the entire responsibility.

A balanced approach combining legal safeguards, community participation and intergenerational engagement is the need of the hour. How a society treats its elderly reflects its moral character.

VEDA CHIDANAND | BENGALURU

Renewable energy transition for a climate-resilient India

For India, which imports nearly 85 per cent of its crude oil and more than half of its natural gas requirements, energy independence is no longer merely an environmental aspiration but a strategic imperative. Its rapid transition to renewable energy is emerging as the cornerstone of economic resilience and climate action



SATENDRA SINGH

Every 10 July, Global Energy Independence Day underscores a simple truth: a nation's energy security is inseparable from its economic and strategic stability. A prolonged war in Eastern Europe, unrest across the Middle East, disrupted shipping lanes, and a fresh flash-point between Iran and the United States have rattled oil markets in recent months, exposing how vulnerable countries remain when they depend on distant, unstable regions for fuel. Few nations feel that exposure as sharply as India, which imports close to 85% of its crude oil and more than half its natural gas - a dependence that shows up directly in import bills, the balance of payments, industrial competitiveness, and household budgets. As the country looks ahead to Viksit Bharat 2047, energy security has moved from a policy footnote to a national priority, with India's decade-long renewable energy transformation at its centre.

Conflict in any oil-producing region moves fast through the global economy: crude prices spike, freight costs climb, and import-dependent countries absorb the shock first. India has treated this as a wake-up call, spending the past decade on one of the world's most ambitious energy transitions - one that now ties together energy security, climate action, economic growth, technology and disaster preparedness.

Modern life runs on energy - industry, agriculture, healthcare, education and digital infrastructure all depend on it. Yet coal, oil and natural gas are also responsible for roughly three-quarters of global greenhouse gas emissions, according to international scientific assessments, driving melting glaciers, erratic monsoons, prolonged droughts, stronger cyclones and rising seas - risks that hit India especially hard given its geography and population. Shifting to renewable energy is therefore not simply a fuel substitution; it is one of the most effective tools for cutting climate risk while strengthening energy security.

As the world's fastest-growing major economy and its third-largest electricity consumer, India's power demand is set to climb sharply with urbanisation, industrial expansion, digitisation and rising living standards. Meeting that demand through fossil fuels alone would deepen import dependence and undercut India's climate commitments at once. Renewable energy avoids that trade-off: it is domestically available, abundant, environmentally sound, and - thanks to falling costs - genuinely competitive on price.

The Scale of the Renewable Revolution

India's numbers are striking. Total installed power generation capacity now exceeds 530 GW, with more than half drawn from non-fossil sources - meeting a key Paris Agreement commitment years ahead of its 2030 deadline. By March 2026, non-fossil capacity had reached roughly 283 GW, making India the world's third-largest producer of renewable energy, with solar and wind together contributing nearly three-quarters of that total.

A few figures capture the pace of change: Solar power capacity has crossed 150 GW; wind has passed 56 GW and India now ranks as the world's third-largest renewable energy producer. This growth has been driven by coordinated policy support: the National Solar Mission, the PM Surya Ghar rooftop solar scheme, ultra-mega solar parks, production-linked manufacturing incentives, and sustained investment in transmission infrastructure.

India's Place on the Global Climate Stage

India's renewable energy record has also strengthened its standing as a global climate leader. At COP26, Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the "Panchamrit" commitments: 500 GW of non-fossil power capacity by 2030, meeting half of India's energy needs from non-fossil sources, cutting a billion tonnes of projected carbon emissions, reducing the emissions intensity of GDP by 45% against 2005 levels, and reaching net-zero by 2070. India has also pushed for developing nations to get adequate climate financing, technology transfer and capacity-building support, backing that stance through initiatives like the International Solar Alliance, co-founded with France.

More Than Just Clean Power

Renewable energy's value now reaches well beyond emissions reduction. Cutting reliance on imported fuel strengthens energy security and improves air quality, and steep declines in solar tariffs have made it one of



AWANISH KUMAR SINGH

acquiring knowledge. It is about developing the skills, values and confidence needed to navigate life's challenges and opportunities. Rural education must focus on a holistic approach to achieve inclusive and sustainable growth.

The Need to Go Beyond Traditional Learning

The majority of villagers are considered to be first-time learners; however, it is also crucial that these children receive training in practical skills in order to prepare them to succeed in today's world. Critical thinking, communication skills, teamwork, problem-solving, financial management, digital literacy, and overall awareness are very much needed in today's fast-moving world. All these skills will help students make good



INDIA'S RENEWABLE AMBITIONS NOW EXTEND WELL PAST SOLAR AND WIND. THE NATIONAL GREEN HYDROGEN MISSION AIMS TO MAKE THE COUNTRY A GLOBAL HUB FOR GREEN HYDROGEN, A FUEL WITH REAL POTENTIAL TO DECARBONISE HARD-TO-ELECTRIFY SECTORS SUCH AS STEEL, FERTILISERS, REFINING, SHIPPING AND HEAVY TRANSPORT

The writer is Former Executive Director, National Institute of Disaster Management, GOI and Director, SAARC Disaster Management Centre.

the cheapest power sources available - an economic asset as much as an environmental one. It is also a genuine jobs engine, spanning manufacturing, installation, operations and research, while rooftop solar, solar pumps, mini-grids and biogas plants extend reliable electricity to rural communities once dependent on diesel, advancing goals from poverty reduction to public health and gender equality. As floods, cyclones, heatwaves, droughts and wildfires grow more frequent, reliable power becomes critical for hospitals, emergency centres, water systems and relief camps, all of which can lose power when conventional grids fail. Distributed renewable systems, including rooftop solar and battery-backed microgrids, keep essential services running when the main grid goes down - something India has already put into practice, extending solar power to hospitals, schools and irrigation systems in disaster-prone regions. This echoes the "Build Back Better" principle under the Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction. Toward Viksit Bharat 2047, renewable energy is as much an investment in resilience as in clean power.

India's renewable ambitions now extend well past solar and wind. The National Green Hydrogen Mission aims to make the country a global hub for green hydrogen, a fuel with real potential to decarbonise hard-to-electrify sectors such as steel, fertilisers, refining, shipping and heavy transport. Battery storage is another priority, smoothing out the natural variability of solar and wind generation, alongside continued investment in pumped hydro. Offshore wind pilots are underway in Gujarat and Tamil Nadu, biomass and mini-hydro projects continue to expand, and rising EV adoption promises to further cut reliance on imported fuel.

What Still Needs Work

Real hurdles remain. Grid integration tops the list: solar and wind output depends on weather, so absorbing it reliably requires substantial investment in modern infrastructure and storage. Financing is another constraint - hitting the 500 GW non-fossil target by 2030 needs capital from international climate funds, green bonds and public-private partnerships. Domestic manufacturing also needs strengthening: despite progress under the production-linked incentive scheme, India still imports key raw materials for solar panels. Land acquisition, environmental clearances, skilled-workforce shortages and transmission delays add further complexity, all pointing to the need for sustained research and development.

The Way Forward

India's progress so far shows that economic growth and environmental sustainability can advance together. But reaching 500 GW of non-fossil capacity by 2030, and net-zero by 2070, will require sustained policy consistency, investment and innovation: scaling up rooftop solar and battery storage, building smarter transmission networks, and expanding domestic production of solar modules, batteries and electrolyzers under the Make in India framework - alongside green hydrogen, energy efficiency and embedding renewable power into infrastructure such as hospitals and schools.

The recent turbulence in the Middle East is only the latest reminder of how exposed fossil-fuel-dependent nations remain to forces beyond their control. For India, energy independence is no longer simply an environmental or economic goal; it is a strategic necessity tied to national security, economic stability and climate resilience. This Global Energy Independence Day carries a clear message: the shift to clean, self-reliant energy is not merely sound environmental policy - it is the foundation of a secure and sustainable future for India.

What the world's finest universities do not teach



ACHARYA PRASHANT

On 30 May, I was at the Cambridge Union in conversation with Professor Jaideep Prabhu. In that hall, where Churchill and Hawking have both been heard, the audience before me was made up largely of economics and management students. But one thing became clear very quickly. However sophisticated the education, there comes a point where no theory helps and no degree comes to the rescue. At that point, the question is no longer about the world. It is about the questioner. A one-hour session stretched into conversations over nearly two days.

And what I saw at Cambridge, I saw throughout the tour. At Oxford, in the British Parliament, at the London School of Economics, and in public dialogues. The lack was the same. People know a great deal, but they do not know themselves. What do the world's finest universities teach, and what do they still fail to teach?

Let us begin fairly. Western higher education has immense strengths. It has reason, analysis, and intellectual honesty. Science has dignity because it does not rush to conclusion. It says: first I will observe, test, verify.

On 8 June, at Oxford, I was speaking on the second mantra of the Ishavasya Upanishad in a setting connected, a century and a half earlier, with Max Muller's role in introducing that very text into the Western scholarly world. On 12 June, at the British Parliament, I spoke on "Asato Ma Sad Gamaya." Universities know how to study the world, but the most important question is left untouched. In the statement "I know," who is this "I"?

That is where education remains incomplete. If you inform a person about the world, but never examine the one gathering that information, education remains incomplete. If the eye itself is distorted, then whatever it sees will also be seen wrongly. All outer knowledge then ends up serving inner distortion.

So the real problem is not a lack of information. The real problem is the condition of the knower.

Knowledge is value-neutral; the user of knowledge is not. A tool is neither good, nor bad in itself. But if the one holding the tool is inwardly distorted, the tool becomes a weapon. Technology then serves exploitation. Economics serves greed, politics serves domination.

On 2 July, in a conversation with the Cambridge-trained biologist Dr Rupert Sheldrake on consciousness and the limits of science, the same point became even clearer. Science asks what a thing is, and how it works. But science, by its nature, does not investigate the one asking those questions. As long as science remains within its domain, it is honest and beautiful. The trouble begins when the limits of science are declared to be the limits of reality itself. Then science turns into scientism. And scientism is very useful to the ego. It allows a person to say: only what is outside is real.

That is where the real trouble begins. At the London School of Economics, in a dialogue with Professor Jonathan Birch on animal consciousness, whose research contributed to UK law recognising even octopuses and crabs as sentient beings, I offered the example of a drunk driver. If a man is driving drunk and we keep improving the roads, softening the barriers, and speeding up the ambulance, will the basic problem be solved? No. There may be some relief, but the root remains untouched. In the very week I was in London, there were severe heatwaves, yet the discussion kept returning to new technology, not to the appetite producing the heat in the first place. But one question is still avoided: who is the one doing all this?

The same point came up again in my conversation with PETA's senior vice-president on 3 July. The exploited may change. Sometimes it is the animal, sometimes the river, sometimes the forest. The exploiter remains almost the same: conditioned, fearful, acquisitive, violent ego. Unless education touches this ego, education produces civilised barbarism. The outer polish remains.

Now let us turn to India. India has had the language of self-knowledge. The Upanishads are here, vedanta is here. India's real contribution was this: before you know the world, see who it is that is knowing. The Ishavasya expresses this in two words: vidya and avidya. If you pursue only avidya, only outer knowledge, you remain in darkness. If you cling only to vidya, in a merely verbal sense, you fall into deeper darkness still. One crosses only by carrying both together. The fault lies not in outer knowledge but in the blindness of the one using it.

And India's tragedy is this: we have repeated this wisdom far more than we have lived it. We have turned it into identity, ritual, sentiment, convenience, and display. What could cut into a person, shake him, and transform him, we set aside. What could become spectacle, we kept.

So this is not a question of East versus West, nor of one civilisation being superior to another. The West knows the outer world very well, but falls silent on the knower. India had the language of the knower, but now often uses that very language to sustain the machinery of ego. Yet in both places, human beings remain frightened, greedy, lonely, and insecure. The real issue is not civilisation, it is consciousness.

Even the students of Oxford and Cambridge, brilliant in their fields, can sense that something remains missing, some lack that neither degrees nor money can fill. But their education does not tell them that what is missing is the cleansing of the eye and the clearing of intent. Because if the knower himself is fearful, greedy, and inwardly unclean, then even the best knowledge will finally serve ego and violence.

So what do the world's finest universities still not teach? They do not teach you to ask whom your education is serving. They do not teach you how to examine the knower.

They do not teach you that achievement without self-knowledge also becomes destructive. They teach the world well. They do not ask who is receiving that knowledge. And until these questions enter the centre of education, universities will continue to produce brilliant, accomplished graduates, while the human being remains a cause of destruction for other species and for the Earth itself.

Acharya Prashant is a philosopher and author whose work centres on self-inquiry and its application to contemporary life

Educating for life: The case for holistic learning in rural India



AWANISH KUMAR SINGH

Education has always been the first step of progress. However, in the rural landscape, the conversation around education must move beyond textbooks, examinations, and classroom attendance. True education is generally beyond

The Need to Go Beyond Traditional Learning

The majority of villagers are considered to be first-time learners; however, it is also crucial that these children receive training in practical skills in order to prepare them to succeed in today's world. Critical thinking, communication skills, teamwork, problem-solving, financial management, digital literacy, and overall awareness are very much needed in today's fast-moving world. All these skills will help students make good

choices regarding their lives, whether in the workforce or otherwise, and contribute to the improvement of their communities.

India's rural communities are rapidly changing due to technology, entrepreneurship and new opportunities. The education system must change and be able to assist our students in this transitional period, in order to guarantee that our students will have a bright future. In addition to teaching mathematics and science, schools should teach children about leadership, creativity, social values, environmental awareness and personal development.

Experiential Learning: Building Confidence and Capability

The most effective way to promote holistic education is through experiential learning. Experiential learning encompasses a variety of activities such as sports, arts, cultural programs, community service, and vocational training. These types of activities give students the ability to build confidence and develop practical skills, as well as teach them important life skills such as discipline, resilience, teamwork, and responsibility that are difficult to develop



through traditional classroom instruction. By encouraging students to participate in experiential learning activities, educational institutions help students identify their strengths while expanding their understanding of what is possible in their lives and careers.

Digital Literacy for a Changing World

Digital literacy is another fundamental principle for a holistic education. The rapid growth of tech-

online learning, developing new skills, creating their own businesses and contributing to the growth of India.

Nurturing Values and Responsible Citizenship

Equally important is the role of values and character building. Education should nurture empathy, integrity, respect, and a sense of civic responsibility. When young people understand their duties

toward society and the environment, they grow into responsible citizens capable of driving positive change. Such values are particularly important in strengthening community bonds and preserving the social fabric of rural India.

Teachers and parents play a vital role in this transformation. Their encouragement and support can help students discover their talents, pursue their aspirations, and develop self-belief. Educational institutions must work closely with families and local communities to create an ecosystem that supports holistic growth. Preparing Rural Youth for the Future

The future of rural India depends on empowering its youth with more than academic qualifications. By integrating life skills, technology, values, and practical learning into education, we can create a generation that is not only educated but also capable, confident, and future-ready. Holistic education is not merely an educational reform; it is an investment in the social and economic development of the nation. When rural students are equipped to succeed in all aspects of life, the entire country moves forward together.

MLC Er. Awanish Kumar Singh is Chief Educationist & President, Subhash Chandra Bose Group of Institutions and State President Kreedha Bharti, UP

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Order Order

HC seeks Delhi govt stand on pvt schools’ plea on fees

The Delhi High Court on Friday sought the Delhi Government’s stand on pleas by private schools against a Directorate of Education circular to constitute the ‘School Level Fee Regulation Committee’ (SLFRC) in accordance with the latest fee regulation law. The applications form part of the petitions assailing the Delhi School Education (Transparency in Fixation and Regulation of Fees) Act, 2025 on grounds of it being malafide, biased, arbitrary and malicious in nature.

A bench of Chief Justice DK Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia issued notice on applications by the schools and asked the Government to file its objections. The counsel for Action Committee Unaided Recognised Private Schools urged the court to protect them from any coercive action by the authorities over failure to constitute the SLFRC.

The bench said the main case was listed for hearing on July 20 and the petitioner can approach it if any adverse action is taken in the meantime. “If they precipitate, inform us. Wait till July 20,” the court stated.

The counsel for the petitioner submitted that despite the court putting in abeyance the Government’s February 1 mandate to private schools to constitute the SLFRC for the ongoing academic session, the authorities issued an “identical” circular on June 30. The circular “reiterates and resurrects” the very same directions to constitute the SLFRC and submit the proposals of fee for a block of three years, including the session 2026-27, the application by Action Committee said. “... the DoE still directing constitution of the SLFRC and submission of proposal for fee increase by the Schools, including the academic year 2026-27, is illegal, to say the least,” the application argued. *(PTI)*

Environmental compensation imposed on Mussorie hotels



The Uttarakhand Pollution Control Board (UKPCB) has informed the National Green Tribunal that environmental compensation has been imposed against 19 hotels for allegedly violating green norms in Mussoorie, while show-cause notices were issued against 30 others.

The green body is hearing the matter regarding hotels operating in Mussoorie without following environmental norms, besides the unregulated withdrawal of water from the Mussoorie lake, mainly by hotels.

In December last year, the tribunal had directed the UKPCB to take expeditious steps and complete the process of calculation and levy of EC after following the principles of natural justice.

In an order dated July 7, a bench of NGT Chairperson Justice Prakash Shrivastava and expert member Afroz Ahmad said that the UKPCB’s action-taken report disclosed that environmental compensation had been imposed against 19 defaulting hotels while show-cause notices were issued to 30 others.

The bench said, “Counsel for the UKPCB submits that out of the remaining 30 hotels, the EC has subsequently been imposed against 12 hotels and for the remaining 18 hotels the proceedings will be concluded and an order imposing the EC will be passed within four weeks.”

It directed the state pollution board to ensure that these hotels operate only with the due consent to operate (CTO) and in compliance with the environmental norms.

“Let a fresh report be filed by the UKPCB within six weeks. List on September 21,” the tribunal said. *(PTI)*

Delhi court acquits husband in attempt to murder case after wife dies before testifying

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A Delhi court has acquitted a man accused of attempting to murder his wife, saying that the prosecution failed to prove its case after the complainant died before she could testify during the trial.

Principal District and Sessions Judge Sanjay Sharma was hearing a case against Abhinesh Tripathi alias Rahul who was accused of attempting to murder his wife Rashmi in 2021.

In an order dated July 6, the court said, “In the present case, the only material witness i.e. complainant/ injured Rashmi has expired and prosecution has not cited any other witness, who can depose



regarding any overt act done by the accused.”

According to the prosecution, the case stemmed from a complaint lodged by Rashmi in April 2021, alleging that her husband assaulted her after she refused to speak to an unknown person at his insis-



NGT restrains activities at 3 stadiums over water issue

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The National Green Tribunal has restrained three cricket stadiums from carrying out any sports activity without its permission, saying they failed to respond despite notices from the Central Ground Water Authority and the tribunal regarding the use of groundwater.

The green body passed the interim order in the matter regarding the use of groundwater or fresh water to maintain cricket grounds instead of the sewage treatment plant (STP)-treated water, and against not installing rainwater harvesting systems for groundwater storage, discharge and restoration.

Earlier in April, the tribunal had issued notices to six cricket stadiums across the country, including Arun Jaitley Stadium in New Delhi, asking them to explain why their activities should not be stopped for failing to disclose to the Central Ground Water Authority (CGWA) the source



of water used to maintain the pitch and grounds.

The other stadiums were Shaheed Veer Narayan Singh International Stadium (Raipur), Sawai Mansingh Stadium (Jaipur), Dr D Y Patil Stadium (Mumbai), Bharat Ratna Shri Atal Bihari Vajpayee Ekana Cricket Stadium (Lucknow) and Barabati Stadium (Cuttack).

In an interim order dated July 2, made available on Friday, a bench of NGT Chairperson Justice Prakash Shrivastava and expert member Afroz Ahmad noted

that Barabati Stadium sought four weeks to file a reply, the Lucknow stadium had already filed a reply and the Arun Jaitley Stadium had also filed a reply, after which CGWA sought some additional information.

Advocates Adnan, Satyam Shekhar and Abhik Chandra, appearing for the applicant, submitted that the remaining three stadiums are not responding to the repeated notices, and despite the imposition of cost, they have not cared to respond. The CGWA’s counsel said

that these three stadiums have been repeatedly served, yet they have not filed a response.

“Having regard to the serious issue of water shortage in different areas of the country, we were expecting that these stadiums will duly respond to the tribunal’s notice and will take appropriate corrective measures, but in spite of repeated notices not only from the tribunal but also from the CGWA, these three stadiums have not cared to file any response,” the tribunal said.

“Therefore, in such circumstances, by way of interim direction, we restrain the following three stadiums — Shaheed Veer Narayan Singh International Stadium, Raipur; Sawai Mansingh Stadium, Jaipur; and D Y Patil Stadium, Mumbai — from carrying on any further sports activity in the stadium without the leave of the tribunal till the next date of hearing,” it added.

The matter has been posted for further proceedings on August 17.

SC to hear pleas seeking probe into Ram temple donations row on July 13

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court would hear a batch of pleas seeking a fair and time-bound probe into the alleged embezzlement of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya on July 13.

On July 7, an Ayodhya court granted one-day police remand for three of the eight accused arrested in connection with the alleged theft of donations at the Ram temple. The court authorised the remand for Anukalp Mishra, Lavkush Mishra and Karunesh Pandey.

On June 29, a local court had sent all the eight accused to 14-day judicial custody.

According to the Supreme Court website, a bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana will hear as many as three petitions filed on the issue when the apex court reopens on Monday.

Narendra Kumar Goswami, one of the three petitioners, has moved the top court seeking a CBI probe into the incident. He also sought a Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) audit of the finances of the Sri Ram Janmabhoomi Theerth Kshetra Trust, which manages the affairs of the Ram temple.

The second petition has been filed by Ajay Kumar Rai and Dinesh Kumar Yadav seeking similar measures.

Besides seeking an apex court-monitored CBI probe, the third petition, filed by RJD MP Sudhakar Singh, has sought a forensic audit of the entire finances of the temple trust.

Earlier, a partial working day bench headed by Justice BV Nagarathna had asked one of the petitioners to mention the case for urgent hearing on a later date.

The petition, filed by practising advocates Ajay Kumar Rai and Dinesh Kumar Yadav, said a CBI-led multi-disciplinary special investigation team



(SIT) should investigate the alleged financial irregularities and other purported illegalities concerning the affairs and administration of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust. Rai, in his petition, has sought directions to the Centre, the Uttar Pradesh Government and the Trust for constituting and operationalising such regulatory, supervisory and

audit mechanisms as may be necessary to safeguard public interest and maintain the confidence of millions of devotees and donors.

“Whether or not the reports regarding missing funds and other alleged irregularities concerning the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust are ultimately found to be true, such reports have caused deep concern among the generations that struggled for the restoration of the glory of Ayodhya,” the plea said.

It also said the SIT constituted by the Uttar Pradesh Government commenced its inquiry into the matter without the registration of an FIR or any regular criminal case.

The plea said the veracity of reports concerning alleged missing funds and other purported irregularities involving the Trust ought to be independently verified through a professional investigation conducted by a unified agency possessing the requisite expertise, resources

and institutional mechanisms for handling complex financial and criminal investigations.

“Such an inquiry would inspire greater public confidence than a preliminary probe conducted by a special investigation team comprising administrative officers who may not possess specialised credentials in criminal investigation,” the plea said.

It said the issues involved not only concern the possible commission of cognisable offences but also directly affect the faith, sentiments and confidence of countless devotees and the public.

On June 13, the Uttar Pradesh Government constituted the SIT on a request from the temple trust following allegations of misappropriation of donations received at the Ram temple. The SIT comprises Lucknow Divisional Commissioner Vijay Vishwas Pant, Inspector General of Police Kiran S and Special Secretary (Finance) Neel Ratan.

Google moves Delhi HC in appeal over use of trademark

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Tech giant Google on Friday moved the Delhi High Court against an order holding it guilty of trademark infringement over the use of sanitaryware brand Hindware’s mark as keywords for its AdWords programme.

A bench of justices V Kameswar Rao and Manmeet P S Arora issued notice to Hindware on Google’s appeal against a single judge’s May 22 decision, which also directed the platform to pay ₹30 lakh as damages, and listed the matter for hearing on July 24.

Refusing to interfere with the judgement at this stage, the bench said, “We will have it on July 24 for final disposal.”

Senior advocate Abhishek Singhvi appeared for the appellant and sought interim stay of the direction to pay damages.



He argued that the single judge’s judgement was not in line with the earlier decisions and globally acceptable practices in the field.

On May 22, the single judge had directed Google to pay ₹30 lakh as damages to Hindware for using its trademark as keywords for its AdWords Programme.

While dealing with two lawsuits by Hindware Ltd, the single judge had held that the use of trademarks as keywords amounted to

unfair advantage under the Trademarks Act and restrained Google LLC and Google India from using ‘Hindware’ or ‘Hindware Sanitaryware’, ‘Hindware Sanitar’ or ‘Hindware Sanitaryware India’ as part of advertising keywords for its platform.

The single-judge bench had ruled that by enabling direct competitors to intercept users when they expressed an interest in the plaintiff’s mark, Google indulged in an “unfair practice” and also sought to exploit the distinctive character or repute of the plaintiff’s well-known trademark to benefit its own advertising business.

It said no prior consent or approval was admittedly sought by Google from the plaintiff for offering, suggesting and selling its registered trademark to other entities pursuant to the AdWords programme.

Thane court rejects bail plea of man held for rape

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Thane

A court in Maharashtra’s Thane district has rejected the bail application of a man accused of raping a woman under the false promise of marriage, impregnating her, and threatening her.

Additional Sessions Judge VG Mohite rejected the plea of the accused, Shubham Bhagwan Shinde, observing that his release could pose a serious risk to the woman and her unborn child. A copy of the court order dated July 7 was received on Thursday.

According to the prosecution, the woman and Shinde got acquainted with each other in December last year. After a few weeks, Shinde invited her to his house



and had physical relations with her under the pretext of marrying her.

The woman subsequently became pregnant and began residing in Shinde’s house. However, whenever she asked him about marriage, Shinde allegedly threatened to commit suicide if pressured, the prosecution alleged. Additional Public Prosecutor Manisha Pawse opposed Shinde’s bail application, arguing that he cheated the

woman and abandoned her after she became pregnant. The woman also objected to Shinde’s bail plea, claiming that his relatives had hurled casteist abuses and threatened her with harm.

Advocate Yasin Nabi, who represented Shinde, argued that it was a case of a failed romantic relationship and produced photographs to show “intimacy” between the duo. He further submitted that the investigation was complete and the

chargesheet had been filed. However, the court said the defence failed to place a copy of the chargesheet on record to verify the evidence. About the photographs, Judge Mohite said they were insufficient to defend the accused since the woman herself claimed they shared a friendly relationship.

The judge also noted that the accused remained “mum” about the woman’s pregnancy in his application as well as during arguments.

“If he is released on bail, then the possibility of causing injury or death to the prosecutrix or her fetus by him cannot be ruled out. Moreover, he may force her to abort the pregnancy,” the court said, rejecting Shinde’s regular bail plea.

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BUSINESS11

Indian Bank reports 10% rise in net profit to ₹3,273 cr in Q1

State-owned Indian Bank on Friday posted a 10 per cent rise in net profit to ₹3,273 crore in the first quarter of the current financial year.

The Chennai-based lender had earned a net profit of ₹2,973 crore in the same quarter of the previous fiscal.

The lender's total income increased to ₹20,724 crore during the June quarter of 2026-27 from ₹18,721 crore in the same period of FY26, Indian Bank said in a regulatory filing.

Interest earned by the bank also improved to ₹18,090 crore, compared to ₹16,283 crore in the year-ago period.

Net Interest Income (NII) increased by 17 per cent to ₹7,435 crore from ₹6,359 crore in the June quarter of FY26, it said. During the period under review, its operating profit increased to ₹5,557 crore from ₹4,770 crore in the same quarter a year ago.

The bank's asset quality showed improvement as gross non-performing assets (NPAs) declined to 1.86 per cent of gross advances at the end of the June quarter from 3.01 per cent a year ago. (PTI)

SBI sells 1.42% stake in SBI funds for ₹1,655 cr ahead of IPO

State Bank of India (SBI) has sold 1.42 per cent stake in its asset management arm, SBI Funds Management Ltd (SBIFM), to 30 investors for ₹1,655 crore in a pre-IPO placement round, the bank said.

The lender sold the stake at ₹574 per share, which is also the higher end of the IPO price band, according to an exchange filing. SBI Funds Management's ₹11,600-crore maiden public equity offering will open on July 14 and conclude on July 16.

The entire IPO is an Offer for Sale (OFS) by promoters SBI and Amundi India Holding.

SBI sold the shares to investors including 360 ONE funds, Tata AIG General Insurance Company, Go Digit General Insurance, Bennett Coleman, Anand Rathii Global Finance, Capri Global Ventures and Carmelian Bharat Amritkaal Fund.

"State Bank of India has entered into share purchase agreements each dated July 9, 2026 to sell, in aggregate, 2,88,32,748 equity shares of SBIFM of face value ₹1 each being equivalent to 1.415 per cent of pre-offer share capital of SBIFM, to a total of 30 investors at ₹574 per equity share, for an aggregate consideration of ₹1,655 crore," the bank said in a filing on Thursday. (PTI)

Sensex jumps 827 points as IT stocks drive rally

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Stock market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended 1 per cent higher on Friday, extending gains for the second day, aided by a rally in heavyweights Reliance Industries, ICICI Bank and HDFC Bank, and positive global cues.

Easing crude oil prices and buying in IT stocks after TCS reported an increase in its June-quarter net profit and guided towards an improvement in demand returning in the ongoing quarter also propelled the rally in the domestic market.

The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped

Top Gainers	%	Top Losers	%
RELIANCE	2.28	ETERNAL	-0.1
Tech Mahindra	2.19	Bharat Aungmye	-0.1
BEL	2.17	Sun Pharma	-0.1
Axis Bank	1.92	TRENT	-0.1
Tata Steel	1.78	ITC	-0.1

EV components market set for eightfold surge to ₹3.55 lakh cr by 2032: Report

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

India's electric vehicle (EV) components market is expected to expand eightfold to around ₹3.55 lakh crore over the next seven years, from ₹41,000 crore in 2025, according to an industry report.

This forecast comes from the newly released 'India Electric Vehicle & Components Market Overview Report' by India Energy Storage Alliance and Customized Energy Solutions (CES), released at the India Energy Storage Week 2026 event in New Delhi.

The report pointed to the emergence of a dynamic domestic opportunity, as the EV component value chain becomes a central pillar in India's industrial and clean mobility ambitions, a statement said.

Vinayak Walimbe, Managing Director, Customized Energy Solutions, said, "India's EV momentum is unmatched, powered by innovation and collaboration. Strengthening domestic supply chains will be central to our clean mobility success."

The culmination of this week's industry dialogue took place at India Energy

India notifies process to claim UK FTA tariff quota benefits on vehicle imports

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

India has notified the procedure for importers to seek government approval to avail quota-based duty concessions on imports of passenger cars and goods vehicles under the free trade agreement with the UK, which will come into force on July 15.

Under the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA), India will reduce import duties on automotive imports from about 110 per cent to 10 per cent, with quotas on both sides.

India is allowing import of 3.78 lakh units of conventional-engine passenger cars, including those in the mass segment, from the UK at concessional customs duty during the first 15 years of the implementation of the trade pact between the two countries.

"Procedure for allocation of Tariff Rate Quotas (TRQ) under India-UK (CETA) is notified," the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) has said in a public notice dated July 9.

It said that at the time of clearance of the import consignment, the importer in India has to produce a Certificate of Origin issued by concerned authorities in the UK.

"Only Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs), Dealers/Channel Partners duly authorised by the OEMs of vehicles originating in the UK shall be eligible to apply for the TRQ," it added.

The DGFT also said that to be eligible, each applicant will have to submit a pre-purchase agreement issued by an OEM of the vehicles in the UK setting out the quantity of

vehicles agreed to be supplied to the applicant during the TRQ year.

"The year in respect of these imports will be the period from 1st January to 31st December, ie, calendar year in India. DGFT shall monitor the cumulative quantities for TRQ Certificates issued. No TRQ Certificates shall be issued once the stated TRQ quantity limit is reached," it said.

These certificates, it said, will be valid for a maximum period of 12 months or till the end of the calendar year, whichever is earlier.

"Importers under TRQ shall

ONGC board approves plan for 1.75-million-tonne strategic oil reserve at Mangaluru

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

State-owned Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) on Friday said its board has given in-principle approval to develop a 1.75 million tonne strategic petroleum reserve at Mangaluru, expanding India's emergency crude oil storage capacity.

The project, along with associated facilities, will be developed as the Phase-I extension of the Mangaluru strategic petroleum reserve,

the company said in a stock exchange filing.

Without giving financial details or the timelines of the project, ONGC said its board also authorised the company to engage with the central government on expanding commercial utilisation of the facility, subject to the required regulatory support.

India's strategic petroleum reserve (SPR) programme was launched to strengthen the country's energy security by maintaining emergency crude oil stockpiles that can

be drawn down during supply disruptions or sharp spikes in global oil prices. The reserves are in addition to the

operational inventories maintained by oil marketing companies and refiners.

In the first phase of the pro-

SEBI launches 2 investor awareness videos on corporate bond market

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Capital markets regulator SEBI has launched two investor awareness videos on the corporate bond market as part of its efforts to deepen the debt market and enhance investor understanding.

The videos explain the importance of understanding credit rating and demystifying the 'dirty price' versus 'clean price' concept of corporate bonds, according to a release by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI).

The videos were unveiled by SEBI's Whole Time Members Amarjeet Singh and KVR Murthy during a pro-

gramme organised in collaboration with Market Infrastructure Institutions (MIIs) and other market intermediaries.

The event focused on investor awareness, issuer outreach and stakeholder engagement to deepen the corporate bond market, it added.

The latest launch is part of

SEBI's ongoing investor education initiative for the corporate bond market.

Under the initiative, the regulator rolled out four investor awareness videos during the inaugural programme on February 4, 2026, followed by two additional videos during an issuer outreach programme held in Mumbai on June 12.

Equity mutual fund inflow surges 26% to ₹28,973 crore in June

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Equity-oriented mutual fund schemes attracted ₹28,973 crore in June, a sharp surge of 26.5 per cent from the preceding month, driven by easing geopolitical tensions, expectations of supportive domestic macroeconomic conditions, and strong retail participation.

With this, net inflow into equity schemes reached to ₹1.81 lakh crore in the first half of 2026, up 12 per cent from the ₹1.61 lakh crore garnered in the same period of 2025.

Moreover, monthly SIP contributions rose to ₹31,781 crore during the month under review, up from ₹30,954

crore in May, according to data released by the Association of Mutual Funds in India (Amfi) on Friday.

Overall, the mutual fund industry's net outflow narrowed to ₹52,949 crore in June from an outflow of ₹64,131 crore in the preceding month. Consequently, the industry's asset base rose to

₹82.22 lakh crore at the end of June from ₹81.6 lakh crore a month earlier.

According to the data, net inflows into equity schemes stood at ₹28,973 crore in June, compared with ₹22,908 crore in May, which was the lowest level in a year.

The rebound indicates that investor confidence remains resilient despite ongoing global uncertainties and periodic market volatility.

"Improved market sentiment, expectations of supportive domestic macroeconomic conditions, and continued strength in retail participation helped support flows during the month," Nehal Meshram, Senior Analyst, Morningstar Investment Research India, said.

Rupee gains 14 paise to settle at 95.33 against US dollar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

The rupee rose 14 paise to settle at 95.33 (provisional) against the US dollar on Friday as the greenback weakened and crude oil prices eased despite intensifying tensions in West Asia.

FII outflows and uncertainties over fresh tensions in West Asia weighed on the local unit while positive sentiment in the domestic equity markets provided support, according to forex traders.

The US launched fresh airstrikes against Iran on early Thursday, and Tehran responded by targeting US-allied West Asian countries in an exchange of fire that threatened an interim deal intended to help end the war.

Back-and-forth attacks, including a day earlier, have repeatedly threatened the ceasefire. But Thursday's attacks appeared bigger all around, with sirens sounding at least three times in Bahrain, home to the US Navy's 5th Fleet headquarters, and missiles targeting Kuwait and Qatar.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.27 against the greenback and traded

Date	Change
July 3	+17p
July 4	+25p
July 5	+47p
July 6	-52p
July 7	+14p
July 8	+14p
July 9	+14p
July 10	+14p

in the range of 95.22 to 95.42 before eventually settling at 95.33 (provisional), up 14 paise from its previous close.

The Indian currency appreciated by just 1 paise to close at 95.47 against the US dollar on Thursday.

"The rupee fell to 95.42 this afternoon after gaining to 95.22 in the morning on a lower dollar index. However, buying by oil companies and importers kept the dollar up... improved risk appetite and expectations of continued foreign portfolio inflows provided support to the rupee," Anil Kumar Bhansali, Head of Treasury and Executive Director, Finrex Treasury Advisors LLP, said.

GOLD FUTURES DROP TO ₹1,44,670 PER 10 GRAMS

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Gold prices on Friday dropped by ₹630 to ₹1,44,670 per 10 grams in futures trade amid a fall in spot demand.

On the Multi Commodity Exchange, yellow metal contracts for August delivery traded lower by ₹630, or 0.43 per cent, at ₹1,44,670 per 10 grams in a business turnover of 975 lots.

Analysts attributed the decline in precious metal prices to weaker spot demand.

Globally, gold futures fell by 0.11 per cent to \$4,118.90 per ounce in New York.

ed from Malaysia, South Africa, and the United States of America for five years.

It is used in different sectors such as chemicals, paints, adhesives, and coatings.

Anti-dumping measures are taken to ensure fair trade and provide a level-playing field to the domestic industry.

They are not a measure to restrict imports or cause an unjustified increase in cost of products.

FROM THE WORLD

CHINA

Export of Helium blocked

China on Friday said it is temporarily blocking the export of helium, a key element for chipmaking, as the Iran war's escalation adds to global supply disruptions. China's commerce ministry and its customs agency said in a brief statement that they are imposing a temporary export ban on helium, effective immediately, in accordance with the relevant provisions of the Foreign Trade Law of the People's Republic of China.

Engraved guns, 6 bullets: Turkiye's gift to NATO heads

SUZAN FRASER ■ Ankara

Western leaders came to Turkiye to discuss security in an increasingly perilous world. They each left with a revolver and six rounds. The unconventional gift from the host of this week's NATO summit, Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan, was meant to showcase his country's growing defence industry. But it left officials across the alliance scratching their heads. Some were forced to leave their gifts behind due to gun laws in their countries, while others donated theirs to museums. "It struck me that my gift of maple syrup kind of undermatched," Canadian Prime Minister



Mark Carney told reporters, adding that the firearm was now in police possession. "I would like to reassure Canadians, they keep guns

Summit: a Magnum revolver with ammunition, engraved with my name," Hungary's new Prime Minister Peter Magyar said on X, posting a photograph of a display box containing the revolver and six cartridges. It was not immediately clear what he did with the gift. Ursula von der Leyen, the European Union commission president, thanked Erdogan for the gift, which will be decommissioned and donated to a military museum, her spokesperson said. British Prime Minister Keir Starmer told reporters that the gift bag included a note waiving export controls. Still, he left his behind to be decommissioned, because it would be illegal to

import it into Britain. Belgian Prime Minister Bart De Wever handed his revolver to airport police upon arrival. The revolvers gifted to German Chancellor Friedrich Merz and Dutch Prime Minister Rob Jetten were left at their countries' embassies in Ankara and would also be taken out of service, officials said. In Italy, the gun was logged as a gift at Palazzo Chigi—the official seat of Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni, an official said. In Greece, officials said the firearm would be donated to the War Museum. Croatian President Zoran Milanovic said he only found out after his return from the summit that Erdogan had given him a gun. His office

said it would probably be handed over to a police museum. "I didn't take it. I shoot from different weapons," Milanovic said, referring to his political style. The White House did not immediately respond to questions about Erdogan's gift to the leaders. Erdogan's office has not commented on the gift. Turkish media reports identified the revolver as the Gmusa .357 Magnum, a vintage six-shot revolver produced by the Turkish state arms manufacturer, MKE. Reports said the gun aimed to highlight Turkiye's defence industry, which in recent decades has transformed from a major importer into an increasingly self-reliant pro-

ducer of advanced military systems, including drones and warships. It is in the process of developing its own next-generation fighter jet. Gun culture is deeply rooted in Turkiye, and the gift hardly triggered any reaction in the country. Umur Vakfi, a foundation campaigning for gun control, says incidents of armed violence have reached alarming levels, reporting more than 2,700 last year in the country of 86 million people. Turkiye's State-run Anadolu Agency said participants at the summit were also given a more conventional gift: a copy of Erdogan's biography, titled: "The politics of courage: Erdogan and the rise of Turkiye." (AP)

SOUTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Follow us on @SCRRailways
Details of the Tender Notices of S.C. Railway can be seen on our website : www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

TENDER NOTICE

On Behalf of The President of India, Sr.Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer, Secunderabad Division, South Central Railway, Secunderabad Invites Open Tenders for The Following Works Through E-procurement of The Tenders

1. Tender No.& Date : C. SG. 36. 604 Dt:18/06/2026 Closing dt: 27/07/2026
Name of the work : SC-WADI Section: 1) Replacement of existing aged codal life completed Coach Indication Boards and At A Gance Display Boards as per RDSO/SPN/TC/108/2019 (Ver.- 2) or latest at Begumpet Station in SC-WADI section of Secunderabad Division. 2)Replacement of existing aged codal life completed Coach Indication Boards and At A Gance Display Boards as per RDSO/SPN/TC/108/2019 (Ver.- 2) or latest at Vikarabad Station in SC-WADI section of Secunderabad Division.3) Replacement of Integrated Passenger Information System as per RDSO/SPN/TC/108/2019 (Ver.- 2) or latest at Lingampalli Station PF. 3 SC-WADI section of Secunderabad Division.4)Replacement of codal life completed aged Train indication Boards as per RDSO/SPN/ TC/108/2019 (Ver.-2) or latest at Sirpur Kaghaznagar Station KZJ-BPO section of Secunderabad Division. **Approx Value :** (₹) 23870389.00 Bid Security EMD : (₹) 477400/-

2. Tender No.& Date : C. SG. 36. 605 Dt:18/06/2026 Closing dt: 27/07/2026
Name of the work : 1)SCR-SC Division - Gatishakti Unit - KZJ-BPO section : Proposed construction of two lane road over bridge in lieu of LC No.12 at Km 344/18-20 between Hasanpathi - Uppal stations 2)Secunderabad Division- KZJ-BPO section - Proposed construction of 2 lane ROB in lieu of LC-13 at Km.343/23-25 between HSP-OPL station- Sanction of detailed estimate- reg. 3)SCR-SC Division - Gatishakti Unit - KZJ-BPQ section: Signal and telecom arrangement in connection with proposed construction of ROB in lieu of LC 18 km no. 335/22-24 between OPL-JMKT Stations. 4)SCR-SC Division - Gatishakti Unit - KZJ-BPQ section : Proposed construction of two lane road over bridge in lieu of LC No. 23 at Km 327/11-13 between Jammiakunta - Bisgirshariff stations. 5)SCR-SC Division - Gatishakti Unit - KZJ-BPQ section: Proposed construction of Two lane Road Over Bridge in lieu of LC No.27 at Km.317/5-7 between Potkapalli-Bisgirshariff stations. **Approx Value :** (₹) 57060590.60 Bid Security EMD : (₹) 1141200/-

3. Tender No.& Date : C. SG. 36. 610 Dt:10/07/2026 Closing dt:01/08/2026
Name of the work : Telecom. 1.Telecom arrangements in connection with rehabilitation of station building at Godumgura (GDO) station in Sr.DEN/West jurisdiction. 2.Telecom arrangements in connection with rehabilitation of station building at Chitigidda(CTF) station in Sr.DEN/West jurisdiction. 3. Raising of PF 1 & PF 2 from Rail level to High level, Provision of COP and passenger amenities at Chitigidda station under Sr.DEN/West/SC Jurisdiction. 4. SEM Station: Proposed Raising of Platform No.2 to High level at Seram station. 5. SKP Station: Raising of PF.1 & 2 to HL. 6.Provision of COP ,Pathway & passenger amenities at SKP. 6. Telecom arrangements in connection with Br.NO 191 at km 166/1-2 rebuilding with RCC box. 7.SC Division :Telecom arrangement in connection with Up gradation of COP by providing SS gutters and new sheeting to arrest leakages at stations under Sr.DEN/West/SC jurisdiction. (SKP,NLP,LPI,CDNR,BRBD,BTNR,S.E.M.,M.Q.R.,C.T. 8. Telecom arrangements in connection with Construction of female block of new running room at KZJ for resting of running staff. 9.Provision of addl. COPs and up gradation of existing COPs and Up gradation of Existing COPs with new sheeting & gutter in DEN/Central jurisdiction. (up gradation of existing COPs at GNP,ALER, WP,BN,MLY and up gradation of existing COP with new sheeting & Gutter at GNP,RGP, ALER,BN,MLY stations) 10.Upgradation of COA systems at 22 locations over SC division and Provision of COA at new locations Ghatkesar, Sanathanagar, Telapur, Ramchandrapuram stations. Signal: 1. Signalling arrangement in connection with Rehabilitation of STATION MASTER room at CHITTIGIDDA (CTF) Station. 2. Signalling arrangement in connection with Rehabilitation of STATION MASTER room at GODAMGURA (GDO) Station. 3. Signalling arrangements for proposed raising of PF 1 & PF 2 from Rail level to High level, Provision of COP and passenger amenities at Chitigidda station under. **Approx Value :** (₹) 28606063.51 Bid Security EMD : (₹) 572100/-

For further details visit the website www.reps.gov.in
Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer/ Co-ord/Secunderabad

Orban allies protest in Hungary against plans to oust President Tamas Sulyok

JUSTIN SPIKE ■ Budapest

Opponents of the Hungarian government's efforts to oust the country's president gathered for a protest in the capital Budapest on Thursday after being called to action by the former autocratic prime minister, Viktor Orban. The protest drew several thousand people to the presidential offices at the opulent Sandor Palace in Budapest's Castle District, where demonstrators spoke out in defence of President Tamas Sulyok, whom the new centre-right government has vowed to remove from office with a constitutional amend-



ment. After defeating Orban in a blowout election in April, bringing an end to his 16 years in power, Hungary's new pro-European prime minister, Peter Magyar, has taken action to dismantle what he calls Orban's "mafia" by removing numerous political appointees and heads of institutions viewed as having facilitated Orban's

autocratic regime. The constitutional amendment, set to go to a vote next week, would end Sulyok's term, as well as set term limits for members of parliament, implement reforms to the judiciary and create a new authority tasked with uncovering alleged financial abuses by Orban's government. But Orban and his far-right Fidesz party, long accused of dismantling Hungary's democratic institutions while in power, have declared that the move to remove Sulyok is an assault on the rule of law and democratic norms, and the first steps toward a dictatorship. (AP)



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar with Oman Foreign Affairs Minister Badr Albusaidi during a meeting, in Muscat, Oman

Four terrorists killed in NW Pakistan

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Peshawar

Four terrorists were killed on Friday during an intelligence-based operation in the Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province in northwestern Pakistan, police said. These terrorists, affiliated with the Commander Zahid group, were killed during the joint intelligence-based operation (IBO) carried out by the Karak and Kohat districts police in the Khattak Dam area early morning, said an official of the Central Police Office (CPO) here. During the operation, the terrorists opened fire on the police party in an attempt to target security personnel.

Office of the Superintending Engineer
3rd Circle, Public Works Department, Pithoragarh
Email: sepwdph@rediffmail.com

Letter No. : 2477/58C(Yata-B)-03/2026 **Dated : 10/07/2026**

Short Term National Competitive E-Tender Notice

The Superintending Engineer 3rd Circle, Public Works Department, Pithoragarh invites tender through E-Tendering (**Two Bid System**) on behalf of Hon'ble Governor of Uttarakhand for following works. All other information will be available online from **date 13-07-2026 at 5.00 PM** onward on website <http://www.uktenders.gov.in>

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Earnest Money (In Lac)	Cost of Tender (₹)	Validity of Tender (day)	Period of Completion (months)	Contractor's Category of Registration
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Improvement of road in Madkote market of Dharachula constituency under the state plan at Munsyari, District Pithoragarh (Length 1.300 Km.),	4.70	5000.00 + 18% GST	90	9	Category "C" for Road works in any State Govt./Govt. of India/Govt. undertaking.

The Pioneer Classified

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Pankaj Pal Singh S/o Sh. Ram Hari Singh, Resident of Apartment No. NGJ 061, DLF New Town Heights, Sector-90, VTC: Hayatpur PO Wazirpur, Distt. Gurugram, Haryana-122505. Hereby declare that I am holding a passport N5595622 in which my wife name is mentioned as Swarna Lata Singh instead of Swarnlata Singh. The correct name of my wife in my Passport Swarnlata Singh.

PD(120)C I, Jagdish Sharma Father of No.21005220Y Hav (Clk SD) Kulbhushan Kumar, R/o- Vill- Shikari, PO- Ganed, PS-Tissa, Teh- Chaurah, Dist- Chamba, H.P.-176316, have changed my name from Jagdish Sharma to Jagdish Chand, vide affidavit dated 10/07/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(121)C I, Shobha B, Mother of No. 14684891K Hav Pradeesha C, R/o- 182 Field Marshal, K M Cariappa Layout, Kumbur, Kodagu, Karnataka - 571251, have changed my name from Shobha B to T C Shobha, vide affidavit dated 30/06/2026 before SDM Delhi Cantt.

PD(122)C I, hitherto known as Devinder Kumar S/o- Rohtas, R/o- WZ - 508, Nangal Raya, South West Delhi, Delhi - 110046, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Devinder.

PD(123)C I, hitherto known as Rekha Sharma W/o- Devinder, R/o- WZ - 508, Nangal Raya, South West Delhi, Delhi - 110046, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Rekha.

PD(124)C

PD(128)C

PD(116)C I, PRAMOD KUMAR GUPTA, S/O, OM. PRAKASH, D - 44, FIRST FLOOR, PRASHANT VIHAR, ROHINI SECTOR - 14, DELHI - 110085, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PRAMOD KUMAR, FOR ALL PURPOSES.

PD(117)C I, Sapna Gupta W/O Pramod Kumar, D - 44, First Floor Prashant Vihar Rohini Sector -14, have Changed My Name to Sapna for all Purposes.

PD(118)C I, Om Vati D, Mother of No.15781158Y Hav(OPR) Chandra Shaker Sharma, R/o- Vill- Avi Hafizpur, Post-Kothi Khidmatpur, Teh-Kanath, Dist- Moradabad, U.P. 244501, have changed my name from Om Vati D to Omwati, vide affidavit dated 10/07/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(119)C

PD(125)C I, Rajaka Bibi, Mother of No.14849901N Hav/MT Sahirul Alam, R/o- Vill- Bolpara, PO- Fatepur, Teh-Kandi, Dist- Murshidabad. W.B.- 742132, have changed my name from Rajaka Bibi to Rejeka Bibi, vide affidavit dated 10/07/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(126)C I, Sarla Sharma Mother of No.21005220Y Hav(Clk SD) Kulbhushan Kumar, R/o- Vill- Shikari, PO- Ganed, PS-Tissa, Teh- Chaurah, Dist- Chamba, H.P.-176316, have changed my name from Sarla Sharma to Sarla Devi, vide affidavit dated 10/07/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(127)C I, NISHA KUMARI D/o No JC469057N Rank Honey. Capt. LATE SH. AJAY KUMAR presently residing at P-102, MOHAN GARDEN, UTTAM NAGAR, WEST DELHI, DELHI-110059, declare that the name of mine has been wrongly written as Nisha Kumari Shrivastav in my father's Service records. The actual name of mine is Nisha Kumari, which may be amended accordingly.

PD(128)C

STATE BANK OF INDIA,
CRAMC New Delhi (65299), NBCC Building, 2nd Floor, Bhisma Pitamah Marg, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110003.

(RULE - 8(1) POSSESSION NOTICE (For Immovable Property)

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the State Bank of India, CRAMC, New Delhi under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a Demand Notice on 27.04.2026 calling upon the Legal Heir MR. NARAYAN JEET NEGI Spouse of Deceased Borrower: MRS. LIANBOI VAIPHIE, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being Rs.23,87,239/- (Rupees Twenty Three Lakh Eighty Seven Thousand Two Hundred Thirty Nine Only) and interest from 27.04.2026 within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The Current outstanding as on 07.07.2026 is Rs.24,62,820/- (Rupees Twenty Four Lakh Sixty Two Thousand Eight Hundred Twenty Only) + future interest + charges and other expenses etc. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower/Guarantor and the public in general that the undersigned has taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on this 8th Day of July of the Year 2026.

The borrower/Guarantor in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealing with the property will be subject to the charge of State Bank of India, CRAMC, New Delhi for an amount of Rs.24,62,820/- (Rupees Twenty Four Lakh Sixty Two Thousand Eight Hundred Twenty Only) and further interest, charges, other expenses etc. The Current outstanding as on 07.07.2026 is Rs.24,62,820/- (Rupees Twenty Four Lakh Sixty Two Thousand Eight Hundred Twenty Only) + future interest + charges and other expenses etc.

The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of Sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available to redeem the secured assets.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY:

All that part and parcel of the property bearing in the name of Mrs. Lianboi Vaiphie W/o Mr. Narayan Jeet Negi is Flat No. K-10/A - 701, Koyal Enclave - 847, Ghaziabad Development Authority, Uttar Pradesh-201006.

Place: NEW DELHI **SD/- Authorized Officer,**
Date: 08/07/2026 **State Bank of India, CRAMC, New Delhi**

ESAF SMALL FINANCE BANK

REGD. OFFICE: ESAF Bhavan
Mannuthy, Thrissur-680 651, Kerala

DEMAND NOTICE

(Notice U/s 13(2) of The Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002)

The following Borrower/s have defaulted in repayment of principal and interest of the loan facilities availed from the Bank. Their accounts have been classified as Non-Performing Assets (NPA). Demand notice under Section 13(2) of Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the Act) was issued to them in their last known addresses as provided to the Bank and the same were returned. Hence, we are constrained to cause this notice to be published.

LOAN ACCOUNT NO & BRANCH: 7124000000877 Karolbagh (New Delhi)

NAME AND ADDRESS OF THE BORROWER(S)/CO-BORROWER(S)/GUARANTOR(S):
(1) Ms. Amisha Anand, D/o. Vishal Anand, House No. 16/6, Ashok Nagar, Tiak Nagar, Durgam, West Delhi, Delhi-110018. (2) Mrs. Monika Anand, W/o. Vishal Anand, House No. 16/6, Ashok Nagar, Tiak Nagar, Durgam, West Delhi, Delhi-110018. (3) Mr. Gourav Kumar, S/o. Ramesh Kumar, D-614, 6th Floor, Madma Apartment, Sector 29, Rohini, Durgam, North Delhi, Delhi-110042.

DATE OF DEMAND NOTICE: 25/06/2026 | OUTSTANDING AMOUNT: (as on 05/06/2026): **Rs. 24,02,588.20/- (Rupees Twenty-Four Lakh Two Thousand Five Hundred Eighty-Eight and Twenty paise only).**

DESCRIPTION OF SECURED ASSETS: All that piece and parcel of DDA freehold built up Flat bearing No.3 Area measuring 33.29 Sq. Mtrs. on Ground Floor, under LG Category, in Block-A-1, Pocket-2, Sector-34, situated in the layout plan of Rohini residential scheme, Rohini, Delhi with the free hold rights of the land under the said flat, in the name of Amisha Anand. Boundaries as per Sale Deed No. 2024/21/13863. **East:** NW-Flat No.02, **West:** SW-Road 30 Feet Wide, **North:** NE-Road 15 Feet Wide, **South:** SE-Flat No.04.

The Borrowers and Guarantors mentioned above are hereby called upon under Sec. 13(2) of the Act to discharge the above-mentioned respective liabilities within 60 (Sixty) days of this notice, failing which the Bank will be exercising all or any of the rights under Sec 13(4) of the above Act. They are also liable to pay future interest at the contractual rate fixed on the aforesaid amount together with incidental expenses, costs, charges etc. They are hereby put to notice that as per terms of Sec 13(13) of the above Act, they shall not transfer by way of sale, lease or otherwise the aforesaid secured assets without the prior written consent of the Bank.

Date: 10/07/2026 **(Sd/-) Authorized Officer**
Place: Karolbagh (New Delhi) **ESAF SMALL FINANCE BANK LTD.**

PUBLIC NOTICE

J. Shama Khan, Senior Manager,
Punjab & Sind Bank, branch
Samrat, hear by inform that the
Original Power of Attorney Bearing
No 7853 Issued by head office has
been lost/misplaced. If anyone finds
this document, please contact the
nearest police station or Bank.
Further this POA treated as
cancelled.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given on behalf of Mrs. Shila Devi to inform to the public at large that Mrs. Shila Devi is purchasing the BUILT-UP FIRST FLOOR, BACK SIDE, WITHOUT GOOD FUTURE RIGHTS, AREA MEASURING 100 SQ. YDS., BUILT-ON PROPERTY BEARING NO. 27-A, OUT OF KHASRA NO. 246, SITUATED IN THE AREA OF VILLAGE NAWADA, ASADI KNOWS AS LAXMI VIHAR UTTAM NAGAR NEW DELHI-110059, from Mr. Rohan Jain who was owner through Regd. G.P.A dated 15.12.2011, as doc No. 3343, book no. 4, vol no. 623, pages 329-344, dated 15.12.2011, SR-I, Noida, which was executed by 1. Mr. Mehtab Singh 2. Mr. Belinder Singh 3. Mr. Jasbir Singh 4. Mr. Mukul Balyan same to be financed & mortgaged by Aditya Birla Housing Finance Ltd., So. to comply the requirements of BANK/NBFC, we give this public notice that any Person having any type of claim/rights/interest/creating mortgage over the said property, may inform nothing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within 15 days from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, hence:- **Lucien Legal LLP N-161, Ground Floor, Saira Tower, Gautam Nagar Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre, New Delhi-110049 Contact # 911-4045316 & 4165272**

PUBLIC NOTICE

Re: Land area measuring 200 Sq. Yds. i.e. 167.22 Hectares, more or less, situated in land area measuring 300 Sq. Yds., falling in Kharsa No. 820, situated in Balraj Nagar, Village Behta Hajipur, Pargana & Tehsil Loni, District Ghazipur, (U.P.), hereinafter referred as the said property.

NOTICE is hereby given to general public that our clients, Mrs. Shubhmitt Intotech through their partners Mr. Gaurang Kapoor (Shareholding-49%) and Mrs. Sarita Kapoor (Shareholding-51%) (hereinafter called the 'owner') is the absolute owner of the said property by virtue of C/CIS Letter issued by Possession Order dated 15.06.2024, initially Mrs. Permjit Agarwal through its Prop. Mr. Permjit Agarwal was the owner of the said property through Allotment Letter. Possession Order dated 15.06.2024, was registered on 29.09.2025 executed by GNIDA. After the death of Mr. Permjit Agarwal, the said property has been transferred to Mrs. Kailash Rani vide Mutation Letter dated 17.08.2015. Thereafter, Mrs. Kailash Rani constituted Mrs. Kailash Rani through its Prop. Mrs. Kailash Rani and further changed its constitution to Mrs. Shubhmitt Intotech LLP vide Change in Constitution Letter dated 24.09.2015 wherein Mrs. Kailash Rani holds a shareholding of 51% and Mr. Gaurang Kapoor holds a shareholding of 49%. Further shareholding of Mrs. Shubhmitt Intotech LLP changed through an Agreement dated 26.10.2025 and accordingly Mr. Gaurang Kapoor has 49% share and Mrs. Sarita Kapoor hold 51% share of Mrs. Shubhmitt Intotech LLP. The said owner has also informed that the said property is not mortgaged anywhere and there is no dispute or any litigation pending upon the said property.

Any person including Banks, Financial Institutions, relatives having any claim right, title or any interest of any nature whatsoever into or upon the said property is hereby called upon to make the same known, in writing, with documentary evidence, by Registered Ad Post, to the undersigned at the address mentioned herein below within 07 days of publication of this notice and in the event of non-response having been received to the notice, the title of the owner in respect of the said property shall be deemed to be clear of any charge or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever and any subsequent claim shall not bind our client/owner, in any manner whatsoever.

Shivkant Arora, Advocate
For M/s Intelective Law Offices
A-74, LGF, Defence Colony,
New Delhi-110024

BSES

BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, New Delhi

TENDER NOTICE **Date: 11.07.2026**

Tender under two parts (Un-priced & priced) are invited for the supply of following materials from all bidders:-

NIT No.	Brief Item Description	Estimated Cost (₹)	Cost of EMD (₹)	Due Date & Time of Submission	Date & Time of Opening
CMC/BR-26/27/FK/PR/RJ/1371	RATE CONTRACT FOR THE PROCUREMENT OF VARIOUS RATINGS OF OIL TYPE DISTRIBUTION TRANSFORMERS UPTO 100 KVA IN BRPL	8.70 Crores	8,70,000	01.08.2026 15:00 HRS	01.08.2026 15:30 HRS

Cost of each Tender Document: ₹ 1180/-

For any query call on 011-49107235 or e-mail on Brpl.Eauction@relancengroupindia.com. For details in respect of Equipment/BOM/Services, Qualifying requirements, Terms & conditions, purchase/submit of tender documents etc. please visit our website www.bsesdelhi.com

Head (Contracts & Materials)

Regd. Off. : BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, BSES Bhawan, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019 | Corporate Identification No.: U40109DL2001PL11527
Telephone No. : +91 11 4910 7235 | Website : www.bsesdelhi.com

Spain battles deadly wildfire as death toll hits 11

SUMAN NAISHADHAM
■ Madrid

A wildfire in southern Spain killed at least 11 people overnight into Friday morning, making it one of the country's deadliest on record, as soaring temperatures grip much of the country, authorities said.

Several victims of the fire in Almeria, a popular holiday destination, were found inside burnt-out vehicles. Eight others have been injured in the blaze, which 150 firefighters and 220 soldiers from Spain's military emergency unit were battling. Regional emergency authorities said four British nationals and other unspecified foreign nationals



appeared to be among the victims. Andalusia's regional leader Juan Manuel Moreno told Cadena Ser radio station that 19 people were un-

counted for. Authorities reported earlier that 12 people had died, but revised the death toll Friday morning. The fire broke out in a

hamlet in a semi-arid area near the Sierra de Los Filabres mountains.

Authorities have not confirmed the cause, but said people who called to report the fire said that a fallen power line had sparked a blaze that spread rapidly into a nearby forest.

Most of the victims died while attempting to flee and ignored shelter-in-place instructions, said Antonio Sanz, president of Andalusia's emergency services. One group did so via a dry riverbed, which "turned into a death trap," he said.

Seven people died while on foot after abandoning their cars, Sanz said, likely looking for a way out.

"The consequences have

been terrible. Everything seems to indicate that, in the case of the deceased ... we are dealing for the most part, if not entirely, with foreign nationals," Sanz said.

Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sanchez expressed his condolences. "Immense sadness and desolation in the face of the terrible consequences of the fire affecting the province of Almeria," he wrote on X.

Spain has battled frequent and severe heat waves in recent years, with temperatures often exceeding 40 degrees Celsius. Wind, high temperatures and little rainfall help small wildfires grow into unchecked blazes.

In June, Spain experienced several days of record-setting

heat, with over 1,000 excess deaths attributed to heat.

Europe is the world's fastest-warming continent, with temperatures increasing twice as fast as the global average since the 1980s, according to the European Union's Copernicus Climate Change Service.

Parts of Western Europe are facing their third heat wave in six weeks. Globally, 2025 was the third-hottest year on record, bringing several intense heat waves across Europe.

France is experiencing the peak of its third heatwave of the summer, with temperatures reaching 40 degrees Celsius across western and central areas and around 37 degrees Celsius in Paris. (AP)

Treasury loss of \$2.5M caused by cybercrime, says Sri Lanka



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Colombo

A Sri Lankan parliamentary oversight committee on Friday ruled that \$2.5 million lost to hacking of the Finance Ministry's payment system was a cybercrime caused by lapses at the ministry's operational level.

In late April, it was revealed that \$2.5 million from the Government Treasury account

was sent to bank accounts controlled by cybercriminals as a result of hacking during a foreign debt repayment to Australia in January. This was a part of a \$22.9 million debt settlement. The Committee on Public Finance (COPF) appointed to investigate the incident found that it was cyber fraud, its chairman Harsha de Silva, an opposition legislator, told parliament.

Two Chinese military pilots killed in training exercises, claim media reports



KJM VARMA ■ Beijing

A high-ranking tactical commander was among two Chinese military pilots killed during frontline flight training exercises last month, according to media reports on Friday.

China, which seldom discloses military fatalities, has not made any statement about the deaths, and it was not known if the pilots died in the same incident, the Hong Kong-based South China Morning Post reported, quoting regional Government notices and local media reports.

One of the pilots, 38-year-old Fang Ming, was a senior colonel who served as a tactical commander under the People's Liberation Army (PLA) Southern Theatre Command Naval Aviation unit, the Post reported, citing a Hefei Daily report. Shi Shaoyong, 25, a first lieutenant in the PLA Navy, also died on June 10, and was from the Southern Theatre Command. Shi died during a night flight training mission, according to an image of the inscription on his tombstone posted by the Yishui Government on Saturday.

The inscription said Shi, who hailed from Yishui in the northern province of

Shandong, was serving in Unit 91911, which also comes under the Southern Theatre Command Naval Aviation division. It was not clear whether they were on the same aircraft or the same mission. Fang, of Lujiang County in the eastern Chinese province of Anhui, enlisted in 2006.

Lujiang local Government posted a video on Monday stating that Fang died while carrying out flight training on June 10. Lujiang authorities hosted a memorial service for Fang on July 3, which was attended by more than 200 people, including personnel from his unit, according to the Government video post.

It said the Political Work Department of the Southern Theatre Command Naval Aviation unit recognised Fang - who was awarded a third-class merit in 2018 and a second-class merit for combat readiness and training in 2022 - as a "martyr."

"His aspiration was to defend our country's skies and seas. Whether in daily training or while carrying out operational missions, he always volunteered to take the lead," said Xia Yong, who used to work with Fang, according to the video post. (AP)

China issues heavy storm alert for Beijing

KJM VARMA ■ Beijing

China on Friday issued a heavy storm alert for capital Beijing and neighbouring Hebei Province, asking the concerned Government departments to be ready for emergency response for geological disasters.

Influenced by the southwest monsoon and Typhoon Bavi, torrential rains are likely to hit some parts of north China from Friday to Monday. Some areas in Beijing and Hebei are likely to receive 300-350 mm of rain, the Ministry of Emergency Management (MEM) said, citing meteorological forecast.

The ministry asked relevant authorities in affected



regions to deploy rescue forces, supplies and equipment, and intensify inspections and early warning, state-run Xinhua news agency reported.

China's national obser-

vatory on Friday renewed an orange alert for Typhoon Bavi, the ninth typhoon of 2026, which is expected to bring gales and heavy rain to eastern China. At 8 a.m., the centre of Bavi was

located approximately 1,020 km southeast of the boundary between Fujian and Zhejiang provinces in eastern China. China has a four-tier emergency response system, with Level I being the most severe. Due to severe weather conditions, flights have been cancelled in at least 10 airports, as Typhoon Bavi nears China's coast, where it is likely to land between Fuzhou in Fujian province and Wenzhou in Zhejiang.

Zhoushan airport said in a social media post that 14 flights to and from the island city in Zhejiang province, eastern China, were cancelled for Friday. In Wenzhou, 17 inbound flights have been cancelled. (PTI)

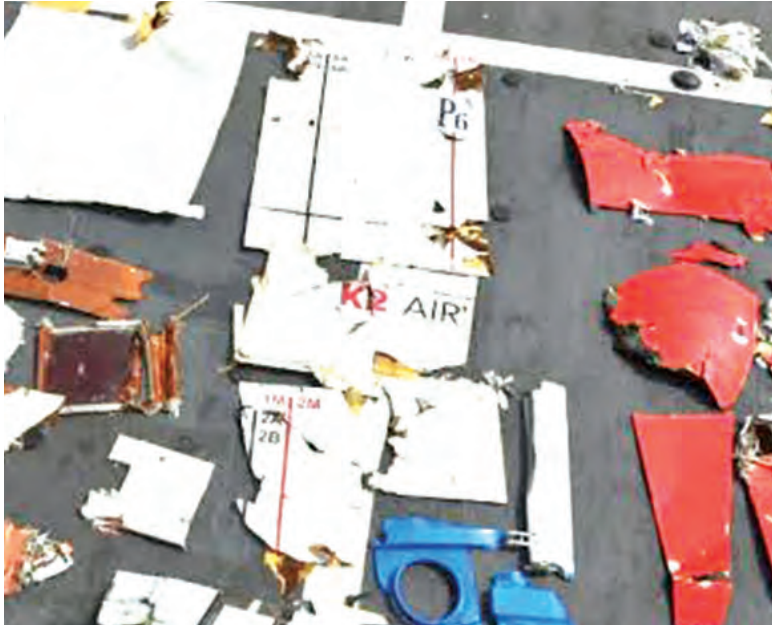
Pakistan: More wreckage of crashed cargo plane found, search continues for missing crew

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Karachi

Pakistan's search and rescue teams on Friday retrieved more pieces of debris of the cargo plane that had crashed into the Arabian Sea with five crew members on board early this week. The Boeing 737 cargo aircraft, operated by Karachi-based private airline K2 Airways, vanished from radar after it was seen descending rapidly and making a sudden change in direction during the flight from Sharjah to Karachi on Tuesday night.

The wreckage of the aircraft was recovered from 53 nautical miles south of Ormara on the Balochistan coast on Wednesday. However, there was no sign of the missing five crew members, according to officials.

"Search and Rescue (SAR) missions by the Pakistan Navy (PN) and Pakistan Maritime Security Agency (PMSA) in the deep sea remain underway," the Pakistan Airports Authority (PAA) said in a statement on Friday. "The search for the crew members is continuing with full vigour through the coordinat-



ed employment of aerial and sea-borne assets," it said.

"Additional parts and debris of the

ill-fated aircraft have been located and retrieved for subsequent analysis by the investigation team," it added.

EU demands Meta dismantle addictive design features for users

KELVIN CHAN ■ London

The Europe Union accused Meta on Friday of breaching its social media law by designing Facebook and Instagram to get users hooked, and demanded it disable "key addictive features" like infinite scrolling.

The EU's executive arm issued a fresh set of charges against Meta Platforms as part of its investigation under the 27-nation bloc's strict digital rule book known as the Digital Services Act. The sweeping set of regulations from Brussels requires tech platforms to protect internet users under threat of hefty fines. The European Commission said Meta failed to properly assess the risks its design features pose to the physical and mental health of users, including minors. And while the company has tools and controls to help manage Facebook and Instagram use, it said they were easily overridden, dismissed, or technically challenging to use.

Meta "needs to implement design changes" to Instagram and Facebook, such as disabling "key addictive features" like autoplay of videos and infinite scroll so they're not turned on by default, the commission said in its preliminary findings.



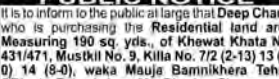
Meta now has the chance to respond and defend itself before the commission issues its final decision, which could result in a fine worth up to 6 per cent of the company's global annual revenue. Meta said Friday that the preliminary findings do not recognise the steps that the company has already taken to protect teens.

"Since this investigation began, we rolled out Teen Accounts that automatically protect teens and put parents in control - allowing them to block access to Instagram at night and cap daily screen time at just 15 minutes," Meta said in a prepared statement. "We share the European Commission's commitment to providing teens with safe, positive online experiences and will continue to engage constructively with them."

Europe is committed to enforcing its legislation that holds platforms accountable

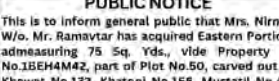
for addictive design features, said Henna Virkkunen, an executive vice-president at the commission overseeing tech. "Protecting the physical and mental health of Europeans must be a priority for social media platforms," Virkkunen, said in a written statement. Facebook and Instagram design features, including personalised recommendations and push notifications, serve up an endless stream of content, putting users' brains on "autopilot" and fuelling compulsive use, the commission said. Meanwhile, screen time controls that parents can impose on their teens' devices can be "easily dismissed" and don't result in a meaningful reduction of use, the commission said.

And the controls are undermined by the technical expertise, time and effort that parents need to understand and use them, it said. (AP)



PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that Deep Chand who is purchasing the Residential land area Measuring 180 sq. yds., of Khevat Khata No. 431471, Muskhil No. 9, Killa No. 72 (2-13) 13 (8-0) 14 (8-0), waka Mouje Bannikhera Tehsil SDist., Pailwal, from Mr. Bhudev Sharma and same to be financed by Ujjivan small finance bank. That, Sale deed dated 12.06.2019 executed by Mr. Pawan Kumar favouring Mr. Bhudev Sharma in respect of Residential land area 180 sq. yds., Khevat Khata No. 431471, Muskhil No. 9, Killa No. 72 (2-13) 13 (8-0) 14 (8-0), waka Bannikhera Tehsil & Dist., Pailwal. Vide doc No. 3709, book No. 1, vol no. 578, pages 128-578-76, dated 12.06.2019, SD-PALWAL, have been lost/not available, if any Person having any type of claim/rights/interest over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about all the objections, within 15 days from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, i.e. etc. Lucien Legal LLP N-161, Ground Floor, Saira Tower, Gautam Nagar Near Yusuf Sara Community Centre, New Delhi-110049 Contact # 011-40646316 & 41667237



PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform general public that Mrs. Nirmla W/o. Mr. Ramnarayan has acquired Eastern Portion, measuring 75 Sq. Yds., vide Property ID No.1BEH4M42, part of Plot No.50, carved out of Khevat No.132, Khateel No.156, Mustail No.48, Killa No.148(8-0), situated at Village Baravali, Tehsil & District Faridkot (Haryana) vide by way of Sale Deed dated 22.05.2026 registered as Document No. 2117. Document related to the above said property has been misplaced i.e. Sale Deed (Doc. No. 3640) dated 28.06.2023 in respect of the said property. If anyone who find the above said documents shall handover the same to the Manager of Truhome Finance Limited (earlier known as Shivram Housing Finance Ltd.) in case anyone has any objection, the same may be raised within 7 days of the publication to Mr. Ajit Sharma (Advocate), Partner of Acoulaw Source LLP, Unit No. S-2-U, 2nd Floor, built on Plot no. 4 and S. Ansal Utility Commercial Centre, Pashchim Vihar, New Delhi-110063 or contact :- 91 9560308093 (M).



M.P. URJA VIKAS NIGAM LIMITED
(DEPARTMENT OF NEW AND RENEWABLE ENERGY
GOVERNMENT OF MADHYA PRADESH)

Urja Bhawan Link Road No. 2, Near Bus Stop No. 5, Shivaji Nagar, Bhopal- 462016, Tel. No.: +91-755-2553595, 2556566, 2767270
Website : <https://mpuvn.mp.gov.in/#/> E-mail : saurabh.sachan@mpuvn.mp.gov.in, resco4.mpuvn@gmail.com
RFP No. F/UVN/2025/RFT/RESCO-X/03-231/1309 Dated: 09.07.2026

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Madhya Pradesh Urja Vikas Nigam Limited invites bids from the bidders to participate through this Request for Proposal (RfP) for discovery of tariff and selection of Solar Power Developers for Design, Engineering, Supply, Financing, Installation, Testing and Commissioning along with Comprehensive Operation & Maintenance for twenty five (25) Operational Years of Grid Connected Roof Top Solar PV Projects for sale of Solar Power under RESCO Mode, at various government premises in 9 districts of Madhya Pradesh (Alirajpur, Damoh, Maihar, Narsinghpur, Pandhurna, Sheopur, Sidhi, Singrauli, Ujjain) under One District-One Resco model.

Bid documents, which include eligibility criteria, technical specifications, conditions of agreements, formats etc., can be viewed for reference from website of Nodal Agency <https://mpuvn.mp.gov.in/#/> and can be downloaded from the website <https://mptenders.gov.in/nicep/app>. The RFP document will be available by 13.07.2026.

M..P. Madhyam/126825/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**



कार्यालय नगर पालिक निगम, (यांत्रिकी शाखा), भोपाल

क्रमांक 62 / यां.वि./2026 भोपाल, दिनांक 08/07/2026

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

निम्न कार्य हेतु म.प्र. लोक निर्माण विभाग में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से आनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। विस्तृत विवरण [website https://www.mptenders.gov.in](https://www.mptenders.gov.in) पर है।

क्र.	निविदा क्र.	कार्य का संक्षिप्त विवरण	अनुमानित लागत (रु.में)	निविदा क्रय करने का अंतिम
01	2026 UAD 520026 1	WIDENING AND CONST. OF C.C. ROAD AND DRAIN FROM BHOURI BYPASS TO NEAR VISHRAM GHAT IN BHOURI WARD 03 ZONE 01 SANT HIRDARAM NAGAR	2,06,86,397/-	दिनांक 10-AUG-2026 समय 05:30 PM

नोट - संशोधन केवल वेबसाइट पर ही देखे जा सकेंगे, समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित नहीं होंगे। कार्यपालन यंत्री (सिविल) नगर निगम भोपाल

नि. क्र. 422/026/027



INDAG RUBBER LIMITED
(CIN: L74899DL1978PLC009038)
Regd. Office: 11, Community Centre, Saket, New Delhi -110017.
Ph. No. 011-26963172/73, E-mail id: info@indagrubber.com,
Website: www.indagrubber.com

Information regarding Forty-Seventh (47th) Annual General Meeting of Indag Rubber Ltd.

- Notice is hereby given that the **Forty-Seventh (47th) Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Members of Indag Rubber Limited (the "Company")** will be held on **Wednesday, August 12, 2026 at 05:00 P.M. (IST)** through Video Conferencing ("VC")/Other Audio Visual Means ("OAVM"), in compliance with all the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the Rules made thereunder and SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (Listing Regulations) read with General Circular No. 14/2020 dated April 08, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020 and subsequent circulars issued in this regard, the latest being 3/2025 dated September 22, 2025, by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs and all other relevant circulars issued from time to time ("MCA Circulars") and Circulars issued by the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI Circulars"), (collectively referred to as "relevant circulars"), to transact the business as set out in the Notice calling the AGM.
- In compliance with the relevant circulars and in support of green initiatives, the Notice of 47th AGM and the Annual Report for the financial year 2025-26 will be sent through electronic mode to those members whose email addresses are registered with the Company/RTA/Depository Participant(s). A letter containing web-link of Notice of 47th AGM and the Annual Report for the financial year 2025-26 shall be sent at the registered address of shareholders whose email addresses are not registered with the Company/RTA/Depository Participant(s). The aforesaid documents will also be made available on the Company's website at www.indagrubber.com, on the website of BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and on the website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com. Members can attend and participate in the ensuing AGM through VC/OAVM only and such Members shall be reckoned for the purpose of quorum under Section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013. Remote e-voting facility is provided to Members to cast their votes on all/any of the Resolutions set out in the Notice of AGM. Members have option to cast their vote using the remote e-voting facility prior to the AGM or during the AGM. Detailed procedure for remote e-voting is provided in the Notice of the AGM.
- Manner of registering/ updating email addresses by the Members is given below:**
 - Members holding shares in physical form may register/ update their email address in prescribed form ISR-1 and send it to the RTA of the Company i.e. Skyline Financial Services Pvt. Ltd., D-153/A, 1st Floor, Phase-1, Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi-110020.
 - Members holding shares in demat mode may contact their respective Depository Participants (DPs).
- Manner of casting vote(s) through e-voting is given below:**
 - The manner of voting remotely ("remote e-voting") by members holding shares in dematerialised mode, physical mode and for members who have not registered their email addresses will be provided in the Notice of the AGM. The details will also be available on the website of the Company at www.indagrubber.com.
 - The facility for voting through electronic voting system will also be made available at the AGM and Members attending the AGM who have not cast their vote(s) by remote e-voting and are not debarred will be able to vote at the AGM.
 - The login credentials for casting votes through e-voting shall be made available to the members through email. Members who do not receive email or whose email addresses are not registered with the Company/ Depository Participant(s), may generate login credentials by following instructions given in the Notes to Notice of the AGM.
 - The same login credentials may also be used for attending the AGM through VC/ OAVM.
- The Board of Directors in their meeting held on May 28, 2026 had recommended a Final Dividend of Rs. 1.50/- per equity Share of face value of Rs. 2/- each. The Register of Members and Share Transfer Books of the Company will remain closed from August 06, 2026 to August 12, 2026 (both days inclusive). The Final Dividend, if approved by the Shareholders at the ensuing AGM, will be paid on or before September 10, 2026, to those Shareholders whose names appear in the Register of Members as of August 5, 2026, in respect of shares held in physical form, and to those beneficial owners whose names appear in the records furnished by NSDL/CDSL as of the close of business hours on August 5, 2026, in respect of shares held in dematerialized form.
- SEBI, vide its Circular SEBI/HO/MIRSD/POD-1/P/CIR/2023/181 dated November 17, 2023, read with subsequent circulars issued in this regard, if any, has mandated registration of PAN, KYC details and Nomination, by holders of physical securities. As per the said mandate, Shareholders, holding securities in physical form, whose folio(s) are not updated with any of the KYC details [viz., (i) PAN; (ii) Choice of Nomination; (iii) Contact Details; (iv) Mobile Number; (v) Bank Account Details and (vi) Signature] shall be eligible for any payment including dividend, interest or redemption in respect of such folios, only through electronic mode with effect from April 1, 2024. In accordance with the above, dividends, in respect of physical folios wherein any of the above KYC details (except choice of Nomination) are not updated before the Record Date, will be held back by the Company. Shareholders may please note that the dividends will get credited to their bank account only after the KYC details are updated in the folio.
- Pursuant to the changes introduced by the Finance Act, 2020, dividends paid or distributed by the Company after 1st April 2020, shall be taxable in the hands of the Members and the Company shall be required to deduct tax at source (TDS) at the prescribed rates from the dividend to be paid to Members. The TDS rate would vary depending on the residential status of the Members and the documents submitted by them and accepted by the Company. The shareholders are requested to update their PAN with the RTA (where shares are held in Physical mode) and with depositories (where shares are held in dematerialised mode). The aforesaid documents must reach the Company on or before July 31, 2026 in order to enable the Company to determine and deduct appropriate TDS/ withholding tax on payment of dividend. Members sending documents through e-mail are also required to send the executed documents (in original) at the Registered Office of the Company.
- This Notice is being issued for the information and benefits of all the Shareholders of the Company in compliance with the relevant circulars issued by MCA and SEBI.

By order of the Board
For Indag Rubber Limited
Sd/-
Sonal Garg
Company Secretary
(ACS 24598)

Date: July 10, 2026
Place: New Delhi

BRIEFLY

Olympic gold medalist out of Commonwealth Games



Five-time Olympic swimming gold medalist Kaylee McKeown is out of the Commonwealth Games and the Pan Pacific Championships which follow due to glandular fever.

The star backstroke won both the 100 – and 200-metre distances at the Tokyo Olympics and repeated the feat at the Paris Games in 2024. She also won both events at the world championships in Singapore last year.

“I am gutted to medically withdraw,” McKeown said in a Swimming Australia statement on Friday.

“What I thought a few months ago was flu has turned out to be my body fighting glandular fever.

“I was sick going into trials and I have just not got better and I am worried about pushing myself so hard that I end up with chronic fatigue. It was a hard decision to make but the right one.” The 24-year-old McKeown is planning to swim at the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

The Commonwealth Games will be held in Glasgow, Scotland from July 23 to August 2, with the six-day swimming event starting July 24.

(AP)

Archery WC: Indian recurve teams crash out in quarterfinals



Dhiraj Bommadevara and Kirti Sharma reached bronze play-off in recurve mixed event, while India crashed out in the quarterfinals of both the men's and women's team events after defeats to the USA in the Archery World Cup Stage 4 on Thursday. Dhiraj, fresh from winning gold with Kumkum Mohod at the Antalya World Cup last month, partnered Kirti for the first time and the duo defeated the Netherlands 6-2, Japan 5-3 before going down to China 3-5 in the semifinal. They will now face Italy in the bronze play-off.

In compound section, the mixed pair of Prithika Pradeep and Sahil Jadhav lost to the Mexican duo Miguel Becerra and Ximena Estrada 153-153 (19-20) in the shoot-out.

Veteran four-time Olympian Deepika Kumari exited in the second round and Asian Games-bound Yashdeep Bhoge crashed out in the opening round, while all other six archers remained in fray in their respective individual categories across men and women sections.

(PTI)

Gill logs top-20 in Asian Development Tour, stays on path to Asian Tour

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Taipei

India's Pukhraj Singh Gill fired three consistent rounds of three-under 69 each to finish a tidy Tied-19th in the Ever Glory ADT Open on the Asian Development Tour here on Friday.

The Ludhiana star, who won the Am Green IGPL Order of Merit in India in 2025, has been focussing on earning his way into the Asian Tour via the Asian Development Tour.

With 69-69-69, Gill totalled nine-under 204 and was Tied-19th. Gill, who plays for the Honer Homes Gurugram on the AM Green IGPL, is now sixth on the Merit List and stands a great chance of making it to the 2027 Asian Tour as the Top-10 players advance to the higher Tour.

Last year Karandeep Kochhar, a colleague of Gill on AM Green IGPL took the same



route. Nathan Han of the USA birdied the first playoff hole to defeat Sean Ramos of the Philippines and win the Ever Glory ADT Open after Typhoon Bavi forced tournament officials to reduce the championship to 54 holes.

Among other Indians in the field, Khalin Joshi (68-67-69) totalled 12-under and finished Tied-12th. Kartik Singh (74-68) missed the 36-hole cut.

LA uses World Cup to show off upgraded public transit

JAIMIE DING ■ Los Angeles

When Matthew Smith took his five-year-old son to a World Cup game in the Los Angeles area earlier this month, they opted to take public transit instead of driving from their nearby coastal city.

It was Smith's first time on the LA Metro in a decade, and the experience exceeded his expectations.

“Seems like a very functioning transit system, which is somewhat surprising given its reputation,” he said.

That is the reaction Metro officials were hoping for as they used the 2026 FIFA World Cup's eight LA games to introduce—or reintroduce—people to the region's public transit system, often an afterthought in car-centric Los Angeles. It is an early test run of sorts for the 2028 Olympics, which organisers have billed as a “no car” Games where there will be no parking for attendees at any of the venues. Spectators will have to rely on transit and shuttles to get to events.

Nearly 50,000 rides were taken on rail lines for the July 2 Spain-



Austria game that Smith and his son attended. There is no train that runs directly to SoFi Stadium in the LA suburb of Inglewood, but Metro has added 15 shuttle lines to transport people there from major rail stations and transit centers—the farthest route taking one hour and 15 minutes. More than 30,000 rides were taken on those shuttles for that game alone, the agency said.

The Metro will take a similar approach for the Olympics because

many venues don't connect directly to the system. For the World Cup, the agency borrowed about 200 buses to meet the increased demand. Officials have said they will need to borrow 3,000 buses for

the Olympics. Officials work to overcome safety fears: For many residents, public transit isn't baked into everyday life in Los Angeles, the nation's second most-populous city, quite the same way it is in other major urban centers like New York and Chicago. LA Metro estimates the system provides about 1 million rides each day—roughly the same as Chicago, a smaller city. In New York, meanwhile, it is well over 3 million on the average weekday.

Many view LA's rail and bus system as unreliable at best and unsafe at worse. Certain high-profile violent incidents, such as a 67-year-old woman who died from being stabbed on a Metro train in 2024, have driven those percep-

tions. Some riders are also concerned about drug use, cleanliness and the presence of homeless people.

In June, Metro opened applications for its police force, which it hopes to have fully deployed by 2029 to replace the LAPD. The agency hopes having its own sworn officers working along with homeless outreach and crisis response teams will help riders feel safer on its trains and buses. Metro has also touted data that showed a decline in violent crime over the past two years, with a 13.6 per cent decrease in overall crime in March 2026 compared to a year before.

Martha Banauelos used the transit system sporadically before but generally preferred to “avoid it like the plague.” She started riding the trains again recently to get into the city from North Hollywood for World Cup watch parties. (AP)

Kylian Mbappe has a goal and an assist as France beats Morocco 2-0 in World Cup quarterfinals



KYLE HIGHTOWERAP
■ Foxborough (US)

Kylian Mbappe spread his arms out wide and spun around after scoring his eighth goal of this year's World Cup. He later gave the jubilant France fans dotted around the stadium a wave when he left the game because of an injury scare.

Les Bleus, with a star striker who said he's fine despite a right ankle issue, are headed back to the semifinals for the third straight World Cup tournament. Mbappe had a goal and an assist after missing a first-half penalty kick, Ousmane Dembele also scored and two-time champion France beat Morocco 2-

0 on Thursday in the quarterfinals.

“There's only one way to relax, and that's by winning. Until we've done that, we don't let up,” Mbappe said.

“We're in the semifinals and we're very happy, but there's still a long way to go.”

Mbappe's goal in the 60th minute was the 20th of his World Cup career and came in his 20th match at the tournament, moving him one behind Argentina captain Lionel Messi.

Dembele scored his fifth goal of the tournament in the 66th. Mbappe went down to the ground in the 76th minute, about 13 minutes after being hit hard by a Moroccan defender, and was

taken off for a substitute a minute later. He was then shown sitting on the bench with an ice pack on his right ankle. After the match and with both shoes on, Mbappe ran and jumped in celebration with his teammates.

“I took a knock to the ankle, but I'm fine,” Mbappe said. “At that point, JP (Jean-Philippe Mateta) was in better shape than I was to play the final minutes.”

France will face either Spain or Belgium in the semifinals in Dallas on Tuesday.

France beat Morocco by the same score in the semifinals of the 2022 tournament in Qatar when the Atlas Lions became the first African team to make it that far. France now remains on track to become only the third nation to play in the final of three consecutive World Cups.

“It is a confirmation of how we've played so far,” said France coach Didier Deschamps, who added there is a reason for his team's success in recent World Cups.

“Having great players.

Excellent players. My credit goes to the players. But maybe I do my job well,” he

said. “The only truth is the one on the pitch.” Mbappe got his goal with a perfectly

placed shot just inside the far post after Morocco failed to clear the ball.

Aditi tied 35th, Japan's Iwai leads at Evian Championship



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Evian-Les-Bains (France)

Indian golfer Aditi Ashok opened with an erratic one-under 70 to be tied for the 35th position after the opening round of the Amundi Evian Championship, which is a Major on the women's circuit.

Aditi, a five-time winner on the Ladies European Tour, and a champion at Hero Women's Indian Open in 2016, is playing the tournament for the ninth time, but has finished in Top-25 only once. She trails Japan's Aki Iwai by seven shots. Aditi had two birdies and two bogeys on the front side of the course and then one bogey and back to back birdies on the 14th and the 15th.

Iwai fired a bogey-free opening round of eight-under 63 to hold a two-stroke lead at the end of the first day of action. The 24-year-old teed off in the morning, making her first birdie of the day on the fifth hole followed by birdies on seventh and ninth.

Egypt's soccer team gets warm welcome home after World Cup loss

MOHAMED SALAH/FATMA KHALED
■ El-Alamein

Thousands of fans turned out to greet Egypt's national soccer team on its return home Friday after its World Cup adventure ended with a 3-2 loss to Argentina in the knockout stage of the tournament.

Crowds gathered at the el-Alamein airport, waving photos of star player Mohamed Salah and holding signs celebrating the team's achievements as they cheered the players' return.

Egypt made it to the last 16

teams in the tournament for the first time after beating Australia 4-2 on penalty kicks, led by Salah.

The players are expected to meet Saturday with Egyptian President Abdel-Fattah el-Sissi, who thanked the team in a Facebook statement on Tuesday “for their honorable performance and for achieving an unprecedented milestone in the history of Egyptian soccer.”

Emotions ran high across Egypt on Tuesday as supporters gathered in coffee shops, homes and public squares to watch the match



against Argentina, with Egyptian flags draped from balconies, storefronts and streets. The Egyptian Football Association, or EFA, said Wednesday that it's deeply

dissatisfied with the refereeing in Tuesday's match and decisions related to the Video Assistant Referee, or VAR system. Egypt coach Hossam Hassan and several players

criticised the referees after Argentina scored three unanswered goals in 13 minutes to pull off one of the biggest comebacks in World Cup history. “Defending the rights and interests of the Egyptian national team is not a matter that can be ignored, minimized, or treated as secondary,” the EFA said in a statement.

In a statement issued later Wednesday, the head of refereeing for soccer's world governing body FIFA, Pierluigi Collina, said the debate over decisions is a natural part of soccer.

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Unit 203 & 204, 2nd Floor, 'A' Wing, Navbharat Estate, Zakaria Bunder Road, Sewri (West), Mumbai 400015, Maharashtra. CIN No.: U65922MH2005PLC272501		
Demand Notice Under Section 13(2) of Securitisation Act of 2002		
Whereas, Vastu Housing Finance Corporation Ltd through its head office Mumbai, Notice issued to the following borrowers / guarantors / mortgagors have defaulted in the repayment of principal and payment of interest of credit facilities obtained by them from the VFHCL and said facilities have turned to be Non Performing Assets. The notices were issued to them under section 13(2) of Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 on their last known addresses however the same have returned un-served and as such they are hereby informed by way of public notice about the same.		
Name of Borrower, Co-borrower and Loan A/c No.	Date and Amount of Demand Notice Under Sec. 13(2)	Description of Mortgaged property
PREETI . (Applicant), JAGVEER . (Co Borrower), SATEESH . (Guarantor) MLP000000255522	26-06-2026 Rs. 668120/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, Measuring area 82.05 Sq.Mts. Part of Khasra no. 875 Mauza Sahar, Tehsil Goverdhan Dist. Mathura.281502. North: Land of Jagveer. South: House of Bhagwat. East: Land of Gram Samaj. West: Road less than 6 Mtr wide.
SABIR . (Applicant), NAJARANA . (Co Borrower), ADIL . (Co Borrower) LP0000000128270	26-06-2026 Rs. 586667/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, PROPERTY ON LAND MEASURING AREA 239.70 SQ.Mts. SITUATED AT IN MAUZA- BAGH KELA. KASBA- KIRAWALI TEHSIL KIRAWALI AND DISTTAGRAPIN 283122. North: Plot of Sayedo. South: Open Plot of Ramwali. East: Rasta 10 ft. West: House of Fool Singh Chhahar.
MANENDRA SINGH (Applicant), BRAJESH KUMARI (Co Borrower), RAMESH RAMESH (Guarantor) MLP000000201528	26-06-2026 Rs. 497973/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, RESIDENTIAL HOUSE OF LAND AREA MEASURING 122.62 SQ. METERS, OUT OF KHASRA NO. 153, SITUATED AT VILLAGE PADU, PARGANA MURSAN, TEHSIL DISTRICT HATHRAS UTTAR PRADESH 204213 North: Plot of Donor. South: House of Pliam Sinh. East: Rasta 14 Feet Wide. West: House of Malkhan Singh.
MEENA DEVI (Applicant), BANSI LAL (Co Borrower), RAHUL . (Guarantor) MLP000000187433	26-06-2026 Rs. 757899/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, Land Measuring 139.40 Sq Mtr. out of Khasra no. 361, Mauza Kamal, Tehsil Chhata Dist, Mathura, Uttar Pradesh 281403. North: Land of Prahlad. South: Road 15 feet wide. East: Road 18 feet. West: Land of Smt. Neetu.
RAJVEER . (Applicant), ANJU . (Co Borrower), SANTOSH KUMAR SHARMA (Guarantor) MHL000000220352	26-06-2026 Rs. 557151/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, RESIDENTIAL PART OF PLOT NO. 14 AREA MEASURING 62.5 SQ. YARDS I.E. 52.25 SQ. METERS, KHASRANO. 343, SITUATED AT BANKE KRISHNA DHAM COLONY, NAGLA BASUA, TEHSIL DISTRICT AGRA UTTAR PRADESH, 203105. North: Part of Plot No. 14, South: Land of Others. East: Land of Praveen Trivedi. West: Rasta Exit 18 Feet Wide.
IRFAN . (Applicant), MISKINA . (Co Borrower), IKRAM . (Guarantor) MLP000000241771	26-06-2026 Rs. 675580/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, Area Measuring 102.35 Sq. Mtr., Part Of Khasra No. 77 Mauza Jalalpur, Tehsil Chhata, District Mathura, Uttar Pradesh - 281401 North: House of Imran. South: Road 13 feet wide. East: House of Chand. West: House of Sangeena.
TEEKAM SINGH (Applicant), SHYAMWATI . (Co Borrower), JAYRAM . (Guarantor) MLP000000259018	26-06-2026 Rs. 763807/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, HOUSE AREA MEASURING 172.10 SQ. MTRS., KHASRA NO.1292, MAUZA SOKHI, TEHSIL CHHATA, DISTRICT MATHURA, UTTAR PRADESH 281502. North: Rasta 10ft. South: House of Vijendra. East: House of Surajpal. West: House of Rajendra.
AJAD (Applicant), NEETU (Co Borrower), SHEETAL (Co Borrower), PRATAP SINGH (Co Borrower) MLP000000257665	26-06-2026 Rs. 564849/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, RESIDENTIAL HOUSE OF LAND AREA MEASURING 42.21 SQ. YARDS I.E. 35.29 SQ. METERS, SITUATED AT MAUZA KHATAINA, LOHAMANDI WARD, TEHSIL DISTRICT AGRA UTTAR PRADESH 282002. North: House of Narayan Singh. South: Remaining Part of House. East: Rasta Exit 6 Feet Wide. West: House of Kishori Lal.
JITENDRA KUMAR (Applicant), RESHAMWATI . (Co Borrower), KUVAR PAL SINGH (Co Borrower), DEEPAK KUMAR (Co Borrower) HL0000000144511	26-06-2026 Rs. 2010182/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, Property being house bearing Plot No. B-14 Bake Krishna Kanhra Residency Jagjeevan Nagar Mauza Nariach Tehsil Etmadpur District Agra Uttar Pradesh Situated in Kh No. 1908 K and Land Measuring Area 83.6 Sq.Mtr. North: Rasta 20 Ft. South: Other Land. East: Plot of Harish Agarwal. West: Other Plot.
DEVI SINGH (Applicant), MADHU DEVI (Co Borrower), TOKI . (Guarantor) MLP000000223828	26-06-2026 Rs. 702573/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, VACANT PLOT OF LAND AREA MEASURING 100 SQ. YARDS I.E. 83.61 SQ. METERS, KHASRA NO. 331, SITUATED AT GARDHI BAZRA, MAUZA CHIRHAULI, TEHSILETMADPUR DISTRICT AGRA UTTAR PRADESH, PIN 283201. North: Land of Seller. South: Rasta 8 Feet Wide. East: Land of Seller. West: House of Deshraj Singh.
RAMESH . (Applicant), VIDHYA DEVI (Co Borrower), HARIKISHAN . (Co Borrower), LAKHAN SINGH (Guarantor) MLP000000241913	26-06-2026 Rs. 619973/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, HOUSE AREA MEASURING 549.52 SQ. MTRS., KHASRA NO. 187, MAUZA BASAI SHERGARH BANGAR, TEHSIL CHHATA, DISTRICT MATHURA, UTTAR PRADESH, PIN 281404. North: House of Ratto. South: Plot of Harkishan. East: House of Naval. West: Rasta 18ft. wide.
JITENDRA SINGH (Applicant), AJAY . (Co Borrower), SONO DEVI (Co Borrower), BHARATI . (Co Borrower) LP0000000156335	26-06-2026 Rs. 797045/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, RESIDENTIAL HOUSE OF LAND AREA MEASURING 91.25 SQ. YARDS I.E. 76.30 SQ. METERS, SITUATED AT VILLAGE AANYAUR, TEHSIL GOVERDHAN AND DISTRICT MATHURA UTTAR PRADESH 281502. North: House of Lakhna. South: House of Prahlad. East: House of Bheemo. West: Badi Paikrama Marg.
SOHIL . (Applicant), RESHMA . (Co Borrower), SAMEER . (Co Borrower), SHOEVI . (Co Borrower) LP0000000133480	26-06-2026 Rs. 671785/- as on 16-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, PROPERTY ON LAND MEASURING AREA 178.37 S.M.TS., SITUATED AT IN MOHALLA GORAPADA KASBA- FATEHPUR SIKARI TEHSIL KIRAWALI AND DISTTAGRA283110. North: House of Gaiinda. South: House of Nabab. East: House of Usman. West: Rasta Nikas 10 ft..
MOHD SHUEB (Applicant), RUKHSAR BEGUM (Co Borrower) HL0000000174229	30-06-2026 Rs. 544659/- as on 30-06-2026 with further interest and charges thereon	Property At, All that piece and parcel of Abadi land bearing Gata No. 1480, admeasuring 0.0240 Hectare (approximately 242.56 Sq. Mtrs./ 2610 Sq. Ft.), situated at Mauja Singhaparasi (Singha Parasi), Pargana Bahraich, Tehsil Sadar, District Bahraich, State of Uttar Pradesh- 271802, together with all easements and appurtenances attached thereto. North: Remaining land of the Vendor (Plot), South: Kachcha Road, 14 Feet Wide. East: Remaining land of the Vendor (Plot), West: Kachcha Road, 22 Feet Wide.
The steps are being taken for substituted service of notice. The above borrowers, co- borrowers and/or their guarantors (where ever applicable) are advised to make the payments of outstanding within 60 days from the date of the publication of this notice failing which further steps will be taken after the expiry of 60 days of the date of this notice as per the provision of Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002. Please be informed that the said notice is also under section 13(13) informing the borrowers/guarantors/ mortgagors that the said mortgaged property should not be sold/leased/transferred.		
Date : 11.07.2026 Place : Bahraich, Mathura, Agra, Hathras		
Authorized Officer, VASTU HOUSING FINANCE CORPORATION LTD		

Harry Brook eyes Number 1 ranking in T20Is with 4-0 rout of India

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Bristol

He “probably didn’t expect” the series against India to be so lopsided but now that England has a winning 3-0 lead, skipper Harry Brook says his team would go all out for a clean sweep to dislodge the reigning world champions from the top of the ICC T20I rankings.

Chasing a modest 158 for 7, Brook led from the front with an attacking unbeaten 79 off 35 balls and together with Phil Salt (59 not out off 42) shared an unconquered 146-run partnership to power England to a comfortable nine-wicket win in the fourth T20I on Thursday for an unassailable 3-0 lead in the five-match series.

If England win the final T20I in Southampton on Friday, they will displace world champions India from the top spot.

“To go (to) world Number 1 and England going to the semis, that would be pretty cool,” Brook told after Thursday’s match.

“We’ve been told if we win the next game, we go to world Number 1 and that’s definitely a prize that we’re eyeing up. India are a strong



side. They probably haven’t been as good (in this series) as they have been over the last couple of years, but we’re really happy with the way that we’ve executed our plans.

“To beat India 4-0 would be a pretty special series win, if I’m being honest, and to go No. 1 in the world would be even better,” he added.

Brook “didn’t expect” such a cakewalk against India in the

ongoing series but he said the results so far are a fair reflection of England’s progress in the shorter formats of the game. “The white-ball side’s been on a really good path, if I’m being brutally honest. We’ve been playing extremely good cricket. We’ve been adapting to the surfaces and conditions really well. We had a good World Cup: we just fell just short of 250 in a chase at the Wankhede, which is incredible,” he said.

“I think it (this series) might have changed the mood (around English cricket) a little bit, but we’ve still got one more game to play. Hopefully, we can go to world Number 1 and beat a very strong Indian side.”

It’s disappointing, we fell short on our execution: Shreyas Iyer



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Bristol

India captain Shreyas Iyer didn’t hide his disappointment, admitting that his side utterly failed in execution once again in all departments after England sealed the T20I series with an emphatic nine-wicket win.

Iyer top-scored with an unbeaten 80 to help India post 158 for 7, a total that was blown away by England, who raced home in just 13.5 overs.

“Again it was a disappointing one. 158 wasn’t the perfect total on the board. Eventually

we saw how quickly they chased it down. When we came onto bowl I just asked the bowlers to repeat the lengths as much as possible.

“Top of middle and leg was difficult to score off. We fell short on our execution.” Iyer was happy with his performance but said it doesn’t matter as it didn’t come for a winning cause.

“Definitely happy with my performance, but see, if it’s not on the winning cause, it just goes to the side. So disappointed on that aspect because whenever I play, I want to perform and see to it that my team wins. But unfortunately, today wasn’t that day. Definitely look forward in the next game.

Challenge to accept we are underachieving in foreign conditions, says Ten Doeschate



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Bristol

India assistant coach Ryan ten Doeschate feels the immediate challenge for the current T20 world champions is to shed the “underachievers” tag in foreign conditions and need to understand the process of adapting quickly to varied playing environments.

After being clean swept by Ireland in the two T20Is, India, under Shreyas Iyer’s captaincy, cut a sorry figure in neighbouring England as the hosts thrashed the visitors by nine wickets in the fourth T20 to take an unassailable 3-0 lead in the five-match series on Thursday.

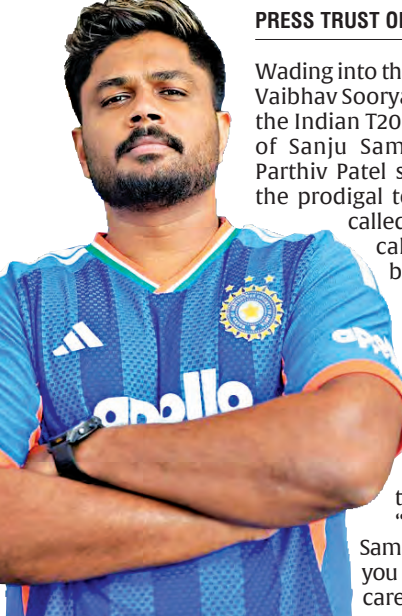
“We have spoken so much about adaptability, it’s easy to say we need to adapt, it’s easy to say but really it’s a point now where we need to understand the process, what is needed to make those adaptations,” Ten Doeschate said at the post-match press conference.

For starters, the team needs to accept that they aren’t playing well.

“Psychologically and mentally the challenge for the group is to accept the fact that we are underachieving in foreign conditions and tell the players look there is a big prize two years down the line in Australia.

“Do we want to be a team that smashes 250 in India and looks great hitting 80m six at Eden Gardens or do you want to come to places like Manchester, Southampton where things are slightly different and further down the line the MCG.

Emotionally right to give Sooryavanshi chance but logic-defying to drop Sanju: Parthiv Patel



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Wading into the debate surrounding Vaibhav Sooryavanshi’s inclusion in the Indian T20 team at the expense of Sanju Samson, former player Parthiv Patel says accommodating the prodigal teenager can only be called an emotionally right call as axing the senior batter defies logic.

Speaking on JioStar, Patel also acknowledged that in the past, Samson was dropped for his own inconsistency but right now, his omission is not easy to explain.

“Why is it always Sanju Samson who misses out? If you look at Sanju Samson’s career over the last 11-12



years, the one question that has always followed him is consistency,” Patel said. “Either the player who isn’t scoring quickly enough gets left out, or the one who has been inconsistent. You can’t make decisions based on both emotion and logic. So emotionally, yes, it was the right call to give Vaibhav Sooryavanshi a chance.

“But if you go purely by logic, then

why has Sanju Samson been left out? So, I think this decision was taken emotionally,” he added.

The 15-year-old Sooryavanshi was picked after Samson, who was player of the tournament in the T20 World Cup this year, failed to score in three consecutive games. However, the prodigal batter has not been able to make much of an impact so far.

Shubman gets invite to watch Wimbledon from Royal Box



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ London

Test and ODI skipper Shubman Gill has joined an elite list of Indian cricketers to get an invitation to watch Wimbledon from the Royal Box.

Gill will be the fourth Indian captain after Sachin Tendulkar, Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma to get the coveted invitation. Gill, who is currently with the Indian cricket team in England for the upcoming three-match ODI series, also witnessed another global sporting spectacle recently – the British Grand Prix at the Silverstone Circuit.

The 26-year-old attended his first-ever Formula 1 race as a VIP guest during the British GP and explored the paddock and soaked in the atmosphere.

‘Big Bash’ at Chepauk highlight in India-Australia sports collaboration

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Melbourne

India and Australia on Friday unveiled a Sports Collaboration Roadmap to expand cooperation in training, sports science, technology and the sports industry, with the inaugural match of the upcoming Big Bash League season in Chennai being the highlight of this collaboration.

The opening Australian Men’s Big Bash League fixture will see Melbourne Renegades face defending champions Perth Scorchers at the MA Chidambaram Stadium (Chepauk) in December, marking the first time a foreign cricket league match will be staged in India. The eight-team BBL is one of the most followed domestic cricket leagues in the world after IPL and is usually held in the December to February window.

The announcement forms



the centrepiece of a week-long “G’Day Namaste” festival across India, featuring Australian cultural, business and sporting events, according to a statement issued by the Australian government.

The India-Australia Sports Collaboration Roadmap, released jointly by India’s

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his Australian counterpart Anthony Albanese at the MCG, seeks to promote partnerships in sports training and capacity building, sports science and technology, and sports industry and investment, according to the Ministry of External Affairs.

Indian duo of Puligilla and Sherif eye podium finish at Rwanda Rally 2026

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Kigali City (Rwanda)

Indian rally driver Naveen Puligilla and his co-driver Musa Sherif will look for another podium finish at the Rwanda Mountain Gorilla Rally, which is the third round of the FIA African Rally Championship (ARC), starting here on Saturday. The duo completed the shakedown and qualifying stage on Friday.

The Duran Racing team’s Puligilla and Sherif of Kasaragod will drive a Ford Fiesta, serviced by MRU Motorsports Africa, in the ARC3 category. The total distance is 307.52km while the 18 Special Stages of competitive distance forms 252km of demanding mountain stages on Saturday and Sunday.



“The recce has given us a good understanding of the stages. The terrain is quite technical with changing grip levels of the moun-

tain roads and we are prepared for it,” said Puligilla, the Indian National Rally champion of 2025 in the 3T class.

Time for Shreyas to create his own identity as captain: Saba Karim

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Former India wicketkeeper-batter Saba Karim believes Shreyas Iyer needs to stamp his authority as captain in international cricket and translate the tactical acumen he has displayed in the IPL into the national side.

Iyer, who took over as India captain from Suryakumar Yadav following the T20 World Cup win, has remained winless as India suffered a 0-2 defeat against Ireland and then lost the last three T20I against England to concede a 0-3 lead with the first game being washed out.

“I feel the time has come for Shreyas Iyer to assert himself as a captain. The tactical captaincy we have seen from him in the IPL has not yet been visible in international cricket,” Karim said on JioHotstar.



“For example, when he was batting in the middle, Shivam Dube came in at number five, I didn’t understand that decision. That is not the Shreyas Iyer we know from the IPL. Logically, if he were captaining in the IPL right now, Tilak Varma would have walked in at number five instead of Shivam Dube.

5th T20I: Clueless India stare at rare whitewash



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Southampton

An Indian team with its back to the wall, led by a captain, who is equally cornered, will look to prevent England from inflicting a seemingly imminent 4-0 ‘whitewash’ when the two contrasting sides clash in the fifth T20 International on Saturday.

Led by Shreyas Iyer, the Indian team’s journey started in the damp and windy conditions of Belfast. It then covered north of England in Durham to finally be in the southern city of Southampton to close the five-match series in which one game was washed out.

In the six UK cities (including Belfast), one thing has remained common – Iyer’s fortunes have remained wretched as he is still without his first win since becoming captain. This is the longest

winless streak for the Indian men’s team since it first played a T20 International in 2006.

The Indian team has looked completely out of sorts save the second game at Old Trafford where it was in the game till the start of 17th over (bowled by Ravi Bishnoi).

Nottingham witnessed India’s worst batting performance – 76 all-out and Bristol was a perfect example of being outplayed in every department of the game.

The consolation win will do little to salvage the pride but even then, a die-hard Iyer fan would take a 1-3 defeat any day than the ignominy associated with a 0-4 humiliation in the early days of his captaincy.

Not being able to cope with pace generated by Jofra Archer and Josh Tongue has certainly left the Indian team management worried.

Women’s Hockey: India opt for continuity in Asian Games



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

India on Friday announced a tried-and-tested women’s hockey squad for this year’s Asian Games with just a couple of changes to the strike force that helped the side regain its place in the FIH Pro League recently.

The 20-member squad, to be led by regular skipper Salima Tete, will be aiming to qualify for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics by winning a gold at the 20th Asian Games to be held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan from September 19 to October 4. Salima will continue to

captain the side, having led the team to FIH Nations Cup triumph in New Zealand last month, which ensured that it spent only season in the relegated zone.

“We have a group in which we have a nice balance between juniors, experienced players and seniors who are constantly working to get the best out of each other,” said India’s chief coach, Sjoerd Marjine, sharing his thoughts on the squad announced here on Friday. Veteran Savita, who recently received the Padma Shri award, and Bichu Devi Kharibam have been named as the two goalkeepers in the squad.